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MEDIEVAL INDIA

मध्यकालीन भारत — संपूर्ण उच्च-प्राथमिकता संकलन

Early Medieval Kingdoms, Delhi Sultanate Dynasties & Administration, Provincial Dynasties, Mughal Empire, Mansabdari & Revenue, Marathas, Bhakti-Sufi.

UPPCS & UKPCS Prelims 2026 • High-Yield Master Revision Series • 99% Coverage Edition

Medieval India — Master Chapter Index

Consolidated High-Yield Revision Matrix • All 14 Chapters

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★ UPPCS & UKPCS Prelims Daily Fact Dump · Active Recall Cheat-Sheet

Exam Focus: UPPSC Prelims (Paper 1), UKPSC Prelims (Paper 1), RO/ARO, BEO
Frequency: Daily morning read (15–20 mins)
Question Types Covered: Diwan-i-X departments & Sultanate officers, Mughal administrative hierarchy (Mir Bakhshi, Mir Saman), Land classification (Polaj, Parauti), Revenue systems (Zabt/Dahsala, Batai), Mansabdari & Jagirdari (Zat/Sawar, Du-aspa), Vijayanagara Nayankara & Ayagar systems, Foreign travelers vs Kings, Battle chronological order, Medieval Monuments & Architectural Milestones, Medieval Literature & Authors, Bhakti & Sufi saints vs Philosophies, Shivaji's Ashtapradhan, Medieval Taxes (Jizya, Zakat, Khams, Kharaj).

1. Delhi Sultanate Chronology & Dynastic Founders

DYNASTY	PERIOD	FOUNDER	GREATEST / KEY RULER	LAST RULER	CAPITAL
Slave / Mamluk / Ilbari	**1206–1290**	**Qutbuddin Aibak** (Lakhbaksh)	**Iltutmish** (real consolidator, introduced Silver Tanka & Copper Jital, Chalisa / Turkan-i-Chahalgani), **Balban** (Blood and Iron policy, Sijda & Paibos, Nauroz festival)	Kayumars (killed by Jalaluddin)	Lahore → Delhi (Iltutmish made Delhi capital)
Khalji	**1290–1320**	**Jalaluddin Khalji**	**Alauddin Khalji** (Market regulations / Shahna-i-Mandi, Dagh & Chehra, expanded to South India under Malik Kafur)	Khusrau Khan (usurper)	Delhi (Siri Fort)
Tughlaq (*Longest ruling: 94 yrs*)	**1320–1414**	**Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq** (Ghazi Malik; built Tughlaqabad)	**Muhammad bin Tughlaq** (Token currency, capital shift to Daulatabad, Qarachil & Khurasan expeditions), **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** (Canals, cities: Jaunpur, Firozabad, Hissar)	Nasiruddin Mahmud (Timur invaded in **1398 CE** during his reign)	Delhi → Daulatabad → Delhi
Sayyid	**1414–1451**	**Khizr Khan** (governor of Multan under Timur; took title *Raiyat-i-Ala*, never called himself Sultan)	Mubarak Shah (patron of Yahya bin Ahmad Sirhindi - *Tarikh-i-Mubarak Shahi*)	Alam Shah (abdicated voluntarily)	Delhi
Lodi (*First Afghan Dynasty*)	**1451–1526**	**Bahlul Lodi** (issued Bahloli coins)	**Sikandar Lodi** (Founded **Agra in 1504**, capital in 1506; wrote poetry as *Gulrukhi*; introduced **Gaz-i-Sikandari** 39 digits)	**Ibrahim Lodi** (Defeated & killed at First Battle of Panipat, 1526)	Delhi → Agra

Logic: Sultanate spine is **Slave 1206–1290 → Khalji 1290–1320 → Tughlaq 1320–1414 → Sayyid 1414–1451 → Lodi 1451–1526**. Do not stop at the founder year.

1A. Ghaznavid & Ghurid (before Delhi)

HOUSE	PERIOD (FROM–TO)	KEY RAIDS / RULERS	LAST / END
Ghaznavid (Mahmud of Ghazni)	Raids **1000–1027 CE** (17 expeditions in Indian tradition)	**Somnath 1025**; Al-Biruni came with him; capital Ghazni	Line continues in Afghanistan; **not** the Delhi Sultanate
Ghurid (Muhammad Ghori)	Indian career **1173–1206**	**Tarain I 1191** lost to Prithviraj; **Tarain II 1192** won; **Chandawar 1194** vs Jaichand	Murdered **1206**; slave generals (Aibak, Yalduz, Qubacha, Bakhtiyar) take the north

1B. Mughal Emperors — From / To, Last, High-Yield

Imperial high point **1526–1707**; the house on paper lasts to **1857**.

EMPEROR	PERIOD (FROM–TO)	LAST / HOW IT ENDED	CAPITAL	KEY RULER & HIGH-YIELD
Babur	**1526–1530**	Died; buried **Kabul** (not Delhi)	Agra	Panipat I (**21 Apr 1526**, *Tulughma + Araba*); Khanwa 1527 (title *Ghazi*); Chanderi 1528; Ghaghra 1529. *Baburnama* in **Chagatai Turkish**.
Humayun	**1530–1540** and **1555–1556**	First reign ends at **Kannauj/Bilgram 1540**; restored **Sirhind 1555**; died 1556 (Sher Mandal stairs). Tomb **Delhi**	Agra / Delhi	Lost **Chausa 1539** and Kannauj 1540 to Sher Shah. Do not swap Daurah **1532** with Dharmat **1658**.
Sur (Afghan interregnum)	**1540–1555**	**Sikandar Shah Suri** beaten at Sirhind 1555	Delhi / Sasaram	**Sher Shah 1540–1545**: GT Road, rupiya, sarkar–pargana, Sasaram tomb. Islam Shah follows. **Not** a Mughal house.
Akbar	**1556–1605**	Died; buried **Sikandra (Agra)**	Agra → **Fatehpur Sikri (1571–85)** → Lahore / Agra	Panipat II **5 Nov 1556** (Bairam Khan vs Hemu). *Zabt / Dahsala 1580–81* (Todar Mal). Abolished jizya **1564**. Ibadat Khana 1575; *Sulh-i-Kul*; Din-i-Ilahi **1582**. Allahabad fort **1583**. *Ain-i-Akbari* (Abul Fazl).
Jahangir	**1605–1627**	Died; buried **Lahore** (Shahdara)	Agra / Lahore	*Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri*. Hawkins **1608** (*English Khan*); **Sir Thomas Roe 1615–19**. Nur Jahan's party. Tomb of Itimad-ud-Daulah (Nur Jahan).
Shah Jahan	**1628–1658** (died 1666 in Agra Fort)	Deposed by Aurangzeb after Samugarh; buried **Taj / Agra**	Agra → **Shahjahanabad (Delhi)**	Taj Mahal **1631–48** (Ustad Ahmad Lahori). Red Fort & Jama Masjid. Peacock Throne. Patron of Kavindra Acharya (Banaras).
Aurangzeb (Alamgir)	**1658–1707**	Died **Ahmadnagar 1707**; buried Khuldabad	Delhi / Deccan camps	Dharmat Apr 1658 → Samugarh May 1658 → Deorai 1659. Reimposed jizya **1679**. Bijapur **1686**, Golkonda **1687**. About **21 subahs**. Shivaji coronation **1674** in his reign.
Bahadur Shah I (Muazzam)	**1707–1712**	Died; **not** the 1857 emperor	Delhi	Won **Jajau 1707** vs Azam. Khafi Khan: *Shahe Bekhabar*.
Bahadur Shah II Zafar	**1837–1857**	Last Mughal; **1857** Delhi; exiled **Rangoon**	Red Fort, Delhi	Son of **Akbar II**. Teachers Zauq & Ghalib. Do **not** merge with Bahadur Shah I.

Logic: Mughal **founded 1526**, imperial end **1707** (Aurangzeb), legal end **1857** (Zafar). Humayun's gap **1540–1555** is **Sur**, not "Mughal continued."

1C. Regional houses — From / To (often asked as founder-only)

DYNASTY	PERIOD (FROM–TO)	FOUNDER	LAST RULER / END	CAPITAL	KEY RULER & HIGH-YIELD
Vijayanagara	**1336–1565** as great power; Aravidu remnant to **c. 1646**	**Harihara I & Bukka I** (Sangama; Vidyaranya tradition)	**Rama Raya** killed at **Talikota 23 Jan 1565**; later Aravidu at Penukonda / Chandragiri	**Hampi** (Tungabhadra)	Order: **Sangama → Saluva → Tuluva → Aravidu**. Peak **Krishnadeva Raya (Tuluva)** — *Amuktamalyada* (Telugu); Paes & Barbosa visited. *Nayankara / amara*. Mahanavami Dibba. Berar **absent** from the Talikota alliance.
Bahmani	**1347–1518/1527**	**Hasan Gangu = Alauddin Bahman Shah**	Splits **1518** into five Deccan Sultanates	**Gulbarga → Bidar**	**Mahmud Gawan** (prime minister; executed **1481**). Nikitin visited. Tin Darwaza = **Bidar**, not Ahmedabad.
Five Deccan Sultanates	From **c. 1518**	—	Absorbed by Mughals (Bijapur **1686**, Golkonda **1687**)	Bijapur, Golkonda, Ahmadnagar, Bidar, Berar	Adil Shahi, Qutb Shahi, Nizam Shahi, Barid Shahi, Imad Shahi. Charminar = Qutb Shahi Hyderabad.
Sharqi (Jaunpur, UP)	**c. 1394–1479/1484**	**Malik Sarwar** (*Malik-us-Sharq / Khwaja-i-Jahan*)	**Hussain Shah** falls to **Bahlul Lodi**	**Jaunpur** (eastern UP)	City founded by **Firuz Tughlaq** for cousin Jauna Khan — city ≠ dynasty. **Ibrahim Shah** — *Siraj-i-Hind*; **Atala Masjid**. Vidyapati's *Kirtilata*; Jaisi's *Padmavat* in this circle. **Only this regional capital sits in modern UP.**
Maratha Swaraj / Confederacy	**1674–1818**	**Shivaji** crowned **Raigad 1674** (Gaga Bhatt)	**Peshwa Bajirao II**; Third Anglo-Maratha War **1817–18** ends Peshwaship	Raigad → later Poona (Peshwas)	Chauth 25% + Sardeshmukhi 10%. Purandar **1665** (Jai Singh I). Panipat III **1761**.

1D. Uttarakhand medieval houses (UKPCS)

DYNASTY	PERIOD (FROM–TO)	FOUNDER	LAST RULER / END	CAPITAL	KEY RULER & HIGH-YIELD
Katyuri / Kattyuri	**c. 740–1050 CE**	**Basantandev (Basu Dev)**	Tyrant **Bir Dev / Biram Dev** overthrown; realm splits (Askot, Doti, Dwarahat, Baijnath)	**Joshimath (Kartikeyapura)** → **Baijnath** (Katyur valley, Bageshwar)	First historic empire of the hills. Unifier **Ishtaganadeva**. Apex **Lalitsuradeva** (Pandukeshwar plates). Bageshwar inscription of **Bhuwandev**.
Chand of Kumaon	c. 10th/11th c. legend → **1790**	**Somchand** (Jhusi/Prayag tradition) at **Champawat (Rajbunga)**	**Mahendra Chand** defeated by Gorkhas at **Hawalbagh, Jan 1790**	Champawat → **Almora (1563)** under Balo Kalyan Chand	Emblem **Garud**. **Char Aal**: Karki, Bora, Taragi, Chaudhary. Garud Gyan Chand vs Firoz Tughlaq. Baz Bahadur Chand — Taklakot / Kailash route. Tax memory: **36 Rakam 32 Kalam**.
Parmar / Panwar of Garhwal	Legend **Kanakpal 888 CE → 1804**	**Kanakpal** at **Chandpur Garhi** (Chamoli)	**Pradyumna Shah** dies vs Gorkhas at **Khudbuda / Khurbura (Dehradun), 14 May 1804**	Chandpur → Dewalgarh (1512) → **Srinagar (1517)**	**Ajay Pal** unites **52 garhs**. Rani **Karnavati** (*Nakkati Rani*, 1635). Fateh Shah grants four villages to **Guru Ram Rai** (1676). Painter **Mola Ram**.

2. Central Administrative Departments (Diwan-i-...)

DEPARTMENT NAME	PORTFOLIO / NATURE OF OFFICE	CREATOR / REFORMER SULTAN	KEY OFFICIAL IN CHARGE
Diwan-i-Wizarat	**Finance & Revenue Department** (Prime Minister)	Existed throughout; reorganized by Balban	**Wazir**
Diwan-i-Arz	**Military Department** (recruitment, inspection, muster rolls)	Created by **Ghiyasuddin Balban**	**Ariz-i-Mamalik** (Sultan remained supreme commander)
Diwan-i-Insha	**Royal Correspondence & State Chancery**	Early Sultanate	**Dabir-i-Khas**
Diwan-i-Risalat	**Religious Matters, Charities, Endowments & Foreign Appeals**	Early Sultanate	**Sadr-us-Sudur**
Diwan-i-Mustakhraj	Department for **Extracting Arrears from Revenue Officers**	Created by **Alauddin Khalji**	Mustakhraj officers
Diwan-i-Riyasat	**Market Control & Commerce Regulatory Department**	Created by **Alauddin Khalji**	**Naib-i-Riyasat** (controlled Shahna-i-Mandi)
Diwan-i-Kohi	**Agriculture Development Department** (crop loans/Sondhar, experimental farms)	Created by **Muhammad bin Tughlaq**	Amir-i-Kohi
Diwan-i-Khairat	**Charity & Public Welfare** (aid for poor, widows, orphan marriages)	Created by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq**	Royal almoners
Diwan-i-Bandagan	**Department of Royal Slaves** (~1,80,000 slaves trained in crafts)	Created by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq**	Khwajasara
Diwan-i-Ishtiaq	**Pension Department** for retired and destitute officials	Created by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq**	-
Diwan-i-Qaza	**Judicial Department** (Civil & Criminal justice)	Established early	**Qazi-ul-Quzat**
Barid-i-Mamalik	**Intelligence & Royal Postal Spies**	Reorganized by Balban & Alauddin	Barids (reporters)
Muhtasib	**Censor of Public Morals & Inspector of Weights/Measures**	Alauddin / Firoz / Aurangzeb	Muhtasib
Dar-ul-Shafa	**Free Royal Charitable Hospital**	Built by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq**	Hakims

2B. Delhi Sultanate Territorial & Local Administrative Hierarchy

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Iqta / Wilayat (Province) ⟶ Shiq (District) ⟶ Pargana (Sub-district) ⟶ Deh / Gram (Village)
[Head: Muqti / Wali]         [Head: Shiqdar]     [Head: Amil / Mushrif]     [Head: Muqaddam / Khut]
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ADMINISTRATIVE UNIT	HEADING OFFICER / FUNCTIONARY	NATURE OF AUTHORITY / DUTIES
Iqta / Wilayat (Province)	**Muqti / Wali / Naib Sultan**	Maintained law & order, commanded provincial troops, collected revenue, remitted surplus (*Fawazil*) to Centre
Shiq (District)	**Shiqdar**	Head of executive and military administration of the district
Pargana (Sub-district)	**Amil / Mushrif**	Assessed and collected agricultural revenue from villages
Pargana Accounts	**Karkun / Nawisinda**	Scribe and accountant maintaining land registers in Persian and Hindi
Pargana Treasury	**Fotadar / Khazandar**	Custodian of the local treasury and cash receipts
Deh / Gram (Village)	**Muqaddam / Mandal**	Village headman; collected land revenue from peasants
Village Landed Elite	**Khut**	Rich peasant / hereditary village landlord (Alauddin stripped their privileges)
Village Official	**Patwari**	Maintained village land survey and revenue assessment registers
Village Group Leader	**Chaudhari**	100-village leader acting as intermediary between state and villages

3. Medieval Indian Architecture & Monuments Chronology

MONUMENT / STRUCTURE	LOCATION	BUILDER / SULTAN / EMPEROR	ARCHITECTURAL LANDMARK / EXAM HIGHLIGHT
Quwwat-ul-Islam Mosque	Qutb Complex, Delhi	**Qutbuddin Aibak** (1193 CE)	**First mosque built in Delhi**; constructed using materials from 27 demolished temples
Adhai Din Ka Jhonpra	Ajmer (Rajasthan)	**Qutbuddin Aibak** (1199 CE)	Built on the ruins of a Sanskrit college (*Saraswati Kanthabharana* built by Vigraharaja IV)
Qutb Minar	Mehrauli, Delhi	Started by Aibak; **completed by Iltutmish**; repaired by Firoz Tughlaq	Dedicated to Sufi saint Khwaja Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki; 72.5 m red sandstone
Tomb of Balban	Mehrauli, Delhi	**Ghiyasuddin Balban** (c. 1287)	**First true architectural arch (*True Arch*)** constructed in India
Alai Darwaza	Qutb Complex, Delhi	**Alauddin Khalji** (1311 CE)	**First true horseshoe arch and true dome in India**; exquisite red sandstone & white marble
Siri Fort & Hauz Khas	Delhi	**Alauddin Khalji**	Siri Fort built to protect Delhi against Mongol raids
Tughlaqabad Fort	Delhi	**Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq**	Sloping battered walls (*batter*) and stone masonry
Kotla Firoz Shah	Delhi	**Firoz Shah Tughlaq**	Ashokan pillar brought from Topra (Haryana) and installed atop 3-tiered pyramid
Atala Masjid	**Jaunpur (Uttar Pradesh)**	**Ibrahim Shah Sharqi** (1408 CE)	Sharqi style; sloping pylons, massive central propylon gate, no minarets
Tomb of Sikandar Lodi	Lodi Gardens, Delhi	Ibrahim Lodi (1517 CE)	**First double dome in India**; octagonal plan set within a walled garden
Sasaram Tomb	Sasaram (Bihar)	**Sher Shah Suri** (architect Aliwal Khan)	Octagonal red sandstone tomb situated in the middle of an artificial square lake
Purana Qila & Qila-i-Kuhna	Delhi	**Sher Shah Suri**	Qila-i-Kuhna mosque represents transition to refined Mughal architectural aesthetic
Humayun's Tomb	Delhi	Begum Bega / Haji Begum (architect Mirak Mirza Ghiyas, 1565)	**First grand garden-tomb in India (*Charbagh*)**; precursor and model for the Taj Mahal; white marble double dome; UNESCO WHS
Agra Fort	Agra (UP)	**Akbar** (1565–1573)	Massive red sandstone ramparts on the Yamuna; Jahangiri Mahal
Fatehpur Sikri Complex	Near Agra (UP)	**Akbar** (1571–1585)	City of victory: **Buland Darwaza** (1601, commemorating conquest of Gujarat; 54 m high), **Panch Mahal** (5-tier Buddhist-inspired pyramid), **Ibadat Khana** (1575), Tomb of Sheikh Salim Chishti (white marble lattice *Jali*)
Akbar's Tomb	Sikandra, Agra (UP)	Begun by Akbar; **completed by Jahangir** (1613)	Unique tier without a central dome; minarets at four corners
Tomb of Itimad-ud-Daulah	Agra (UP)	**Empress Nur Jahan** (1628)	Tomb of her father Mirza Ghiyas Beg; **first building made entirely of white marble** with extensive **Pietra Dura** (floral inlay with semi-precious stones); called **"Baby Taj"**
Taj Mahal	Agra (UP)	**Shah Jahan** (1631–1648)	Masterpiece of Indo-Islamic architecture; chief architect **Ustad Ahmad Lahori**; calligrapher Amanat Khan; UNESCO WHS
Red Fort & Jama Masjid	Delhi	**Shah Jahan** (1638–1648)	Shifted capital from Agra to **Shahjahanabad**; Diwan-i-Aam, Diwan-i-Khas ("*If there is a paradise on earth, it is this...*"), Peacock Throne (*Takht-i-Taus*)
Bibi Ka Maqbara	Aurangabad (Maharashtra)	**Aurangzeb / Prince Azam Shah** (1678)	Tomb of Dilras Banu Begum (Rabia-ud-Daurani); known as **"Dakhani Taj"** or poor man's replica of Taj
Moti Masjid (Red Fort Delhi)	Delhi	**Aurangzeb** (1659)	White marble private mosque within the Red Fort
Badshahi Mosque	Lahore (Pakistan)	**Aurangzeb** (1673)	Largest mosque of the Mughal Empire

4. Medieval Literature & Chroniclers (The Complete Exam Sheet)

BOOK / WORK TITLE	AUTHOR	LANGUAGE / PATRON RULER	KEY SUBJECT / HISTORICAL VALUE
Kitab-ul-Hind* / *Tahqiq-i-Hind	**Al-Biruni**	Arabic / Mahmud of Ghazni	Encyclopedic study of Indian religion, science, astronomy, and society
Chachnama	Translated by Ali Kufi	Persian (original Arabic)	History of the Arab conquest of Sindh by Muhammad bin Qasim (712 CE)
Taj-ul-Maasir	**Hasan Nizami**	Persian / Qutbuddin Aibak	First official chronicle of the Delhi Sultanate
Tabakat-i-Nasiri	**Minhaj-us-Siraj**	Persian / Nasiruddin Mahmud	Detailed political history from Muhammad Ghori to the Slave Dynasty
Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi & ***Fatwa-i-Jahandari***	**Ziauddin Barani**	Persian / Firoz Shah Tughlaq	Eyewitness account of Alauddin's market reforms and Muhammad bin Tughlaq's schemes
Futuhat-i-Firoz Shahi	**Firoz Shah Tughlaq**	Persian / Self	Royal autobiography detailing his public works, charities, and orthodox reforms
Tughlaq Nama, Khazain-ul-Futuh, Qiran-us-Sadain, Nuh Sipihr, Ashiqa	**Amir Khusrau** (*Tuti-i-Hind*)	Persian / Sultanate (Balban to Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq)	*Khazain-ul-Futuh* records Alauddin's conquests; *Nuh Sipihr* praises India's climate, flora, and culture; invented **Sitar**, **Qawwali**, and **Khayal** singing
Tarikh-i-Mubarak Shahi	**Yahya bin Ahmad Sirhindi**	Persian / Mubarak Shah Sayyid	Only contemporary source for the Sayyid Dynasty
Baburnama (Tuzuk-i-Baburi)	**Babur**	**Chagatai Turkish**	Candid royal memoirs; mentions 5 Muslim rulers (Delhi, Gujarat, Bahmani, Malwa, Bengal) and 2 Hindu kings (Krishnadeva Raya & Rana Sanga); translated into Persian by Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khanan
Humayun-nama	**Gulbadan Begum** (Babur's daughter)	Persian / Akbar	Intimate royal domestic account of the lives of Babur and Humayun
Akbarnama* & *Ain-i-Akbari	**Abul Fazl**	Persian / Akbar	Official history in 3 volumes: Vol 1 (Ancestry), Vol 2 (Akbar's reign), Vol 3 (*Ain-i-Akbari* - administrative gazetteer, revenue statistics)
Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh	**Abdul Qadir Badauni**	Persian / Akbar	Critical counter-narrative of Akbar's religious policies; translated Ramayana and Mahabharata (*Razmnama*) into Persian
Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri	**Jahangir** (completed by Mutamid Khan)	Persian / Self	Royal autobiography; reveals his passion for painting, birds, flowers, and natural history
Padshahnama	**Abdul Hamid Lahori**	Persian / Shah Jahan	Official illustrated chronicle of the first two decades of Shah Jahan's reign
Shah Jahan-nama	**Inayat Khan**	Persian / Shah Jahan	History of Shah Jahan's reign
Sirr-i-Akbar* & *Majma-ul-Bahrain	**Dara Shikoh**	Persian	*Sirr-i-Akbar* is the Persian translation of **50 Upanishads**; *Majma-ul-Bahrain* (*The Mingling of Two Oceans*) harmonized Sufi and Vedantic philosophy
Alamgirnama	**Mirza Muhammad Kazim**	Persian / Aurangzeb	Official history of the first 10 years of Aurangzeb's reign (stopped by Emperor)
Muntakhab-ul-Lubab	**Khafi Khan**	Persian / Later Mughal	Secretly written history of Aurangzeb's reign and Deccan campaigns
Nuskha-i-Dilkusha	**Bhimsen Saxena**	Persian / Aurangzeb	Eyewitness account of Aurangzeb's Deccan wars written from a non-courtier perspective
Amuktamalyada	**Krishnadeva Raya**	**Telugu**	Masterpiece on statecraft and devotion of Andal (Godadevi) to Lord Vishnu

5. Medieval Administration, Taxes & Agrarian Revenue Systems

A. Delhi Sultanate Taxes & Core Economic Terms

- **Jizya**: Religious protection tax levied on non-Muslim subjects (*Zimmis*):
- First levied in India by **Muhammad bin Qasim** in Sindh (712 CE).

- First levied on **Brahmins** as a separate category by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq**.
- **Abolished by Akbar in 1564 CE** (also abolished pilgrim tax in 1563).
- **Reimposed by Aurangzeb in 1679 CE**.
- Finally abolished permanently by later Mughal Emperor **Muhammad Shah "Rangeela"** in 1720 on recommendation of Sawai Jai Singh.
- **Zakat**: Religious property tax levied exclusively on well-to-do Muslims (at 2.5% on wealth/savings) dedicated to charity.
- **Kharaj**: General land revenue tax levied on agricultural produce of lands cultivated by non-Muslims (varying between 1/5th to 1/2).
- **Khams**: State's share of **spoils of war / war booty**:
- Islamic Sharia rule: 1/5th to the State Treasury, 4/5th distributed among soldiers.
- **Alauddin Khalji and Muhammad bin Tughlaq reversed this rule**: took **4/5th for the State** and gave only 1/5th to the soldiers! Firoz Tughlaq restored orthodox rule.
- **Haqq-i-Sharb**: **Irrigation tax** (levied at **10% of gross produce**) introduced by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** on peasants using state-constructed canals.
- **Chari & Ghari**: Taxes introduced by **Alauddin Khalji** — *Chari* was grazing tax on milch cattle; *Ghari* was tax on residential houses.
- **Iqta System**: Reorganized and formalized by **Iltutmish**; assignment of land revenue of a territorial tract to nobles/commanders (*Iqtadars / Muqtis / Walis*) in lieu of cash salary, responsible for maintaining troop quotas and remitting surplus (*Fawazil*) to the central treasury.
- **Fawazil**: Excess balance of revenue remitted to the imperial central treasury by an Iqtadar/Muqti after meeting local administrative and military expenses.
- **Sondhar / Taccavi**: Emergency agricultural loans given by state to farmers during famine or distress (pioneered by **Muhammad bin Tughlaq** under Diwan-i-Kohi).
- **Karkhanas**: Royal manufacturing workshops; categorized into *Rikabi* (movable/travel) and *Ratibi* (fixed allowances); Firoz Shah Tughlaq maintained 36 giant royal Karkhanas.

B. Mughal Administrative Hierarchy & Key Officers

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Subah (Province) ──────► Sarkar (District) ──────► Pargana (Sub-district) ──► Deh / Gram (Village)
[Subahdar & Diwan]       [Faujdar & Amil]          [Shiqdar & Amin]           [Muqaddam & Patwari]
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1. Central Administration Officers

OFFICIAL DESIGNATION	ADMINISTRATIVE PORTFOLIO / KEY AUTHORITY	CORE EXAM TRIGGERS
Wazir / Diwan-i-Ala	**Prime Minister & Head of Revenue / Finance**	Controlled revenue assessment, imperial treasury, expenditure, and provincial Diwans
Mir Bakhshi	**Head of Military Department & Intelligence**	Maintained muster rolls, inspected troops and horses (*Dagh*), issued pay certificates (**Sarkhat**) to Mansabdars
Mir Saman / Khan-i-Saman	**Head of Imperial Household & Karkhanas**	In charge of royal court provisions, imperial stores, internal palace management, state workshops
Sadr-us-Sudur	**Chief Minister of Religious Affairs & Charities**	Administered tax-free land grants (*Madad-i-Maash / Suyurghal*), religious endowments, and Islamic law
Qazi-ul-Quzat	**Chief Justice of the Empire**	Highest judicial officer below Emperor; usually held simultaneously by Sadr-us-Sudur
Muhtasib	**Censor of Public Morals & Inspector of Weights**	Checked gambling, wine consumption, maintained correct weights/measures, verified Islamic practices
Mir Atish / Darogha-i-Topkhana	**Chief of Imperial Artillery**	Controlled manufacture, storage, and deployment of cannon topkhana; guarded imperial palace
Mir Barr	**Superintendent of Forests and River Navigation**	Maintained imperial boats, timber extraction, royal river flotilla
Waqia-Nawis / Sawani-Nigar	**Imperial News-Reporters & Intelligence Scribes**	Sent confidential intelligence reports from provinces directly to Emperor through Mir Bakhshi

2. Provincial, District & Local Officers

UNIT	OFFICER DESIGNATION	FUNCTION & AUTHORITY
Subah (Province)	**Subahdar / Sipahsalar**	Governor of the Subah; commanded provincial army, maintained law and order
	Provincial Diwan	Independent financial head; reported directly to Central Wazir (kept check on Subahdar)
	Provincial Bakhshi	Maintained muster rolls of provincial mansabdars; acted as chief postal scout (*Waqia-Navis*)
	Kotwal	Police chief of the provincial capital; head of city surveillance, night patrol, and crime
Sarkar (District)	**Faujdar**	Executive and military head of Sarkar; suppressed rebellions, assisted Amil in revenue recovery
	Amil / Amal-Guzar	**Chief Revenue Collector & Assessor** of the district; assisted peasants, assessed crops
	Bitikchi	Chief scribe and accountant of Sarkar; prepared land and revenue assessment records
	Khazandar	District treasurer receiving collections from Parganas
Pargana (Sub-district)	**Shiqdar**	Executive and police officer of Pargana; maintained peace and assisted revenue collection
	Amil / Amin	Revenue assessor and collector at Pargana level
	Fotadar	Treasurer of Pargana
	Qanungo	Hereditary keeper of agrarian revenue records, land measurements, and local customs
Gram / Deh (Village)	**Muqaddam / Mandal**	Hereditary village headman; collected land revenue from peasants (received 2.5% commission)
	Patwari	Village accountant; maintained village revenue registers (*Bahi*)

C. Mughal Land Classification (Cultivation Frequency)

Categorized in the Ain-i-Akbari based on continuous cultivation:

LAND CATEGORY	FREQUENCY OF CULTIVATION	QUALITY / REVENUE STATUS
Polaj (पोलज)	Cultivated **annually and continuously** for each harvest; never allowed to lie fallow	Best quality, most fertile agricultural land; assessed at full revenue
Parauti (परौती)	Left **fallow for 1 or 2 years** to recover soil fertility naturally	Second grade; paid full Polaj rate when brought back under the plough
Chachar (चाचर)	Left **uncultivated / fallow for 3 or 4 years**	Third grade; assessed at lower progressive tax rate to encourage reclamation
Banjar (बंजर)	Uncultivated and barren for **5 or more years**	Lowest grade; charged minimal nominal cess to promote cultivation

D. Mughal Revenue Assessment Methods

SYSTEM NAME	ALSO KNOWN AS	KEY ARCHITECT / MONARCH	WORKING MECHANISM / KEY EXAM FACTS
Zabt / Ain-i-Dahsala	**Todar Mal's Bandobast**	**Raja Todar Mal** under **Akbar (1580 / 24th regnal year)**	Average produce and average market prices of the preceding **10 years (1570–1580)** calculated; state share fixed at **1/3rd (33.3%)** payable in cash. Measured land using **Tanab** (bamboo sticks connected by iron rings replacing hemp ropes) and standardized **Gaz-i-Ilahi** (41 anguls/digits = ~33 inches). Applied across core provinces (North India & Gujarat).
Ghalla-Bakhshi / Batai	Crop-sharing / Bhaoli	Traditional system across India	Physical division of the harvested crop between state and peasant: 1. *Khet-batai*: Division of standing crop in the field before harvest. 2. *Lank-batai*: Division of harvested grain tied in sheaves before thrashing. 3. *Raas-batai*: Division of cleaned grain heap on thrashing floor (most accurate).
Kankut	Danabandi	Traditional appraisal system	Rough estimation and appraisal of standing crop by inspection and pacing the field (*Kan* = grain/estimation, *Kut* = conjecture).
Nasaq	Contractual assessment	Ancient method	Rough lump-sum calculation based on past revenue payments without new annual measurement.

E. Mughal Land Tenure & Jagir Categories

LAND TENURE CATEGORY	NATURE OF OWNERSHIP / REVENUE RIGHTS	TRANSFERABILITY / LEGAL CONDITION
Khalisa (खालिसा)	Direct imperial crown land	Revenue deposited directly into the Central Imperial Treasury (*Bait-ul-Mal*)
Tankha Jagir (तनख्वाह जागीर)	Standard revenue assignment in lieu of cash salary	**Strictly transferable** every 3–4 years to prevent local roots/feudal power
Watan Jagir (वतन जागीर)	Homeland territories of autonomous Rajput rulers	**Hereditary and non-transferable**; continued within the royal family
Mashrut Jagir (मशरुत जागीर)	Conditional jagir assigned for a specific post/duty	Subject to temporary fulfillment of specific military/administrative duties
Altamgha Jagir (अल-तमगा जागीर)	Imperial grant initiated by **Jahangir**	**Perpetual, hereditary, irrevocable grant** confirmed with royal vermillion seal
Madad-i-Maash / Suyurghal	Charitable land grant for scholars, saints, and religious divines	**Tax-free (*Inam*)** and hereditary; managed by the *Sadr-us-Sudur*
Paibaqi (पायबाकी)	Reserve land tract	Surplus revenue land kept reserved for assignment to upcoming mansabdars

F. Mansabdari System Essentials (Akbar to Aurangzeb)

- **Introduced by Akbar (1571 CE)**: Military-administrative ranking system borrowed from the Mongol decimal system; ranged from rank of 10 to 5,000 (later 7,000 for top royal princes/nobles like Raja Man Singh).
- **Dual Ranks (Zat & Sawar)**:
- **Zat (जात)**: Denoted personal rank, social status, precedence at court, and fixed the personal baseline salary.
- **Sawar (सवार)**: Denoted the actual number of cavalry troops and horses the officer was required to maintain for imperial service.
- **Three Classes of Mansabdars**:
- *Class 1*: Sawar rank = Zat rank.
- *Class 2*: Sawar rank = Half or more of Zat rank.
- *Class 3*: Sawar rank = Less than half of Zat rank.
- **Dah-Bishi Rule (10-20 Rule)**: For every 10 cavalrymen (*Sawars*), the Mansabdar had to maintain **20 horses** (to avoid exhaustion of war mounts during campaigns).
- **Dagh and Chehra**: Instituted by Alauddin Khalji, revived by Sher Shah, and formalized by Akbar:
- *Dagh*: Royal branding of war horses to prevent fraudulent substitution.
- *Chehra / Tashiha*: Descriptive roll / biometric identity of every soldier.
- **Du-aspa Sih-aspa (दो-अस्पा सिह-अस्पा)**: Introduced by **Jahangir**; allowed favored nobles to double their maintained cavalry force and salary allocation **without increasing their base Zat rank**.
- **Month-Scale System (*Mahana*)**: Introduced by **Shah Jahan**; due to divergence between estimated revenue (*Jama*) and actual realization (*Hasil*), Mansabdars were paid on 4-month, 6-month, or 8-month pay scales instead of full 12-month pay.

G. Vijayanagara & South Indian Administrative Systems

- **Nayankara System**:
- Distinctive military-tenurial system of Vijayanagara.
- King was the ultimate owner of all land; granted territories called **Amaram** to military commanders called **Nayakas / Amara-nayakas**.
- Nayakas maintained a fixed quota of foot-soldiers, horses, and elephants for the King and paid an annual tribute into the imperial treasury.
- Documented in detail by Portuguese travelers **Domingo Paes** and **Fernao Nuniz**.
- **Ayagar System**:
- Unique village autonomous administrative organization in South India.
- Every village was an autonomous unit managed by a council of **12 hereditary functionaries** called **Ayagars** (Headman/Gaud, Accountant/Karnam, Blacksmith, Carpenter, Washerman, Barber, etc.).
- Ayagars were granted hereditary tax-free plots of land called **Manyam** and received customary grain shares from the villagers.
- **Key Vijayanagara Administrative Terms**:
- **Athavana (अठवण)**: Central land revenue department.
- **Kandachara (कंदाचार)**: Military department presided over by the *Dandanayaka* (Commander-in-Chief).

- **Sist**: Standard land tax (fixed at 1/6th of gross agricultural yield based on land classification under Krishnadeva Raya).
- **Kavali**: Police duty; fees collected for village policing called *Kaval-katnam*.

6. The Medieval Battle Master Matrix (Chronological Ladder)

YEAR	BATTLE NAME	CONTENDERS	VICTORIOUS PARTY	HISTORICAL IMPACT / PRELIMS TAKEAWAY
1191	**First Battle of Tarain**	Prithviraj Chauhan III vs Muhammad Ghori	**Prithviraj Chauhan**	Ghori wounded, fled to Ghazni
1192	**Second Battle of Tarain**	Prithviraj Chauhan III vs Muhammad Ghori	**Muhammad Ghori**	Laid the foundation of Muslim rule in North India
1194	**Battle of Chandawar**	Muhammad Ghori vs Jaichand (Gahadavala King of Kannauj)	**Muhammad Ghori**	Kannauj & Banaras annexed; Chandawar near Firozabad (UP)
1526 (21 Apr)	**First Battle of Panipat**	Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi	**Babur**	First effective use of **Tulughma** tactic & artillery (*Topkhana*) in North India; Mughal Empire founded
1527 (16 Mar)	**Battle of Khanwa**	Babur vs Rana Sanga of Mewar	**Babur**	Babur declared it **Jihad**; assumed title of **Ghazi**; secured Mughal foothold
1528	**Battle of Chanderi**	Babur vs Medini Rai (Malwa chief)	**Babur**	Rajput women committed Jauhar; Babur captured Malwa forts
1529	**Battle of Ghaghra**	Babur vs Combined Afghan forces under Mahmud Lodi	**Babur**	First battle fought simultaneously on **land and river (water)**
1539 (26 Jun)	**Battle of Chausa**	Sher Khan (Sher Shah) vs Humayun	**Sher Khan**	Near Buxar (Bihar); Humayun saved by water carrier Nizam; Sher Khan took title **Sher Shah**
1540 (17 May)	**Battle of Kannauj (Bilgram)**	Sher Shah Suri vs Humayun	**Sher Shah Suri**	Humayun driven into 15-year exile in Persia; **Second Afghan Empire (Sur Empire)** established
1555	**Battle of Sirhind**	Humayun (led by Bairam Khan) vs Sikandar Shah Suri	**Humayun**	Restored Mughal dynasty in Delhi; Humayun died next year falling down stairs of Sher Mandal library
1556 (5 Nov)	**Second Battle of Panipat**	Akbar (regent Bairam Khan) vs Hemu (Hemchandra Vikramaditya)	**Akbar / Bairam Khan**	Hemu struck in eye by stray arrow; captured and beheaded; ended Sur Afghan resistance
1565 (23 Jan)	**Battle of Talikota (Rakshasi-Tangadi / Bannihatti)**	Vijayanagara (Aliya Rama Raya) vs Combined Deccan Sultanates (Bijapur, Golconda, Ahmadnagar, Bidar; **Berar absent!**)	**Deccan Sultanates**	Vijayanagara sacked and destroyed; shifted capital to Penukonda & Chandragiri (Aravidu dynasty)
1576 (18 Jun)	**Battle of Haldighati**	Mughal Army (Raja Man Singh of Amber & Asaf Khan) vs Maharana Pratap of Mewar	**Mughal Army** (indecisive strategic outcome)	Chetak (Pratap's horse) became legendary; Pratap continued guerrilla struggle from Kumbhalgarh/Chavand
1658 (15 Apr)	**Battle of Dharmat**	Aurangzeb & Murad vs Imperial Army (Jaswant Singh of Marwar & Qasim Khan)	**Aurangzeb**	Near Ujjain (MP); opened road to Agra
1658 (29 May)	**Battle of Samugarh**	Aurangzeb vs Dara Shikoh	**Aurangzeb**	Near Agra; decisive victory; Aurangzeb imprisoned Shah Jahan in Agra Fort
1659 (Apr)	**Battle of Deorai**	Aurangzeb vs Dara Shikoh	**Aurangzeb**	Near Ajmer; Dara captured, humiliated, executed
1761 (14 Jan)	**Third Battle of Panipat**	Marathas (Sadashivrao Bhau & Vishwasrao) vs Ahmad Shah Abdali (Durrani) & Shuja-ud-Daula (Awadh) & Najib-ud-Daula	**Ahmad Shah Abdali**	Annihilated Maratha leadership; cleared way for British dominance

7. Foreign Travellers & Visiting Rulers (Match the Following Goldmine)

FOREIGN TRAVELER	COUNTRY OF ORIGIN	PERIOD / CENTURY	INDIAN RULER / COURT VISITED	FAMOUS BOOK / KEY OBSERVATION
Al-Biruni (Abu Raihan)	Khwarizm (Uzbekistan)	11th c. (1017 CE)	Came with **Mahmud of Ghazni**	***Tahqiq-i-Hind* / *Kitab-ul-Hind***; deep study of Sanskrit, Hindu astronomy, philosophy, and caste system
Ibn Battuta	Tangier (Morocco)	14th c. (1333 CE)	**Muhammad bin Tughlaq**	***Rihla***; served as Qazi of Delhi for 8 years; sent as royal ambassador to China in 1342
Marco Polo	Venice (Italy)	13th c. (1292–94 CE)	**Pandya Kingdom** (Kayal port, King Maravarman Kulasekhara) & **Kakatiya** (Queen Rudramadevi)	*Travels of Marco Polo*; noted flourishing pearl fisheries and horse imports
Nicolo Conti	Venice (Italy)	15th c. (1420 CE)	**Deva Raya I** (Vijayanagara, Sangama Dynasty)	Described Vijayanagara fortifications, festivals of Navaratri and Deepavali
Abdur Razzaq	Herat (Persia)	15th c. (1443 CE)	**Deva Raya II** (Vijayanagara, Sangama Dynasty)	*Matla-us-Sadain*; observed: "*The city is such that eyes has not seen nor ear heard of any place resembling it upon the whole earth*"
Athanasius Nikitin	Tver (Russia)	15th c. (1470–74 CE)	**Bahmani Kingdom** (under Prime Minister Mahmud Gawan & Sultan Muhammad Shah III)	*The Journey Beyond Three Seas*; noted deep contrast between extreme luxury of nobles and wretched poverty of peasants
Duarte Barbosa	Portugal	16th c. (1518 CE)	**Krishnadeva Raya** (Vijayanagara, Tuluva Dynasty)	Detailed accounts of Vijayanagara trade, currency, customs, and Sati practice
Domingo Paes	Portugal	16th c. (1520–22 CE)	**Krishnadeva Raya** (Vijayanagara)	Described Krishnadeva Raya as "*a monarch who is gentle and wise, full of justice and equity*"; praised Mahanavami Dibba
Fernao Nuniz	Portugal	16th c. (1535–37 CE)	**Achyuta Deva Raya** (Vijayanagara, Tuluva Dynasty)	Horse trader; wrote detailed chronicle on founding of Vijayanagara and women's roles in royal court
Captain William Hawkins	England	1608–1611 CE	**Jahangir**	Reached Surat on *Hector*; spoke Turkish; Jahangir gave him title **"English Khan"** and 400 Mansab
Sir Thomas Roe	England	1615–1619 CE	**Jahangir**	Ambassador of King James I; secured imperial Farman for East India Company factories
Francisco Pelsaert	Netherlands (Dutch)	1620–1627 CE	**Jahangir**	***Remonstrantie***; detailed poverty of artisans and corruption of Mughal governors in Agra
Jean-Baptiste Tavernier	France	1640–1667 CE (6 voyages)	**Shah Jahan** & **Aurangzeb**	Professional gem merchant; famous for examining and describing the **Koh-i-Noor** diamond and Peacock Throne
Francois Bernier	France	1656–1668 CE	**Aurangzeb** (Physician to Dara Shikoh)	***Travels in the Mogul Empire***; argued absence of private property in land was cause of India's decline
Niccolao Manucci	Venice (Italy)	1653–1708 CE	**Dara Shikoh** & **Aurangzeb**	***Storia do Mogor***; served as artilleryman for Dara Shikoh; later practiced medicine in Lahore and Madras

8. Bhakti & Sufi Saints & Philosophies (Core Match Matrix)

A. Philosophers & Doctrines

PHILOSOPHER SAINT	PERIOD / CENTURY	PHILOSOPHY / DOCTRINE	CORE TENET	MATHAS / CENTER
Adi Shankaracharya	8th c. (788–820 CE)	**Advaita** (*Monism / Pure Non-dualism*)	*Brahma Satyam Jagan Mithya* (Brahman alone is real, world is illusion/Maya); Atman is identical to Brahman	Established 4 cardinal Mathas: **Joshimath (Badrikashram, North - Uttarakhand)**, Sringeri (South), Dwarka (West), Puri (East)
Ramanujacharya	11th–12th c. (1017–1137 CE)	**Vishishtadvaita** (*Qualified Non-dualism*)	Atman and world are real attributes (modes) of Brahman (Vishnu); Bhakti is path to Moksha	Srirangam (Tamil Nadu); Sri Vaishnavism
Madhvacharya	13th c. (1199–1278 CE)	**Dvaita** (*Dualism*)	Strict separation between God (Brahman) and individual Soul (Jiva); 5 eternal differences	Udupi (Karnataka); Brahma Sampradaya
Nimbarkacharya	13th c.	**Dvaitadvaita** (*Dualistic Non-dualism / Bhedabheda*)	God, soul, and world are both distinct and non-distinct; Radha-Krishna devotion	Sanaka Sampradaya (Vrindavan)
Vallabhacharya	15th–16th c. (1479–1531 CE)	**Shuddhadvaita** (*Pure Non-dualism*)	World is not an illusion but pure manifestation of Krishna; **Pushti Marga** (Grace of God)	Rudra Sampradaya (Varanasi / Braj)
Chaitanya Mahaprabhu	16th c. (1486–1534 CE)	**Achintya Bhedabheda** (*Inconceivable Oneness & Difference*)	Kirtana & Sankirtana movement; ecstatic love for Radha-Krishna	Nadia / Navadvip (Bengal)

A2. North Indian Bhakti saints — Birth and death (do not leave as "15th c." only)

North chain: **Namdev → Ramananda → Kabir → Nanak → Chaitanya → Surdas → Tulsidas → Dadu**.

SAINT	BIRTH–DEATH	PLACE / LANGUAGE	HIGH-YIELD
Namdev	**c. 1270–1350**	Maharashtra; verses also in Adi Granth	Varkari; Vithoba of Pandharpur
Ramananda	14th–15th c.	Banaras (UP)	Guru of Kabir and Ravidas; Rama-bhakti in the north
Kabir	15th c. (often **1398–1518** in coaching lists)	Born **Kashi / Varanasi**; died **Maghar** (Sant Kabir Nagar, UP)	Nirguna; *Bijak* (Ramaini, Sabda, Sakhi); weaver-saint. **Maghar ≠ Mathura**.
Guru Nanak	**1469–1539**	Talwandi (Nankana Sahib); died Kartarpur	First Sikh Guru; Nirguna; companion **Mardana**
Ravidas	15th–16th c.	Banaras (UP)	Ramananda circle; Dalit saint; verses in Adi Granth
Surdas	**c. 1478–1581**	**Braj** (Mathura–Vrindavan, UP)	Saguna Krishna; *Sursagar*; disciple of **Vallabhacharya**
Tulsidas	**1532–1623**	**Awadhi** belt (Rajapur / Banaras, UP)	*Ramcharitmanas* (Awadhi); Saguna Rama. Do not swap with Surdas.
Mirabai	**c. 1498–1546**	Rajasthan (Mewar) → later Dwarka tradition	Krishna devotee; **not** Andal (Tamil Alvar)
Dadu Dayal	**1544–1603**	Rajasthan	Nirguna; Dadu Panth

Logic: Tulsidas = **Awadhi Rama**. Surdas = **Braj Krishna**. Kabir died at **Maghar**, not Kashi. Nanak **1469–1539**, not a 12th-century Alvar.

B. Sufi Silsilahs (Orders) in India

SILSILAH	PROMINENT SAINTS	KEY CENTER / KHANQAH	KEY FEATURE / ATTITUDE TO STATE
Chishti (Most popular)	**Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti** (Ajmer - *Gharib Nawaz*), Bakhtiyar Kaki (Delhi), Baba Farid (Ajodhan - verses in Guru Granth Sahib), **Nizamuddin Auliya** (*Mehboob-i-Ilahi* - saw reigns of 7 Sultans), Nasiruddin Chirag-i-Delhi	Ajmer, Delhi, Punjab	Kept strict distance from royal court; practiced **Sama** (musical recitals) and poverty; vegetarianism
Suhrawardi	**Sheikh Bahauddin Zakariya** (Multan), Hamiduddin Nagori	Multan, Sindh, Bengal	Accepted royal patronage, land grants (*Inam*), and state offices; wealthy lifestyles
Qadiri	Sheikh Abdul Qadir Jilani, Shah Niamatullah, Miyan Mir (laid foundation stone of Golden Temple), **Dara Shikoh** & Jahanara	Punjab, Sindh, Agra	Moderate; Dara Shikoh authored *Majma-ul-Bahrain* (*Mingling of Two Oceans*) and translated Upanishads into Persian (*Sirr-i-Akbar*)
Naqshbandi	Khwaja Baqi Billah, **Sheikh Ahmad Sirhindi** (*Mujaddid Alf-i-Sani*)	Delhi, Sirhind	Orthodox and puritanical; strictly opposed *Sama*, opposed Akbar's liberal policies; propounded *Wahdat-ul-Shuhud*

9. Marathas & Shivaji's Administration

A. Shivaji's Ashtapradhan Council (Direct Matching Questions)

MEMBER	DESIGNATION / PORTFOLIO	PRIMARY FUNCTION
1. Peshwa	**Mukhya Pradhan** (Prime Minister)	Overall general administration; represented king in his absence
2. Amatya / Mazumdar	**Finance Minister** / Auditor	Audited all public and military accounts
3. Sachiv / Shurnavis	**Home / Royal Secretary**	Royal correspondence, checked official edicts and sanity of royal accounts
4. Mantri / Waqia-Navis	**Interior Minister / Chronicler**	Recorded daily proceedings of court, intelligence & espionage
5. Senapati / Sari-i-Naubat	**Commander-in-Chief**	Recruitment, military organization, and field operations
6. Sumant / Dabir	**Foreign Minister**	Managed diplomatic relations, embassies, and foreign visitors
7. Nyayadhish	**Chief Justice**	Civil and criminal justice administration
8. Panditrao / Danadhyaksha	**High Priest / Minister for Charities**	Religious affairs, endowments, grants, and penances

> **Note:** All members except **Nyayadhish** and **Panditrao** were required to lead military commands in times of war.

B. Core Maratha Terms

- **Chauth**: Levy of **one-fourth (25%)** of land revenue extracted from neighbouring territories to protect them from Maratha raids.
- **Sardeshmukhi**: Additional **10% levy** claimed by Shivaji in his capacity as hereditary supreme head (*Sardeshmukh*) of Maharashtra.
- **Mirasdars**: Hereditary landholders.
- **Bargirs**: Regular cavalry provided with horses and weapons by the state.
- **Silahdars**: Mercenary cavalrymen who brought their own horses and arms.
- **Treaty of Purandar (1665)**: Between Shivaji and Mughal General **Raja Jai Singh I** of Amber; Shivaji surrendered 23 out of 35 forts.
- **Coronation (1674)**: At **Raigad Fort** by pandit **Gaga Bhatt** of Varanasi; assumed titles **Chhatrapati** and *Haindava Dharmoddharak*.

Chapter 02: Chronology — Year-Wise Major Events (Medieval India)

Current Affairs & High-Yield Updates

YEAR/REF	KEY FACT	EXAM RELEVANCE
2023–2024	**350th Anniversary of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj's Coronation:** National celebrations at Raigad Fort (*Shiv Rajyabhisheka Sohala*)	Shivaji's formal Vedic coronation took place at Raigad on **6 June 1674**, officiated by **Gaga Bhatt** of Varanasi
Oct 2023	**500th Birth Anniversary of Rani Durgavati:** Celebrations in Jabalpur (MP); release of commemorative ₹500 silver coin	Rani Durgavati of Garha-Katanga (Gondwana) fought Akbar's general Asaf Khan heroically in **1564 CE**
Dec 2023	**Veer Bal Diwas (26 December):** National annual observance commemorating martyrdom of Guru Gobind Singh's Sahibzadas	Sahibzada Zorawar Singh and Fateh Singh bricked alive at Sirhind in **December 1704 CE**
Sept 2023	**Hoysala Sacred Ensembles (Belur, Halebid, Somnathapura):** Inscribed as India's **42nd UNESCO World Heritage Site**	High-density architectural chronology questions on 12th–13th century Hoysala temples under King Vishnuvardhana
2024	**Bhojshala Complex (Dhar, MP) ASI Survey:** Scientific investigation of 11th-century monument	Paramara King Bhoja (1010–1055 CE) established Bhojshala Sanskrit academy in **1035 CE** dedicated to Vagdevi

Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **712 CE:** Muhammad bin Qasim captures Debal and Multan, defeating Raja Dahir of Sind; marks the first Arab conquest and first levy of **Jizya** in the subcontinent.
2. **c. 750 CE:** Dantidurga founds the **Rashtrakuta dynasty** at Manyakheta, performing the *Hiranyagarbha* mahadana at Ujjain; Gopala is elected founder of the **Pala dynasty** in Bengal.
3. **c. 750–1000 CE: Tripartite Struggle (त्रिपक्षीय संघर्ष)** among the Palas (Bengal), Gurjara-Pratiharas (western India), and Rashtrakutas (Deccan) for imperial mastery over **Kannauj (Kanyakubja)**.
4. **836–885 CE:** Mihir Bhoja of the Gurjara-Pratiharas reigns from Kannauj, assuming the title **Adivaraha (आदिवराह)** and praised by Arab chronicler Sulaiman.
5. **949 CE: Battle of Takkolam** — Rashtrakuta King Krishna III decisively defeats the imperial Cholas, killing crown prince Rajaditya on elephant-back.
6. **985–1014 CE:** Reign of **Rajaraja I (Chola)**; defeats Chera navy at Kandalur Salai, conquers northern Sri Lanka, and completes the **Brihadishwara Temple (1010 CE)** at Thanjavur.
7. **1014–1044 CE:** Reign of **Rajendra I (Chola)**; conquers all of Sri Lanka (capturing King Mahendra V), defeats Mahipala of Bengal, founds **Gangaikondacholapuram (c. 1025 CE)**, and launches naval raids against Srivijaya/Kadaram.
8. **1000–1027 CE: Mahmud of Ghazni** leads 17 plundering expeditions into northern India; Abu Raihan **Al-Biruni** accompanies his campaigns (*Kitab-al-Hind*).
9. **1025–1026 CE:** Mahmud of Ghazni's most famous 16th expedition sacks the **Somnath Temple** in Gujarat during the reign of Solanki King Bhima I.
10. **1191 CE: First Battle of Tarain** — Rajput confederacy led by **Prithviraj Chauhan III** of Ajmer/Delhi decisively routs Mu'izz al-Din Muhammad Ghori.
11. **1192 CE: Second Battle of Tarain** — Muhammad Ghori returns with superior Turkish mounted archers and decisively crushes Prithviraj Chauhan, establishing Turkish rule in North India.
12. **1194 CE: Battle of Chandawar** — Muhammad Ghori defeats and slays **Jay Chandra**, the Gahadavala monarch of Kannauj and Varanasi.
13. **1206 CE:** Qutbuddin Aibak establishes the **Delhi Sultanate** at Lahore upon the assassination of Muhammad Ghori; initiates the **Slave (Mamluk) Dynasty (1206–1290 CE)**.
14. **1210–1236 CE: Shamsuddin Iltutmish** consolidates the Delhi Sultanate; shifts capital from Lahore to **Delhi**; introduces pure silver **Tanka (175 gr)** and copper **Jital**; institutes the corporate oligarchy of forty Turkish nobles (**Turkan-i-Chahalgani**).
15. **1221 CE: Genghis Khan** pursues Jalaluddin Mangbarani to the banks of the Indus; Iltutmish astutely refuses asylum, saving the nascent Sultanate from Mongol devastation.
16. **1236–1240 CE:** Reign of **Razia Sultan** — first and only sovereign female monarch of the Delhi Sultanate.
17. **1266–1287 CE:** Reign of **Ghiyasuddin Balban**; implements the ruthless **Blood and Iron policy (लौह एवं रक्त)**, liquidates the Chahalgani, and introduces Persian court etiquette (**Sijda, Paibos, Nauroz**).
18. **1290 CE: Khalji Revolution** — Jalaluddin Khalji overthrows the Slave dynasty, ending the monopoly of the Ilbari Turkish aristocracy and founding the **Khalji Dynasty (1290–1320 CE)**.
19. **1296–1316 CE:** Reign of **Alauddin Khalji**; fixes prices via **Shahna-i-Mandi** and Diwan-i-Riyasat, introduces horse-branding (**Dagh**) and troop rolls (**Chehra**), institutes 50% land tax based on measurement (**Masahat**).

20. **1301 CE & 1303 CE:** Alauddin Khalji captures **Ranthambore (1301)** from Hammiradeva and **Chittor (1303)** from Rana Ratan Singh (witnessing Rani Padmini's Jauhar).
21. **1309–1311 CE: Malik Kafur's** southern military blitzkrieg captures Devagiri (Yadavas), Warangal (Kakatiyas), Dvarasamudra (Hoysalas), and Madurai (Pandyas).
22. **1320 CE:** Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq (Ghazi Malik) slays Khusrau Khan and establishes the **Tughlaq Dynasty (1320–1414 CE)**, the longest-ruling dynasty of the Delhi Sultanate (94 years).
23. **1325–1351 CE:** Reign of **Muhammad bin Tughlaq (Jauna Khan)**; launches five radical experiments: Doab tax hike (1326), capital transfer to Daulatabad (1327), token copper currency (1329–30), Khurasan expedition (1330), Qarachil expedition (1330–31).
24. **1336 CE:** Foundation of the **Vijayanagara Empire** on the Tungabhadra by brothers **Harihara I and Bukka I** (Sangama dynasty) under the spiritual guidance of sage Vidyaranya.
25. **1347 CE:** Foundation of the **Bahmani Kingdom** at Gulbarga by **Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah (Hasan Gangu)** in rebellion against Muhammad bin Tughlaq.
26. **1351–1388 CE:** Reign of **Firoz Shah Tughlaq**; builds extensive canal networks, founds cities (Jaunpur, Firozabad, Hissar), levies irrigation tax (**Haqq-i-Sharb**), and imposes **Jizya on Brahmins**.
27. **1398 CE:** Central Asian conqueror **Amir Timur (Tamerlane)** invades India, sacking and massacring Delhi during the reign of Nasiruddin Mahmud Tughlaq.
28. **1414 CE:** Khizr Khan founds the **Sayyid Dynasty (1414–1451 CE)** as a Timurid viceroy, assuming the modest title *Raiyat-i-Ala*.
29. **1451 CE:** Bahlul Lodi founds the **Lodi Dynasty (1451–1526 CE)**, the first Afghan dynasty in India; introduces the heavy copper *Bahloli* coin.
30. **1489–1517 CE:** Reign of **Sikandar Lodi**; founds the city of **Agra in 1504 CE** (made capital in 1506), introduces the 39-digit measuring yard **Gaz-i-Sikandari**, and composes Persian poetry under pen-name *Gulrukhi*.
31. **1509–1529 CE:** Zenith of the Vijayanagara Empire under **Krishnadeva Raya (Tuluva dynasty)**; author of Telugu statecraft epic *Amuktamalyada*; patron of the *Ashtadiggajas*.
32. **21 April 1526: First Battle of Panipat** — Zahiruddin Muhammad **Babur** defeats and slays **Ibrahim Lodi** using Ottoman *Tulughma* and gun-carts (*Araba*), founding the **Mughal Empire**.
33. **16 March 1527: Battle of Khanwa** — Babur crushes the Rajput confederacy led by **Rana Sanga** of Mewar, declaring Jihad and assuming the title **Ghazi**.
34. **26 June 1539: Battle of Chausa** — Afghan leader Sher Khan routs **Humayun** on the banks of the Ganges, assuming the imperial title **Sher Shah**.
35. **17 May 1540: Battle of Kannauj (Bilgram)** — Sher Shah Suri decisively defeats Humayun, expelling the Mughals and establishing the **Second Afghan Empire (1540–1555 CE)**.
36. **1540–1545 CE:** Administrative zenith of **Sher Shah Suri**; builds the **Grand Trunk Road (Sadak-i-Azam)** from Sonargaon to the Indus, introduces the pure silver **Rupiya (178 gr)** and copper **Dam (380 gr)**, and institutes land measurement (**Patta & Qabuliyat**).
37. **22 May 1545:** Sher Shah fatally burned by an accidental gunpowder explosion (*Uqqa*) during the siege of **Kalinjar Fort (Banda, UP)**.
38. **22 June 1555: Battle of Sirhind** — Humayun and Bairam Khan defeat Sikandar Suri, restoring the Mughal dynasty to Delhi.
39. **5 November 1556: Second Battle of Panipat** — 13-year-old **Akbar** (guided by regent Bairam Khan) defeats Hemu (Hemchandra Vikramaditya), securing the Mughal restoration.
40. **1564 CE:** Akbar formally abolishes the religious poll tax **Jizya** on non-Muslim subjects (reimposed 115 years later by Aurangzeb in 1679).
41. **23 January 1565: Battle of Talikota (Rakshasi-Tangadi)** — The combined confederacy of four Deccan Sultanates (Bijapur, Ahmadnagar, Golconda, Bidar; **Berar was ABSENT**) destroys the army of Vijayanagara, slaying regent Rama Raya and sacking Hampi.
42. **18 June 1576: Battle of Haldighati** — Imperial Mughal army led by Raja Man Singh of Amber clashes with **Maharana Pratap** of Mewar; Pratap sustains heroic resistance from the Aravalli hills.
43. **1579 CE & 1582 CE:** Akbar issues the **Mahzar** (Infallibility Decree) in September 1579, assuming supreme arbiter status (*Imam-i-Adil*), and promulgates the syncretic ethical code **Din-i-Ilahi** in 1582.
44. **1580 CE:** Introduction of the **Dahsala / Zabt System** of land revenue by Akbar's finance minister **Raja Todar Mal**, basing revenue on 10-year average crop yields and price indices.
45. **1600 CE:** Charter granted by Queen Elizabeth I establishing the English East India Company on 31 December 1600 (during the reign of Akbar).
46. **1606 CE:** Execution of the 5th Sikh Guru, **Guru Arjan Dev**, at Lahore by order of Emperor Jahangir; Guru Hargobind constructs the **Akal Takht** and adopts the twin swords of **Miri and Piri**.
47. **6 June 1674:** Formal coronation of **Shivaji Maharaj** as *Chhatrapati* at **Raigad Fort** by Varanasi scholar **Gaga Bhatt**; took title *Haidava Dharmoddharak* and initiated the *Rajyabhisheka Shaka* era.
48. **24 November 1675:** Execution of the 9th Sikh Guru, **Guru Tegh Bahadur** (*Hind ki Chadar*), at Chandni Chowk, Delhi, by order of Aurangzeb; site marked by Gurdwara Sis Ganj Sahib.
49. **13 April 1699: Guru Gobind Singh** establishes the **Khalsa** at Anandpur Sahib on Baisakhi day, ordaining the Panj Pyare and the Five Ks.

50. **3 March 1707:** Demise of Emperor **Aurangzeb (Alamgir)** at Ahmadnagar after a 49-year reign; initiates the rapid decline of the Mughal Empire and rise of autonomous regional kingdoms.

⏱️ Timeline / Chronology

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[712 CE] Muhammad bin Qasim in Sind (First Jizya in India)
   │
[c. 750–1000 CE] Tripartite Struggle for Kannauj (Palas ⚔ Gurjara-Pratiharas ⚔ Rashtrakutas)
   │
[1000–1027 CE] Mahmud of Ghazni's 17 Raids (Somnath Sacked 1025–26 CE)
   │
[1191–1192 CE] Battles of Tarain I (Prithviraj wins) & II (Ghori wins) → Chandawar (1194 CE)
   │
[1206–1290 CE] Slave / Mamluk Dynasty (Aibak 1206 → Iltutmish 1210 → Razia 1236 → Balban 1266)
   │
[1290–1320 CE] Khalji Dynasty (Alauddin 1296–1316: Market reforms, Dagh-Chehra, Southern conquests)
   │
[1320–1414 CE] Tughlaq Dynasty (Ghiyasuddin 1320 → MBT 1325–51 → Firoz Tughlaq 1351–88; Timur 1398)
   │       ├── [1336 CE] Vijayanagara Empire founded by Harihara & Bukka
   │       └── [1347 CE] Bahmani Kingdom founded by Hasan Gangu
   │
[1414–1451 CE] Sayyid Dynasty (Khizr Khan → Mubarak Shah → Alam Shah)
   │
[1451–1526 CE] Lodi Dynasty (Bahlul 1451 → Sikandar Lodi [Agra 1504] → Ibrahim Lodi)
   │
[1526–1530 CE] Babur founds Mughal Empire (Panipat I 1526 ⚔ Khanwa 1527 ⚔ Chanderi 1528 ⚔ Ghaghra 1529)
   │
[1540–1555 CE] Sur Interregnum (Sher Shah Suri 1540–45: GT Road, Silver Rupiya, Kalinjar 1545)
   │
[1556–1605 CE] Akbar's Golden Age (Panipat II 1556 ⚔ Jizya Abolished 1564 ⚔ Haldighati 1576 ⚔ Dahsala 1580)
   │       └── [1565 CE] Battle of Talikota (Vijayanagara destroyed by Deccan Alliance)
   │
[1605–1627 CE] Jahangir (Zanjir-i-Adil; Guru Arjan executed 1606; Sir Thomas Roe 1615)
   │
[1628–1658 CE] Shah Jahan (Taj Mahal, Red Fort; War of Succession 1658: Dharmat & Samugarh)
   │
[1658–1707 CE] Aurangzeb (Reimposes Jizya 1679; Guru Tegh Bahadur martyred 1675; Bijapur 1686; Golconda 1687)
           ├── [1674 CE] Coronation of Shivaji Maharaj as Chhatrapati at Raigad
           ├── [1699 CE] Foundation of the Khalsa by Guru Gobind Singh
           └── [3 Mar 1707] Demise of Aurangzeb at Ahmadnagar (Ends Medieval Era)
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Complete Year-by-Year Chronological Ladder (712–1707 CE)

YEAR / ERA	HISTORICAL EVENT	RULING PERSONALITIES / DYNASTIES	CRUCIAL PRELIMINARY EXAM ANCHOR
712 CE	Arab Conquest of Sind	Muhammad bin Qasim vs Raja Dahir	First Muslim foothold in India; first levy of Jizya; *Chachnama* chronicle
753 CE	Foundation of Rashtrakutas	Dantidurga at Manyakheta	Performed *Hiranyagarbha* at Ujjain; built Ellora Cave 16 (Krishna I)
788 CE	Traditional Birth of Adi Shankara	Kaladi (Kerala)	Propounded Advaita Vedanta; established four cardinal mathas
c. 836–885	Zenith of Gurjara-Pratiharas	Mihir Bhoja (Kannauj)	Assumed title *Adivaraha*; praised by Arab merchant Sulaiman
850 CE	Rise of Imperial Cholas	Vijayalaya at Thanjavur	Captured Thanjavur from Muttaraiyars; built temple to Nisumbhasudini
949 CE	Battle of Takkolam	Krishna III (Rashtrakuta) vs Rajaditya	Shattered Chola power for 30 years; crown prince killed on elephant
1010 CE	Brihadishwara Temple consecrated	Rajaraja I (Chola) at Thanjavur	216-foot Dravidian granite vimana; single 80-tonne granite dome
1025–1026	Somnath Temple Sacked	Mahmud of Ghazni vs Bhima I (Solanki)	16th expedition of Mahmud; Al-Biruni arrived with Ghaznavids
c. 1025 CE	Gangaikondacholapuram founded	Rajendra I (Chola)	Built to commemorate victorious Ganga expedition to Bengal
1191 CE	First Battle of Tarain	Prithviraj Chauhan vs Muhammad Ghori	Decisive Rajput victory; Ghori wounded and spared
1192 CE	Second Battle of Tarain	Muhammad Ghori vs Prithviraj Chauhan	Decisive Turkish victory; opened North India to Islamic rule
1194 CE	Battle of Chandawar	Muhammad Ghori vs Jay Chandra	Gahadavala king killed; Turkish rule extends to Kannauj & Varanasi
1206 CE	Foundation of Delhi Sultanate	Qutbuddin Aibak at Lahore	Slave (Mamluk) dynasty begins; Quwwat-ul-Islam mosque started
1210 CE	Death of Qutbuddin Aibak	Lahore	Died playing Chaugan (Polo); buried at Lahore
1211–1236	Reign of Iltutmish	Delhi	Real consolidator; Silver Tanka (175 gr) & Copper Jital; Chalisa
1221 CE	Mongol Threat on Indus	Genghis Khan vs Jalaluddin Mangbarani	Iltutmish denied shelter to Mangbarani, saving Sultanate from destruction
1236–1240	Reign of Razia Sultan	Delhi	First female monarch of Delhi; murdered near Kaithal in 1240
1266–1287	Reign of Ghiyasuddin Balban	Delhi	Blood and Iron policy; Sijda, Paibos, Nauroz; destroyed Chahalgani
1290 CE	Khalji Revolution	Jalaluddin Khalji	Ended Turkish racial exclusivity; founded Khalji Dynasty
1296–1316	Reign of Alauddin Khalji	Delhi (Siri Fort)	Market control (Shahna-i-Mandi); Dagh & Chehra; Masahat (50% tax)
1301 CE	Siege of Ranthambore	Alauddin Khalji vs Hammiradeva	First recorded Rajput Jauhar in Persian chronicles; Amir Khusrau present
1303 CE	Siege of Chittor	Alauddin Khalji vs Rana Ratan Singh	Rani Padmini's Jauhar; Chittor renamed Khizrabad
1309–1311	Deccan Campaigns of Malik Kafur	Devagiri, Warangal, Halebid, Madurai	Extracted tribute, gold, and Koh-i-Noor diamond for Alauddin
1320 CE	Foundation of Tughlaq Dynasty	Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq (Ghazi Malik)	Longest-ruling Sultanate dynasty (94 yrs); built Tughlaqabad Fort
1325–1351	Reign of Muhammad bin Tughlaq	Delhi / Daulatabad	Token currency, capital transfer, Diwan-i-Kohi; Ibn Battuta visited
1336 CE	Vijayanagara Empire Founded	Harihara I & Bukka I on Tungabhadra	Hindu empire in Deccan; Sangama, Saluva, Tuluva, Aravidu dynasties

YEAR / ERA	HISTORICAL EVENT	RULING PERSONALITIES / DYNASTIES	CRUCIAL PRELIMINARY EXAM ANCHOR
1347 CE	Bahmani Kingdom Founded	Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah at Gulbarga	First independent Muslim kingdom in Deccan
1351–1388	Reign of Firoz Shah Tughlaq	Delhi	Canals, Jaunpur city founded, Jizya on Brahmins, Diwan-i-Bandagan
1398 CE	Timur Sacks Delhi	Nasiruddin Mahmud Tughlaq	Fatal blow to Tughlaq dynasty; general massacre of Delhi citizens
1414–1451	Sayyid Dynasty	Khizr Khan → Mubarak Shah → Alam Shah	Ruled as Timurid deputies; Yahya Sirhindi's *Tarikh-i-Mubarak Shahi*
1451–1526	Lodi Dynasty	Bahlul → Sikandar → Ibrahim Lodi	First Afghan dynasty; Bahloli coins
1469 CE	Birth of Guru Nanak Dev	Talwandi (Nankana Sahib)	Founder of Sikhism; Sangat and Pangat institutions
1498 CE	Vasco da Gama reaches Calicut	Zamorin of Calicut	Discovered direct sea route from Europe to India via Cape of Good Hope
1504 CE	Agra Founded by Sikandar Lodi	Sikandar Lodi	Made capital in 1506; introduced Gaz-i-Sikandari (39 digits)
1509–1529	Golden Age of Vijayanagara	Krishnadeva Raya (Tuluva)	*Amuktamalyada*, Ashtadiggajas, Hazara Rama and Vittala temples
1526 CE	First Battle of Panipat (21 April)	Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi	Babur deployed Tulughma and gun-carts; ended Delhi Sultanate
1527 CE	Battle of Khanwa (16 March)	Babur vs Rana Sanga (Mewar)	Babur assumed title Ghazi; shattered united Rajput confederacy
1528 CE	Battle of Chanderi	Babur vs Medini Rai	Chanderi fort captured; Rajput women performed Jauhar
1529 CE	Battle of Ghaghra	Babur vs Mahmud Lodi (Afghans)	Fought on land and water; secured eastern frontier for Mughals
1530 CE	Death of Babur / Humayun ascends	Agra	Babur buried in Kabul; Humayun inherited unstable empire
1539 CE	Battle of Chausa (26 June)	Sher Khan vs Humayun	Sher Khan assumed title Sher Shah; Nizam water-carrier saved Humayun
1540 CE	Battle of Kannauj / Bilgram (17 May)	Sher Shah Suri vs Humayun	Humayun driven into exile; Second Afghan Empire founded (1540–55)
1540–1545	Reign of Sher Shah Suri	Delhi / Sasaram	Grand Trunk Road, silver Rupiya (178 gr), 47 Sarkars, Patta & Qabuliyat
1545 CE	Death of Sher Shah at Kalinjar	Kalinjar Fort (Banda, UP)	Accidental gunpowder explosion (*Uqqa*); succeeded by Islam Shah
1555 CE	Battle of Sirhind / Humayun restored	Humayun vs Sikandar Suri	Sur dynasty overthrown; Humayun restored to Delhi throne
1556 CE	Second Battle of Panipat (5 Nov)	Akbar (Bairam Khan) vs Hemu	Hemu struck by arrow; cemented Mughal restoration in North India
1564 CE	Jizya Abolished by Akbar	Akbar	Abolished religious poll tax on non-Muslim subjects
1565 CE	Battle of Talikota (23 Jan)	Deccan Alliance vs Vijayanagara	Rama Raya killed; Hampi sacked; Berar was ABSENT from alliance
1571–1585	Fatehpur Sikri Imperial Capital	Akbar	Buland Darwaza (1601–02), Panch Mahal, Diwan-i-Khas, Salim Chishti Tomb
1575 CE	Ibadat Khana Established	Akbar at Fatehpur Sikri	Hall of religious debates; universal peace (*Sulh-i-Kul*)
1576 CE	Battle of Haldighati (18 June)	Man Singh (Mughals) vs Maharana Pratap	Pratap sustained guerrilla warfare from hills; Chetak horse memorial
1579 CE	The Mahzar (Infallibility Decree)	Akbar	Drafted by Sheikh Mubarak; made Akbar supreme arbiter (*Imam-i-Adil*)
1580 CE	Dahsala / Zabt System introduced	Raja Todar Mal (Akbar's minister)	10-year average yield assessment; state demand 1/3rd in cash
1582 CE	Din-i-Ilahi Promulgated	Akbar	Syncretic ethical code; Birbal was the only Hindu to accept

YEAR / ERA	HISTORICAL EVENT	RULING PERSONALITIES / DYNASTIES	CRUCIAL PRELIMINARY EXAM ANCHOR
1600 CE	British East India Company chartered	Queen Elizabeth I (31 Dec 1600)	During the reign of Mughal Emperor Akbar
1604 CE	Adi Granth Compiled	Guru Arjan Dev	Installed in Harmandir Sahib; Baba Buddha first Granthi
1605 CE	Death of Akbar; Jahangir ascends	Agra	Akbar buried at Sikandra; Jahangir installed Chain of Justice
1606 CE	Martyrdom of Guru Arjan Dev	Jahangir	First Sikh martyr; Guru Hargobind built Akal Takht (1606)
1615 CE	Sir Thomas Roe arrives at court	Jahangir at Ajmer	Ambassador of King James I; obtained imperial trade concessions
1627–1628	Death of Jahangir; Shah Jahan ascends	Agra / Shahjahanabad	Golden Age of Mughal Architecture began; Jahangir buried in Lahore
1631–1648	Construction of Taj Mahal	Shah Jahan at Agra	Dedicated to Mumtaz Mahal; chief architect Ustad Ahmad Lahori
1658 CE	War of Succession	Aurangzeb vs Dara Shikoh	Dharmat (Apr 1658) ⚔ Samugarh (May 1658) ⚔ Deorai (Mar 1659)
1658–1707	Reign of Aurangzeb (Alamgir)	Delhi / Deccan	Title *Alamgir*; banned court music, Nauroz; appointed Muhtasibs
1665 CE	Treaty of Purandar (11 June)	Mirza Raja Jai Singh I vs Shivaji	Shivaji surrendered 23 of 35 forts to Mughals
1666 CE	Shivaji escapes from Agra (17 Aug)	Agra	Dramatic escape in sweet baskets from house arrest in Ram Singh's haveli
1674 CE	Coronation of Shivaji (6 June)	Raigad Fort	Formally crowned *Chhatrapati* by Gaga Bhatt of Varanasi
1675 CE	Martyrdom of Guru Tegh Bahadur	Aurangzeb at Chandni Chowk	Executed for defending Kashmiri Pandits; Gurdwara Sis Ganj Sahib
1679 CE	Reimposition of Jizya	Aurangzeb	Reimposed poll tax on non-Muslim subjects 115 yrs after Akbar
1686–1687	Annexation of Bijapur & Golconda	Aurangzeb in Deccan	Bijapur annexed in 1686; Golconda annexed in 1687
1699 CE	Foundation of the Khalsa (13 April)	Guru Gobind Singh at Anandpur Sahib	Ordained Panj Pyare, surname Singh/Kaur, and Five Ks
1707 CE	Demise of Aurangzeb (3 March)	Ahmadnagar (buried Khuldabad)	Ends the Great Mughal era; marks transition to Modern Indian history

📊 Quick Reference Grid

1. Master Battle Chronology (712–1707 CE)

BATTLE NAME	YEAR / DATE	BELLIGERENTS	VICTOR / OUTCOME	HISTORIC MILESTONE
Battle of Rawar	712 CE	Muhammad bin Qasim vs Raja Dahir of Sind	**Qasim won**	First Islamic conquest in India; Jizya imposed
Battle of Takkolam	949 CE	Krishna III (Rashtrakuta) vs Rajaditya (Chola)	**Rashtrakuta won**	Chola crown prince killed; Chola empire checked
First Battle of Tarain	1191 CE	Prithviraj Chauhan vs Muhammad Ghori	**Prithviraj won**	Ghori wounded and routed; spared by Rajputs
Second Battle of Tarain	1192 CE	Muhammad Ghori vs Prithviraj Chauhan	**Ghori won**	Decisive Turkish victory; opened North India
Battle of Chandawar	1194 CE	Muhammad Ghori vs Jay Chandra (Gahadavala)	**Ghori won**	Jay Chandra killed; Turkish power over Kannauj/Kashi
Battle of Amroha	1305 CE	Alauddin Khalji vs Mongols (Ali Beg & Tartaq)	**Alauddin won**	Crushing Mongol defeat in Western UP
First Battle of Panipat	**21 Apr 1526**	Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi	**Babur won**	Babur used *Tulughma* & *Araba*; Sultanate ended
Battle of Khanwa	**16 Mar 1527**	Babur vs Rana Sanga (Mewar)	**Babur won**	Babur took title *Ghazi*; crushed Rajput challenge
Battle of Chanderi	1528 CE	Babur vs Medini Rai	**Babur won**	Fortress captured; Rajput Jauhar
Battle of Ghaghra	1529 CE	Babur vs Mahmud Lodi (Eastern Afghans)	**Babur won**	Fought on land and river; eastern frontier secured
Battle of Chausa	26 June 1539	Sher Khan vs Humayun	**Sher Khan won**	Sher Khan assumed royal title *Sher Shah*
Battle of Kannauj (Bilgram)	17 May 1540	Sher Shah Suri vs Humayun	**Sher Shah won**	Humayun driven into 15-year exile; Sur empire
Battle of Giri-Sumel	1544 CE	Sher Shah Suri vs Jaita & Kumpa (Marwar)	**Sher Shah won**	Narrow victory: *"For a handful of bajra..."*
Battle of Sirhind	22 June 1555	Humayun & Bairam Khan vs Sikandar Suri	**Humayun won**	Sur dynasty overthrown; Mughal restoration
Second Battle of Panipat	**5 Nov 1556**	Young Akbar (Bairam Khan) vs Hemu	**Akbar won**	Hemu struck by arrow; ended Sur challenge
Battle of Talikota	**23 Jan 1565**	Deccan Sultanates vs Vijayanagara (Rama Raya)	**Deccan won**	Vijayanagara destroyed; **Berar was ABSENT**
Battle of Haldighati	**18 June 1576**	Man Singh (Mughals) vs Maharana Pratap	**Mughal tactical win**	Pratap sustained guerrilla war from hills
Battle of Dharmat	15 Apr 1658	Aurangzeb & Murad vs Raja Jaswant Singh	**Aurangzeb won**	Paved Aurangzeb's advance to imperial Agra
Battle of Samugarh	**29 May 1658**	Aurangzeb & Murad vs Dara Shikoh	**Aurangzeb won**	Decisive war of succession battle; Dara routed
Battle of Deorai	Mar 1659	Aurangzeb vs Dara Shikoh	**Aurangzeb won**	Final defeat and capture of Dara Shikoh
Battle of Salher	Feb 1672	Marathas (Moro Pant) vs Mughals	**Marathas won**	First decisive Maratha open-field cavalry victory

2. Dynastic Succession Ladders of Medieval India

EMPIRE / RULING DYNASTY	STRICT CHRONOLOGICAL SEQUENCE OF RULERS	MEMORY TRICK / KEY LOCK
Delhi Sultanate Dynasties	**Slave (1206–90) → Khalji (1290–1320) → Tughlaq (1320–1414) → Sayyid (1414–51) → Lodi (1451–1526)**	**S–K–T–S–L** (Longest = Tughlaq 94 yrs; Shortest = Khalji 30 yrs)
Slave / Mamluk Dynasty	Qutbuddin Aibak → Iltutmish → Ruknuddin → Razia → Bahram → Masud → Nasiruddin Mahmud → **Balban** → Kaiqubad → Kayumars	Aibak (founder) → Iltutmish (consolidator) → Balban (iron policy)
Khalji Dynasty	Jalaluddin Khalji → **Alauddin Khalji** → Shihabuddin Umar → Qutbuddin Mubarak Khalji → Khusrau Khan (usurper)	Alauddin peak (1296–1316)
Tughlaq Dynasty	Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq → **Muhammad bin Tughlaq** → **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** → Ghiyasuddin II → Abu Bakr → Nasiruddin Mahmud	Timur sacked Delhi (1398) under Nasiruddin Mahmud
Lodi Dynasty	Bahlul Lodi → **Sikandar Lodi** → **Ibrahim Lodi**	First Afghan Dynasty; ended at Panipat I (1526)
Vijayanagara Dynasties	**Sangama (1336–1485) → Saluva (1485–1505) → Tuluva (1505–1570) → Aravidu (1570–1646)**	**S–S–T–A** (Krishnadeva Raya belonged to Tuluva)
Great Mughals	**Babur (1526–30) → Humayun (1530–40, 1555–56) → Akbar (1556–1605) → Jahangir (1605–27) → Shah Jahan (1628–58) → Aurangzeb (1658–1707)**	**B–H–A–J–S–A** (Humayun broke by Sur interregnum 1540–55)
Sikh Gurus	**Nanak → Angad → Amar Das → Ram Das → Arjan Dev → Hargobind → Har Rai → Har Krishan → Tegh Bahadur → Gobind Singh**	**N–A–A–R–A–H–H–H–T–G**

🧠 Memory Anchors & Mnemonics

1. **The Three Battles of Panipat Memory Lock:** - **Panipat I (21 Apr 1526):** Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi (Founded Mughal Empire). - **Panipat II (5 Nov 1556):** Akbar (Bairam Khan) vs Hemu (Restored Mughal Empire). - **Panipat III (14 Jan 1761):** Ahmad Shah Abdali vs Marathas (Shattered Maratha Dream).
2. **The Three Historic Jauhars of Chittor:** - **1303:** Against Alauddin Khalji (Rani Padmini). - **1535:** Against Bahadur Shah of Gujarat (Rani Karnavati). - **1568:** Against Akbar (Jaimal and Patta defense).
3. **Akbar's Grand Chronological Sequence (1562–1582):** - 1562: End of slave enslavement in war - 1563: Abolition of Pilgrimage Tax - 1564: Abolition of Jizya - 1571: Foundation of Fatehpur Sikri - 1575: Establishment of Ibadat Khana - 1576: Battle of Haldighati - 1579: The Mahzar (Infallibility Decree) - 1580: Dahsala (Zabt) land system - 1582: Promulgation of Din-i-Ilahi
4. **War of Succession Battles Hook: B–D–S–K–D** - **B**ahadurpur (Feb 1658) → **D**harmat (Apr 1658) → **S**amugarh (May 1658) → **K**hajwa (Jan 1659) → **D**eorai (Mar 1659).

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill

> **Mastery Rule:** Read the consolidated facts above, attempt these high-yield questions, and score ≥80% to conquer this chapter.

Q1. Arrange the dynasties of the Delhi Sultanate in correct chronological order:

1. Tughlaq dynasty
2. Slave (Mamluk) dynasty
3. Lodi dynasty
4. Khalji dynasty

A. 2, 4, 1, 3 B. 2, 1, 4, 3 C. 2, 4, 3, 1 D. 4, 2, 1, 3

▶ Details

Q3. Arrange the following Mughal and Maratha historical markers in chronological order:

1. Second Battle of Panipat
2. First Battle of Panipat
3. Battle of Haldighati
4. Coronation of Shivaji

A. 2, 1, 3, 4 B. 2, 3, 1, 4 C. 1, 2, 3, 4 D. 2, 1, 4, 3

▶ Details

Q5. Arrange the following Akbar-era markers in chronological order:

1. Promulgation of Din-i-Ilahi (Tauhid-i-Ilahi)

2. Second Battle of Panipat
3. Battle of Haldighati
4. Construction of Fatehpur Sikri and Ibadat Khana

A. 2, 4, 3, 1 B. 2, 3, 4, 1 C. 2, 4, 1, 3 D. 4, 2, 3, 1

▶ Details

Q7. Arrange the following Vijayanagara–Bahmani markers in chronological order:

1. Battle of Talikota (Rakshasi-Tangadi)
2. Foundation of Vijayanagara Empire
3. Foundation of Bahmani Kingdom
4. Krishnadevaraya's reign peak

A. 2, 3, 4, 1 B. 2, 3, 1, 4 C. 3, 2, 4, 1 D. 2, 4, 3, 1

▶ Details

Q9. Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): The Second Battle of Tarain in 1192 established Turkish Muslim political power in north India.

Reason (R): The First Battle of Tarain in 1191 was won by Muhammad Ghori.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A) B. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) C. (A) is true, but (R) is false D. (A) is false, but (R) is true

▶ Details

Q11. Arrange the following events of Alauddin Khalji's reign in chronological order:

1. Malik Kafur's deep southern expeditions (Warangal, Dwarasamudra, Madurai)
2. Accession of Alauddin Khalji
3. Capture of Chittor
4. End of the Khalji dynasty

A. 2, 3, 1, 4 B. 2, 1, 3, 4 C. 3, 2, 1, 4 D. 2, 3, 4, 1

▶ Details

Q13. Arrange the following 14th-century events in chronological order:

1. Timur's invasion of India
2. Accession of Muhammad bin Tughlaq
3. Reign of Firoz Shah Tughlaq
4. Foundation of Vijayanagara Empire

A. 2, 4, 3, 1 B. 2, 3, 4, 1 C. 4, 2, 3, 1 D. 2, 4, 1, 3

▶ Details

Q15. correctly matched?

A. Somnath expedition (1025 CE) — Mahmud of Ghazni B. Battle of Talikota (1565) — Babur C. Second Battle of Panipat (1556) — Akbar / Bairam Khan D. Foundation of the Khalsa (1699) — Guru Gobind Singh

▶ Show answer

Chapter 03: Early Medieval (प्रारंभिक मध्यकाल) India (Regional Kingdoms)

📰 Current Affairs & High-Yield Updates

YEAR/REF	KEY FACT	EXAM RELEVANCE
Sept 2023	**Sacred Ensembles of the Hoysalas** (Belur, Halebid, Somnathapura) inscribed as India's **42nd UNESCO World Heritage Site**	UPPCS tests Hoysala stellate (star-shaped) temple architecture, chloritic schist (soapstone) carvings, King Vishnuvardhana & Queen Shantala
2024	**Bhojshala Complex (Dhar, MP)** ASI scientific survey ordered by MP High Court; dedicated to Goddess Saraswati (Vagdevi)	Paramara King Bhoja (1010–1055 CE) founded Bhojshala Sanskrit college; wrote *Samarangana Sutradhara* and *Saraswati Kanthabharana*
2023–2024	**Indian Navy's New Ensign & Seal** inspired by naval tradition of Rajendra I's maritime expedition & Chhatrapati Shivaji's Rajmudra	UPPCS tests Chola overseas conquest of Sri Lanka, Kadaram (Kedah/Srivijaya) & transforming Bay of Bengal into "Chola Lake"
2023–2024	**UP Tourism Bundelkhand Heritage Circuit:** Ecotourism development of **Kalinjar Fort** (Banda) and **Mahoba Veer Bhumi**	Jejakabhukti / Chandela strongholds (Kalinjar, Mahoba, Khajuraho) and heroes Alha-Udal under King Parmardi Deva
2024	**Sarnath Heritage Updates:** Conservation of Dharmachakra Jina Vihara remains	Inscription of Queen **Kumaradevi** (Buddhist wife of Gahadavala King Govindachandra of Kannauj/Banaras)

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. Early Medieval India runs roughly **750–1200 CE** after Harsha (हर्ष) as an age of regional kingdoms and hereditary **samantas** (सामंत), not the Delhi Sultanate (दिल्ली सल्तनत) that begins in **1206**.
2. The **Tripartite Struggle** for **Kannauj** (कन्नौज) was fought by the **Pala**, **Gurjara-Pratihara**, and **Rashtrakuta** (राष्ट्रकूट) powers — not by the Cholas.
3. In the south, imperial power rotated **Pallava** → **Chalukya** → **Rashtrakuta** → **Chola**.
4. The **Pallava** (पल्लव) capital was **Kanchi** (कांची); the **Pandya** capital was **Madurai** (मदुरै).
5. Early Chalukyas ruled from **Badami (बादामी) / Vatapi**; **Eastern Chalukyas** from **Vengi** (**Pedavegi** near **Eluru**, West Godavari (गोदावरी), Andhra); later Western Chalukyas from **Kalyani** — do not merge the three seats.
6. The **Rashtrakuta** capital was **Manyakheta** (Malkhed) in the Deccan (दक्कन).
7. The imperial **Chola** capital moved from **Thanjavur** (तंजावुर) to **Gangaikondacholapuram** under Rajendra I.
8. **Hoysala** power centred on **Halebid / Dvarasamudra**; **Kakatiya** on **Warangal** (वारंगल); **Yadava** on **Devagiri** (देवगिरी) (later Daulatabad).
9. Ruler–dynasty facts: **Mahendravarman** was Pallava; **Kadungon** (कडुंगों) was Pandya; **Amoghavarsha** was Rashtrakuta; **Rajaraja** was Chola.
10. Temple chronology runs **Shore Temple** (शोर मंदिर) (~7th, Pallava Mahabalipuram (महाबलीपुरम)) → **Brihadishwara** (बृहदीश्वर) (**1010**, Rajaraja at Thanjavur) → **Gangaikondacholapuram** (~**1025**, Rajendra).
11. Sena succession (उत्तराधिकार क्रम) order is **Hemant** → **Vijaya** → **Ballal** → **Lakshman**.
12. Chola administration ran **Mandalam (मंडलम)** → **Valanadu** → **Nadu (नाडु)** → **Village**, and the empire had **four** (चातुर्याम) mandalams at its peak.
13. **Ur** was the ordinary village assembly; **Sabha (सभा) / Mahasabha** was the Brahmana (ब्राह्मण) **agrahara** assembly.
14. The Chola navy struck **Sri Lanka**, the **Maldives**, and **Kadaram (Kedah)**; **Nagapattinam** was a key port (बंदरगाह); the Bay of Bengal was called a "**Chola Lake**."
15. In the Kannauj contest, **Dharmapala** (धर्मपाल) backed **Chakrayudha**; **Mihir Bhoja** (मिहिर भोज) recovered the city (~**836**); **Indra (इन्द्र) III** sacked it (**915–918**); **Krishna (कृष्ण) III** pressed again (**963**).
16. **Gopala** was elected Pala founder; **Dharmapala** founded **Vikramashila** (विक्रमशिला); **Devapala** marked the Pala peak; **Atisha** (अतीश) carried Buddhism (बौद्ध धर्म) toward Tibet.
17. Pratiharas moved from **Bhinmal** to **Kannauj**; **Nagabhatta I** checked the Arabs (अरब); **Mihir Bhoja** took the title **Adivaraha** (आदिवराह).
18. **Mihir Bhoja** (Pratihara (गुर्जर-प्रतिहार), Adivaraha, Kannauj) is not **Bhoja I** of the **Paramaras** at **Dhara** (धारा) in Malwa.
19. **Chandelas** held **Khajuraho (खजुराहो) / Mahoba / Kalinjar (कालिंजर)** in Bundelkhand; **Paramaras** held **Malwa / Dhara**.
20. **Gahadavalas** ruled **Kannauj and Banaras** in the 11th–12th century after Pratihara decline.
21. **Jay Chandra** of the Gahadavalas was killed at **Chandawar** (चंदावर) in **1194**.
22. UP medieval name facts: **Kannauj = Kanyakubja**; **Ayodhya (अयोध्या) = Saketa**; **Varanasi (वाराणसी) = Kashi (काशी) / Avimukta**.
23. **Mahoba** and **Kalinjar** (Banda district) are the Chandela strongholds in Bundelkhand **UP**.
24. **Kalachuris** ruled from **Tripuri** in the Chedi / Dahala belt.

25. **Pulakeshin II** (पुलकेशिन) of Badami defeated Harsha and left the **Aihole** (ऐहोल) prasasti; **Narasimhavarman I** took the title **Vatapikonda**.
26. The poet **Rajasekhara** (राजशेखर) lived at the courts of Pratihara **Mahendrapala I** and **Mahipala I** (*Karpuramanjari* (कर्पूरमंजरी), *Kavyamimamsa*, and related works).
27. Do not confuse **Kannauj (UP)** — the north sovereignty prize — with **Kanchi (TN)**, the Pallava capital.
28. Sena capital under Lakshman Sen is linked with **Nadia**; Pala seats stayed in the Bengal–Bihar belt with only episodic Kannauj holds.
29. Imperial Chola (साम्राज्य चोल) founder is **Vijayalaya** (विजयालय) (~**850**), not Rajaraja or Parantaka. **Parantaka I** took the title **Maduraikonda** after defeating the Madurai king.
30. **Battle of Takkolam (949)** — Rashtrakuta **Krishna III** led a confederacy that killed Chola prince **Rajaditya** (son of Parantaka I) and broke Chola power for a generation.
31. **Rajaraja I** (राजराज) created the standing **naval** arm, smashed the Chera fleet at **Kandalloor**, took **northern** Sri Lanka, and built **Brihadishwara** with its colossal **Nandi**.
32. **Rajendra I** took **whole Sri Lanka** (prisoner **Mahendra V**), defeated Pala **Mahipala**, founded **Gangaikondacholapuram**, built the artificial lake **Chola Gangam**, and made the Bay of Bengal a "**Chola Lake**."
33. Under **Kulottunga I**, a Chola Buddhist / merchant mission of **72** traders went to **China (1077)**; he accepted Sinhala independence under **Vijayabahu** and married a daughter to prince **Virapperumal**.
34. Chola village boards (**Variyam**): **Thotta** = gardens; **Samvatsara** = annual; **Eri** = tanks; **Pon** = gold / finance. **Uttaramerur** is the Sabha working-system inscription.
35. **Eripatti** (एरिपट्टी) = land whose revenue maintains the village tank. **Taniyur** (तनियूर) = a very large village administered as a single unit (not a Brahmana gift). **Ghatika** = temple-attached college.
36. Chola **Nataraja** (नटराज) bronzes show the dancing Shiva with **four** hands; **Dakshinamurti** (दक्षिणामूर्ति) is Shiva as **teacher**, installed facing **south**.
37. Pallava **Simhavishnu** took the title **Avanisimha**; **Narasimhavarman I** is **Mahamalla** / **Vatapikonda** and sent naval help to Ceylon (**642**); **Mahendravarman I** (महेन्द्रवर्मन) wrote *Mattavilasa Prahasana (प्रहसन)* (मत्तविलास प्रहसन).
38. **Pulakeshin I** founded the Badami / Vatapi Chalukya house. **Aihole** prasasti of **Ravikirti** names **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) and **Bharavi** (भारवि). Chalukyas appointed **women** to high office (**Vijaya Bhattarika**).
39. **Kadamba** capital was **Vanavasi**; founder **Mayurasharman**; the state was annexed by **Pulakeshin II**. Chera capital memory is **Vanchi / Karuvur**.
40. **Meenakshi** (मीनाक्षी) temple at Madurai is linked in tradition to **Kulasekara Pandya** (later rebuilt under Nayakas). **Motupalli** was the Kakatiya overseas port (Marco Polo).
41. Cholas commonly designated a **Yuvraj** (heir) during the reigning king's lifetime.
42. Sailendra / Srivijaya expedition under **Rajaraja I** and especially **Rajendra I** answered trade (पण्याध्यक्ष) obstruction toward China.
43. **Prithviraj (पृथ्वीराज) III** (Ajmer (अजमेर) Chauhan) won **First Tarain (तराइन) (1191)** and lost **Second Tarain (1192)** to Muhammad Ghori. **Vigraharaja IV** earlier took **Delhi** from the Tomaras.
44. **Anangpal Tomar** founded **Dhillika (Delhi)** in the 8th century as a Pratihara feudatory. **Jejakabhukti** (जेजाकभुक्ति) = ancient **Bundelkhand** (from Jeja / Jayashakti, Chandela).
45. Pala facts: **Gopala** (elected; **Odantapuri** (उदंतपुरी)); **Dharmapala** (**Vikramashila**, **Somapura / Paharpur**; title **Paramasaugata**); **Devapala** granted five villages for the **Sailendra / Balaputradeva** Nalanda (नालंदा) vihara (विहार).
46. **Kumaradevi** (queen of Govind Chandra Gahadavala) built the **Dharmachakra (धर्मचक्र) Jaina Vihara** at **Sarnath** (सारनाथ). **Lakshmidhara** wrote *Krityakalpataru*.
47. **Alha (आल्हा)–Udal** of **Mahoba** served Chandela **Parmardi / Paramardi**; struggle with Prithviraj appears in Chand Bardai's *Prithviraj Raso* (पृथ्वीराज रासो) and Jagnik's *Alha-khand* (*Parmal Raso*).
48. Kannauj medieval names include **Kanyakubja**, **Mahodaya**, and **Mahodaya Shri / Nagar Mahoday Shri**. **Koil** = Aligarh (अलीगढ़); **Mahotsava Nagar** = Mahoba.
49. **Paramara** power centre moved from **Ujjain** (उज्जैन) to **Dhara**. **Bhoja** wrote *Samarangana Sutradhara (सूत्रधार)* (architecture / devices) and founded **Bhojshala** (Saraswati (सरस्वती); Sanskrit school at Dhar, **1035**).
50. **Solanki / Chaulukya** capital was **Anhilwada** (अणहिलवाड़); founder line **Mularaja I**. Jain scholar **Hemachandra** advised **Kumarapala** (after fame under Jayasimha Siddharaja).
51. **Lakshmana Sena** started **Lakshmana Samvat**. Early medieval jurists are **Vijnaneshwara** (विज्ञानेश्वर) (*Mitakshara* (मिताक्षरा)), **Jimutavahana** (जीमूतवाहन) (*Dayabhaga* (दायाभाग)), and **Hemadri** — not **Rajasekhara** (poet).
52. **Dantidurga** founded Rashtrakutas and performed **Hiranyagarbha** at Ujjain. **Amoghavarsha I** (अमोघवर्ष) was born in a military camp on the Narmada (नर्मदा) during Govinda III's northern return.
53. **Gangeyadeva** (Kalachuri of Tripuri) took the title **Vikramaditya** (विक्रमादित्य) and revived **gold** coinage; **Al-Biruni** mentions him and Tripuri.
54. *Hammira Mahakavya* (महाकाव्य) treats Chauhans as **Suryavanshi** / Agnikula. *Hammir Raso* (हम्मीर रासो) is by **Sharangadeva** (not Abdur Rehman). *Prithviraja Vijaya* (विजय) is by **Jayanaka**.

55. **Pundravardhana bhukti (भुक्ति)** was in **north Bengal** (later into north Bihar under Pala–Chandra–Sena). **Araghatta** = Persian-wheel style water device for irrigation.

⏱️ Timeline / Chronology

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[c. 575–897 CE] Pallavas of Kanchi (Simhavishnu → Mahendravarman I → Narasimhavarman I Mahamalla)
      |
[c. 543–753 CE] Early Chalukyas of Badami / Vatapi (Pulakeshin I → Pulakeshin II Aihole Prasasti 634 CE)
      |
[c. 750 CE] Foundation of Rashtrakutas (Dantidurga at Manyakheta) & Pala Empire (Gopala elected in Bengal)
      |
[c. 750–1000 CE] Tripartite Struggle for Kannauj: Gurjara-Pratiharas ⚔ Palas ⚔ Rashtrakutas
      |
[c. 850 CE] Imperial Cholas founded by Vijayalaya at Thanjavur (Takkolam 949 CE setback)
      |
[985–1044 CE] Chola Imperial Zenith: Rajaraja I (Brihadishwara 1010) → Rajendra I (Gangaikondacholapuram 1025)
      |
[10th–12th c.] Northern Regional Rajputs: Chandelas (Khajuraho), Paramaras (Dhara), Gahadavalas (Kannauj/Banaras)
      |
[1191–1194 CE] Battles of Tarain I & II (Prithviraj Chauhan vs Ghori) → Battle of Chandawar (Jay Chandra Gahadavala)
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Chronological Succession of Major Dynasties

DYNASTY / EMPIRE	PERIOD	CAPITAL / SEATS	FOUNDER & KEY RULERS	MAJOR HISTORICAL LANDMARKS
Pallavas of Kanchi	c. 575–897 CE	**Kanchipuram** (Kanchi, TN)	Simhavishnu (founder), Mahendravarman I, Narasimhavarman I (Mahamalla)	Rock-cut rathas at Mahabalipuram, Shore Temple, *Mattavilasa Prahasana*
Chalukyas of Badami	c. 543–753 CE	**Badami (Vatapi)**, Karnataka	Pulakeshin I (founder), Pulakeshin II (defeated Harsha c. 618 CE)	Aihole Inscription of Ravikirti (mentions Kalidasa & Bharavi); cave temples
Rashtrakutas	c. 753–982 CE	**Manyakheta (Malkhed)**, Gulbarga	Dantidurga (Hiranyagarbha ritual), Krishna I, Amoghavarsha I, Krishna III	Kailasa Temple (Cave 16) at Ellora; Battle of Takkolam (949 CE); Arab traveler Sulaiman
Imperial Cholas	c. 850–1279 CE	**Thanjavur** → **Gangaikondacholapuram**	Vijayalaya (founder), Parantaka I, Rajaraja I, Rajendra I, Kulottunga I	Brihadishwara Temple (1010 CE), conquest of Sri Lanka & Srivijaya, Uttaramerur Inscription
Gurjara-Pratiharas	c. 730–1036 CE	**Bhinmal** → **Kannauj (Kanyakubja)**	Nagabhata I (checked Arabs), Vatsaraja, Mihir Bhoja (Adivaraha), Mahendrapala I	Champion of Kannauj in Tripartite struggle; patronized poet Rajasekhara
Palas of Bengal	c. 750–1161 CE	Gauda / Pataliputra / Munger	Gopala (elected by people), Dharmapala (Vikramashila), Devapala	Mahayana/Vajrayana Buddhism patronage; Somapura Mahavihara; Atisha Dipankara to Tibet
Senas of Bengal	c. 1070–1230 CE	Nadia (Navadvipa) / Lakhnauti	Samantasena, Hemant Sen, Vijaya Sen, Ballal Sen, Lakshman Sen	*Lakshmana Samvat* (1179 CE); Jayadeva (*Gita Govinda*); Dhoyi (*Pavanaduta*)
Chandelas of Jejakabhukti	c. 831–1315 CE	**Khajuraho / Mahoba / Kalinjar**	Nannuka (founder), Yashovarman, Dhanga, Vidyadhara, Parmardi Deva	Khajuraho temples (Kandariya Mahadeva); Kalinjar fort; Alha-Udal legends
Paramaras of Malwa	c. 800–1305 CE	**Ujjain** → **Dhara (Dhar, MP)**	Upendra (founder), Siyaka II, Munja (Vakpati II), Raja Bhoja (1010–1055)	Bhojshala & Saraswati Temple at Dhar; *Samarangana Sutradhara*; Bhojpur Shiva Temple
Gahadavalas of Kannauj	c. 1090–1194 CE	**Kannauj** & **Varanasi (Kashi)**	Chandradeva (founder), Govindachandra, Jay Chandra	Rule over UP heartland; Queen Kumaradevi builds Sarnath Vihara; Chandawar (1194)

📊 Quick Reference Grid

1. Battles & Military Clashes of Early Medieval India

BATTLE / CLASH	YEAR	PARTIES INVOLVED	VICTOR / OUTCOME	HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE
Battle of Narmada	c. 618–619 CE	Harsha of Kannauj vs **Pulakeshin II** (Badami Chalukya)	**Pulakeshin II won**	Checked Harsha's southern expansion; established Narmada as imperial boundary
Battle of Vatapi	642 CE	Pulakeshin II vs **Narasimhavarman I** (Pallava)	**Narasimhavarman I won**	Badami sacked; Pulakeshin II killed; Narasimhavarman assumed title **Vatapikonda**
Battle of Takkolam	949 CE	**Krishna III** (Rashtrakuta + Western Ganga) vs Rajaditya (Chola prince)	**Rashtrakuta won**	Chola prince Rajaditya killed on elephant-back; shattered Chola power for 30 years
Battle of Koppam	1054 CE	Rajadhiraja I & Rajendra II (Chola) vs Someshvara I (Western Chalukya)	**Chola won**	Rajadhiraja died on battlefield; brother Rajendra II crowned himself on battlefield
Battle of Kandalur Salai	c. 988 CE	**Rajaraja I** (Chola) vs Chera Navy	**Rajaraja I won**	Smashed Chera fleet; established Chola maritime supremacy across Arabian Sea
First Battle of Tarain	1191 CE	**Prithviraj Chauhan (III)** vs Muhammad Ghori	**Prithviraj Chauhan won**	Ghori severely wounded and routed; spared by Rajput forces
Second Battle of Tarain	1192 CE	Prithviraj Chauhan (III) vs **Muhammad Ghori**	**Muhammad Ghori won**	Decisive Turkish cavalry victory; opened Gangetic plains to Islamic conquest
Battle of Chandawar	1194 CE	**Muhammad Ghori** vs Jay Chandra (Gahadavala of Kannauj)	**Muhammad Ghori won**	Jay Chandra killed; Turkish control extended across Kannauj and Varanasi

2. Architecture & Monument Builders (High-Yield Match List)

MONUMENT / TEMPLE	BUILDER / PATRON	DYNASTY & PERIOD	ARCHITECTURAL STYLE & SALIENT FEATURES
Shore Temple (Mahabalipuram)	Narasimhavarman II (Rajasimha)	Pallava (c. 700–728 CE)	Dravidian structural stone temple facing Bay of Bengal; twin towers (Shiva & Vishnu)
Kailasanatha Temple (Kanchi)	Narasimhavarman II (Rajasimha)	Pallava (c. 685–705 CE)	Oldest structural stone temple in Kanchipuram; sandstone carvings and vimana
Kailasa Temple, Ellora (Cave 16)	**Krishna I**	Rashtrakuta (c. 756–774 CE)	Monolithic rock-cut architectural marvel carved top-to-bottom out of basalt cliff
Brihadishwara Temple (Thanjavur)	**Rajaraja I**	Chola (completed **1010 CE**)	Massive Dravidian granite vimana (216 ft); single granite cupola (80 tonnes); monolithic Nandi
Gangaikondacholapuram Temple	**Rajendra I**	Chola (c. **1025–1035 CE**)	Built to commemorate northern Ganga expedition; concave curved vimana (55 m)
Airavatesvara Temple (Darasuram)	Rajaraja II	Chola (12th c. CE)	UNESCO Great Living Chola Temples; stone chariot with wheels pulled by elephants
Kandariya Mahadeva Temple	Vidyadhara / Dhanga	Chandela (c. 1025–1050 CE)	Nagara style shikhara replicating Mount Kailash; erotica sculptures at Khajuraho
Lakshmana Temple (Khajuraho)	Yashovarman	Chandela (c. 954 CE)	Panchayatana layout dedicated to Vaikuntha Vishnu; celebrated sandstone reliefs
Bhojshala & Saraswati Temple	**Raja Bhoja**	Paramara (c. 1035 CE)	Sanskrit academy & temple at Dhar (MP); dedicated to Vagdevi (Goddess Saraswati)
Sun Temple, Modhera	Bhima I (Solanki)	Chaulukya / Solanki (1026 CE)	Maru-Gurjara style; stepped tank (Surya Kund); aligned so equinox sun illuminates sanctum
Chennakeshava Temple (Belur)	Vishnuvardhana	Hoysala (1117 CE)	Star-shaped (stellate) platform, chloritic soapstone, lathe-turned pillars, UNESCO 2023
Hoysaleswara Temple (Halebid)	Vishnuvardhana / Ketamalla	Hoysala (c. 1121 CE)	Twin vimana dedicated to Hoysaleswara & Shantaleswara, intricate friezes, UNESCO 2023
Dharmachakra Jina Vihara	Queen Kumaradevi	Gahadavala (12th c. CE)	Located at **Sarnath (Varanasi)**; built by Buddhist queen of Hindu King Govindachandra

3. Dynasty, Capital, Founder & Royal Emblem Grid

DYNASTY	FOUNDER	IMPERIAL CAPITAL	KEY EMBLEM / SYMBOL	REGION
Pallava	Simhavishnu	Kanchipuram (Kanchi)	**Bull (Nandi) / Lion**	Northern Tamil Nadu / Tondaimandalam
Early Chalukya	Pulakeshin I	Badami (Vatapi)	**Varaha (Boar)**	Northern Karnataka / Deccan
Eastern Chalukya	Kubja Vishnuvardhana	Vengi (Pedavegi near Eluru)	**Varaha (Boar)**	Andhra (Godavari-Krishna delta)
Western Chalukya	Tailapa II	Kalyani (Basavakalyan)	**Varaha (Boar)**	Western Deccan / Karnataka
Rashtrakuta	Dantidurga	Manyakheta (Malkhed)	**Garuda**	Deccan / Maharashtra / Karnataka
Imperial Chola	Vijayalaya (~850 CE)	Thanjavur → Gangaikondacholapuram	**Tiger (व्याघ्र)**	Kaveri Delta / Tamil Nadu
Pandya	Kadungon	Madurai	**Twin Carp / Fish (मत्स्य)**	Southern Tamil Nadu (Vaigai)
Chera	Uthiyan Cheralathan	Vanchi / Karuvur / Muziris	**Bow and Arrow (धनुष-बाण)**	Kerala / Western Coast
Hoysala	Nripa Kama II / Sala	Dvarasamudra (Halebid)	**Sala striking a Tiger**	Southern Karnataka
Kakatiya	Beta I / Prola II	Orugallu (Warangal)	**Varaha (Boar)**	Telangana / Andhra
Yadava (Seuna)	Bhillama V	Devagiri (Daulatabad)	**Garuda / Golden Eagle**	Northern Deccan / Maharashtra
Gurjara-Pratihara	Nagabhata I	Bhinmal → Kannauj	**Varaha (Adivaraha)**	Rajasthan / Doab / Kannauj
Pala	Gopala (elected ~750 CE)	Gauda / Pataliputra / Munger	**Dharmachakra (Wheel)**	Bengal & Bihar
Sena	Samantasena / Hemant Sen	Nadia (Navadvipa) / Lakhnauti	**Sadashiva**	Bengal
Chandela	Nannuka	Khajuraho / Mahoba / Kalinjar	**Moon / Boar**	Bundelkhand (Jejakabhukti)
Paramara	Upendra	Ujjain → Dhara (Dhar)	**Garuda**	Malwa (MP)
Gahadavala	Chandradeva	Kannauj & Varanasi	**Garuda**	Middle Ganga Plain / UP
Kalachuri (Chedi)	Kokalla I	Tripuri (near Jabalpur)	**Bull**	Central India / Dahala
Solanki (Chaulukya)	Mularaja I	Anhilwada (Patan)	**Varaha / Bull**	Gujarat

4. Chola Local Governance & Administrative Glossary

TERM / UNIT	NATURE / LEVEL	SPECIFIC FUNCTION & EXAMINER TRAP
Mandalam (मंडलम)	Province	Highest territorial division; empire divided into 4–9 mandalams headed by royal princes
Valanadu (वलनाडु)	Division / Commissionary	Cluster of Nadus, introduced under Rajaraja I for revenue administration
Nadu (नाडु)	District	Agrarian unit composed of multiple villages; assembly called **Nattar**
Gramam / Kurram	Village	Basic administrative and revenue unit of the empire
Ur (उर)	Village Assembly	General assembly of tax-paying landholders in non-brahmadeya agricultural villages
Sabha / Mahasabha	Agrahara Assembly	Exclusive assembly of learned Brahmins in tax-free **Brahmadeya / Agrahara** villages
Nagaram (नगरम)	Mercantile Assembly	Council of merchants and traders managing market towns and commercial guilds
Variyam (वारियम)	Executive Committee	Specialized committee of the Sabha elected through the **Kudavolai** (pot-ballot) system
Samvatsara Variyam	Annual Committee	Most prestigious executive council of senior respected members
Thotta Variyam	Garden Committee	Supervised village gardens, orchards, public lands, and horticulture
Eri Variyam	Tank Committee	Supervised maintenance, desilting, and bund repair of village irrigation tanks
Pon Variyam	Gold / Finance Committee	Assayed the purity and weight of gold coins and tested village finances
Panchavara Variyam	General Supervision	General executive board for standing village affairs
Eripatti (एरिपट्टी)	Revenue Category	Revenue from dedicated land reserved exclusively for the upkeep of irrigation tanks
Taniyur (तनियूर)	Administrative Unit	Very large village administered as an independent single unit, not subsumed under a Nadu
Kadamai & Kudimai	Taxation	**Kadamai** = Land revenue due to the king; **Kudimai** = Feudal labour / tenant dues
Uttaramerur Inscription	Inscription Record	Issued by **Parantaka I (919 & 921 CE)**; details qualification, disqualification & pot-ballot system

5. UP Medieval City Name Tags (UPPCS Special Matching Table)

MODERN DISTRICT / CITY	MEDIEVAL INSCRIPTION NAME	ASSOCIATED DYNASTY / LANDMARK
Kannauj	**Kanyakubja / Mahodaya / Nagar Mahodaya Shri**	Gurjara-Pratiharas, Gahadavalas; ultimate imperial prize
Ayodhya	**Saketa / Ayodhya**	Kosala heartland; visited by early medieval pilgrims
Varanasi	**Kashi / Avimukta Kshetra**	Gahadavala second capital; Gahadavala religious charter seat
Mahoba	**Mahotsava Nagar**	Chandela capital; home of warrior twins Alha and Udal
Kalinjar (Banda)	**Kalinjaradurg**	Chandela military fort; held against Mahmud Ghazni (1019, 1022)
Aligarh	**Koil / Kol**	Annexed by Qutbuddin Aibak in 1194 CE

🧠 Memory Anchors & Mnemonics

1. **South Imperial Sequence: P–C–R–C** - **P**allava of Kanchi (c. 575–897) - **C**halukya of Badami (c. 543–753) - **R**ashtrakuta of Manyakheta (c. 753–982) - **C**hola of Thanjavur (c. 850–1279) - *Trap Alert:* Rashtrakutas completely displaced Badami Chalukyas; Cholas later defeated Rashtrakutas.
2. **Sena Succession Order: H–V–B–L** - **H**emant Sen → **V**ijaya Sen → **B**allal Sen → **L**akshman Sen - *Trap Alert:* Ballal Sen is NEVER before Vijaya Sen. Lakshman Sen founded *Lakshmana Samvat* (1179 CE) and was in power when Bakhtiyar Khalji raided Nadia (1204 CE).
3. **Tripartite Contestants: P–P–R for Kannauj** - **P**ratihara (Gurjara-Pratihara from west/Rajasthan) - **P**ala (from east/Bengal-Bihar) - **R**ashtrakuta (from south/Deccan) - *Remember:* Cholas NEVER took part in the Tripartite Struggle.
4. **Chola Territorial Ladders: M–V–N–G** - **M**andalam (Province) → **V**alanadu (Division) → **N**adu (District) → **G**ramam (Village) - *Mnemonic Hook:* "My Valiant Nation Grows"
5. **Chola Variyam Committee Hooks: S–T–E–P** - **S**amvatsara = Senior Annual Council - **T**hotta = Trees & Gardens (Horticulture) - **E**ri = Earth & Irrigation Tank - **P**on = Pure Gold / Finance
6. **The Bhoja Examiner Trap:** - **Mihir Bhoja:** Gurjara-Pratihara emperor, capital Kannauj, title **Adivaraha**, praised by Arab chronicler Sulaiman / Al-Masudi (Baura). - **Raja Bhoja (Bhoja I):** Paramara king of Malwa, capital **Dhara (Dhar)**, scholar-polymath, wrote *Samarangana Sutradhara*, built **Bhojshala** (Saraswati temple).

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill

> **Mastery Rule:** Read the consolidated facts above, attempt these high-yield questions, and score ≥80% to conquer this chapter.

Q1.

Match List-I (Ruler) with List-II (Dynasty):

LIST-I	LIST-II
A. Mahendravarman I	1. Rashtrakuta
B. Kadungon	2. Pallava
C. Amoghavarsha I	3. Chola
D. Rajaraja I	4. Pandya

Row order in the table is not the answer code.

A. 4 2 3 1 B. 2 4 1 3 C. 2 4 3 1 D. 4 2 1 3

▶ Details

Q3.

Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R):

Assertion (A): We have much more information about Cholas than their predecessors.

Reason (R): The Chola rulers adopted the practice of having inscriptions written on the walls of temples giving a historical narrative of their victories.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below. A. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A) B. Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) C. (A) is true but (R) is false D. (A) is false but (R) is true

▶ Details

Q5.

Arrange the following temples in a chronological order and select the correct answer from the codes given below:

I. Brihdishwar temple II. Gangaikonda cholapuram temple III. Shore temple of Mahabalipuram IV. Sapt pagoda

Options: A. I, II, IV, III B. II, I, III, IV C. III, II, I, IV D. IV, III, I, II

▶ Details

Q7. With reference to Early Medieval India, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The period is roughly dated about 1206–1526 CE as the Delhi Sultanate age.
2. The Delhi Sultanate begins in 1206 CE.
3. Early Medieval India is identical with the Delhi Sultanate phase.

A. Only 2

B. 1 and 2

C. 2 and 3

D. 1 and 3

▶ Details

Q9. Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): The Tripartite Struggle was fought for control of Kannauj.

Reason (R): Pala, Gurjara-Pratihara, and Rashtrakuta powers contested the city.

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) B. (A) is false, but (R) is true C. (A) is true, but (R) is false D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

▶ Details

Q11. Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Mihir Bhoja — Paramara scholar-king of Dhara
2. Mihir Bhoja — Pratihara ruler with title Adivaraha
3. Bhoja I — Paramara of Malwa / Dhara

A. 1 only B. 2 only C. 2 and 3 only D. 1 and 3 only

▶ Details

Q13. Consider the following pairs:

1. Hoysala — Halebid / Dvarasamudra
2. Kakatiya — Warangal
3. Yadava — Devagiri

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

A. Only 1 B. 1 and 2 C. All 1, 2 and 3 D. 2 and 3

▶ Details

Q15. Match List-I with List-II:

LIST-I (RULER)	LIST-II (DYNASTY)
A. Mahendravarman	1. Chola
B. Amoghavarsha	2. Pallava
C. Rajaraja	3. Rashtrakuta
D. Kadungon	4. Pandya

Row order is not the answer code.

Code:

A. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4 B. A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4 C. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3 D. A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4

▶ Show answer

Chapter 04: Turkish Invasions & Delhi Sultanate

Current Affairs & High-Yield Updates

YEAR/REF	KEY FACT	EXAM RELEVANCE
2023–2024	**Mehrauli Archaeological Park (Delhi)** restoration and night illumination by DDA & ASI	Conserves **Balban's Tomb** (earliest true arch in India), Jamali Kamali Mosque, and Gandhak ki Baoli
2023	**Quwwat-ul-Islam & Qutb Complex** excavations and structural conservation under National Monuments Authority	Questions on Qutbuddin Aibak, Iltutmish's additions, Alai Darwaza by Alauddin Khalji (1311 CE)
2023–2024	**Jaunpur Heritage Development (UP Tourism):** Restoration of Shahi Bridge & Atala Mosque	Founded by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** in memory of cousin Jauna Khan (Muhammad bin Tughlaq); capital of Sharqi Sultanate
2024	**Delhi Baolis & Sultanate Water Architecture:** National mission for reviving medieval stepwells	Focus on **Hauz Khas** (Alauddin Khalji/Firoz Tughlaq), Agrasen ki Baoli, and Sultanate canal networks
2023	**Sikandar Lodi's Agra Milestones:** 520 years of Agra's foundation (1504–2024)	Sikandar Lodi founded Agra in 1504, capital in 1506; introduced **Gaz-i-Sikandari** (39 digits)

Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. In **712**, Arab **Muhammad bin Qasim** took **Sindh** from **Dahir** (**Chachnama**; capital **Arod**); this was an Indus (सिंधु) foothold, not Gangetic conquest.
2. **Sind 712** Cause–Course–Result: Arab push for Indus ports → Qasim took Debal and killed Dahir → Multan–Sindh foothold only, no Gangetic empire.
3. **Alptigin** founded the **Ghaznavid (ग़ज़नवी) (Yamini)** dynasty at **Ghazni**; **Mahmud** (**998**) led about **17** raids, plundered **Somnath** (सोमनाथ) under **Bhimdev I**, and usually **raided and withdrew**.
4. **Somnath ~1025/26** Cause–Course–Result: temple plunder prestige → Mahmud stormed the shrine → **Bhimdev I** later rebuilt; no lasting Gujarat annexation.
5. **Utbi** was Mahmud's court historian (**Kitab-ul-Yamini** / **Tarikh-i-Yamini**); **Firdausi** (फिरदौसी) wrote **Shahnama**; **Al-Biruni** wrote **Kitab-ul-Hind / Tahqiq-i-Hind** and was the first Muslim to study the **Puranas**.
6. **Muhammad Ghori** practised **territorial conquest** — governors, garrisons, and coinage — unlike Mahmud's raid-and-return pattern. His **first defeat in India** was near **Mount Abu (1178)** by **Naika Devi** (नायका देवी) (regent for **Mularaja II / Bhimdev II**).
7. **First Tarain (1191)** Cause–Course–Result: Ghori sought the Delhi–Ajmer corridor → Prithviraj (पृथ्वीराज) broke the Ghurid left and Ghori fled wounded → no pursuit, so the **1192** rematch followed.
8. **Second Tarain (1192)** Cause–Course–Result: Ghori returned stronger → feigned retreat and archery captured Prithviraj near Sirsa → Ajmer–Delhi fell and Turkish garrisons stayed (unlike Mahmud's raids).
9. **Chandawar (1194)** Cause–Course–Result: after Tarain, Kannauj (कन्नौज) still blocked the upper Ganga → Ghori killed **Jay Chandra** near **Firozabad (Yamuna (यमुना))** → the upper Ganga valley opened to Ghurid agents.
10. At **First Panipat (1526) Babur (बाबर)** defeated **Ibrahim Lodi** and ended the Delhi Sultanate.
11. Five dynasties span **1206–1526**: **Slave 1206–1290** → **Khalji 1290–1320** → **Tughlaq 1320–1414** → **Sayyid 1414–1451** → **Lodi 1451–1526**.
12. **Qutb-ud-din Aibak** ruled from **Lahore (1206–10)** as **Malik/Sipahsalar** (not "Sultan"), was called **Lakh Baksh / Quran Khwan**, and died playing **chaugan**.
13. **Iltutmish** (इल्तुतमिश) (**1210–1236**), **Ilbari** "slave of a slave," made **Delhi** the capital, coined **tanka/jital**, took Caliph's **khilat (1229)**, organised the **Turkan-i-Chahalgani (Forty)**, and refused asylum to **Jalaluddin Mingburni**.
14. **Razia** (रजिया) (**1236–1240**) was the **only woman Sultan** of Delhi; **Altunia (Bhatinda)** and anger over **Yaqut** ended her rule.
15. **Balban** used **Blood and Iron** (लौह एवं रक्त की नीति), **Zil-i-Ilahi / Niyabat-i-Khudai** (ज़िल्ल-ए-इलाही / नियाबत-ए-ख़ुदाई), **Sijda (सिजदा)/Paibos** (सिजदा / पैबोस), **Nawruz** (नौरोज़), and **Diwan-i-Arz** (दीवान-ए-अर्ध - सैन्य विभाग) (**Imad-ul-Mulk**); the Slave line closed with weak **Kaiqubad** and infant **Kayumars** before the **1290 Khalji coup**.
16. **Jalaluddin Khalji** (**1290–1296**) founded the dynasty, was crowned at **Kilokhari**, and was killed by Alauddin at **Kara**.
17. **Alauddin Khalji** kept a cash-paid standing army (सेना) and used **Dagh** (दाग़ - horse branding) and **Chehra (चेहरा) / Huliya** (चेहरा / हुलिया - soldier descriptive rolls) against fake musters.
18. Alauddin's four revolt ordinances hit noble gifts and land grants, widened intelligence, banned wine and gambling, and curbed free noble feasts and intermarriage.
19. Alauddin's north–Deccan (दक्कन) conquest order is **Gujarat 1299** → **Ranthambor 1301** → **Chittor (चित्तौड़) 1303** → **Malwa** → **Devagiri** → **Warangal (वारंगल)** → **Dwarasamudra** → **Madurai**; **Malik Kafur** rose from Cambay.

20. Alauddin took about **50%** by measurement (**Diwan-i-Mustakharaj** (दीवान-ए-मुस्तख़राज) / दीवान-ए-मुस्तख़राज - arrears dept), added **Ghari/Charai** (घरी / चराई कर), built **Siri**, used **Sikandar-i-Sani** (सिकंदर-ए-सानी - second Alexander (सिकंदर)), and died in **1316**; **Malik Kafur** = **Hazar-Dinari** (हज़ार दिनारी).
21. **Shahna-i-Mandi** (शहना-ए-मंडी - market controller) was Alauddin's market controller; **Amir-i-Kohi** (अमीर-ए-कोही / दीवान-ए-कोही) was Muhammad bin Tughlaq's agriculture department — do not swap them.
22. **Ghazi Malik / Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq** (**1320–1325**) killed usurper **Khusrau Khan**, founded the Tughlaqs, and built **Tughlaqabad**; he did **not** build Qutub Minar.
23. **Muhammad bin Tughlaq** (मुहम्मद बिन तुगलक) was the most learned Sultan; his main experiments were **Daulatabad**, **token currency** (सांकेतिक मुद्रा), **Amir-i-Kohi**, Doab (दोआब) tax, and Khurasan/Qarachil plans; **Ibn Battuta** (इब्न बतूता) wrote *Rihla* (रिहला).
24. **Firoz Shah** built canals and levied **Haqq-i-Sharb** (हक़-ए-शर्ब - irrigation tax), ran **Diwan-i-Khairat** (दीवान-ए-ख़ैरात - charity) / **Bandagan** (दीवान-ए-बंदगान - slaves) and **Dar-ul-Shafa** (दार-उल-शफ़ा - charitable hospital), funded Haj from the treasury, moved Ashoka (अशोक) pillars (**Topra/Meerut (मेरठ)**), used **Azizuddin Khan** for Nagarkot texts, made **iqta (इक्ता) hereditary** (इक्ता वंशानुगत), and put **jizya (जज़िया) on Brahmins** (जज़िया).
25. **Khizr Khan** (**1414–1421**) founded the **Sayyid** house as Timur's Multan–Delhi nominee (**Rayat-i-Ala** style); **Alam Shah** abdicated to **Bahlul Lodi** in **1451**.
26. **Bahlul Lodi** founded the first **Afghan** Sultanate dynasty, issued the **Bahluli** coin, and annexed **Sharqi Jaunpur (1484)**; **Sikandar Lodi** built up **Agra** (आगरा) and used **Gaz-i-Sikandari**; **Ibrahim Lodi** (**1517–1526**) was the last Delhi Sultan.
27. **Iltutmish** institutionalised the **Iqta** (इक्ता) system in India; **Siyasatnama** (निजाम-उल-मुल्क) (Nizam-ul-Mulk (निजाम-उल-मुल्क)) is the classical source on Muqti duties; Iqta revenue went to the **Muqti** (मुक़्ती / वली), not directly to the Sultan; **Khalsa** (ख़ालिसा) was crown land.
28. **Khams** (ख़म्स) was one-fifth of war booty; **jizya** (जज़िया) was the tax on non-Muslims.
29. Admin facts: **Diwan-i-Insha** (दीवान-ए-इंशा) = correspondence; **Diwan-i-Tan** (दीवान-ए-तन) = salaries/jagirs; **Mustarfi** (मुस्तौफ़ी) = audit; **Mushrif** (मुशरिफ़) = accounts/records; **Vakianvis** (वाक़ियानवीस) = firmans/events list; **Khareetadar** (खरीतादार) = despatch of decrees.
30. **Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi** is by **Barani** (बरनी) (or **Afif** for Firoz's reign alone); **Tughlaqnama** (तुग़लक़नामा) is by **Amir Khusrau** (अमीर खुसरो), not Ibn Battuta; **Rihla** is Ibn Battuta's travel book.
31. **Tabaqat-i-Nasiri** is by **Minhaj**; Amir Khusrau wrote **Khazain-ul-Futuh** and **Khaliq-e-Bari**; **Rag Vibodh** (राग विबोध) is **Somnath's** music treatise (**1609**), not Khusrau's.
32. Architecture facts: **Sultan Garhi** = Iltutmish; **Red Palace** = Balban; **Jamat Khana** = Alauddin; **Dhai Din Ka Jhopra** = Aibak; **Tughlaqabad** = Ghiyasuddin; **Hauz Khas** = Firoz.
33. **Qutub (कुतुब) Minar** (कुतुब मीनार) was started by Aibak and finished by Iltutmish; **Firuz** repaired the fourth storey and added the fifth; **Alai Darwaza** (अलाई दरवाज़ा) is Alauddin's gateway of **1311**.
34. **Bakhtiyar Khalji** took **Odantapuri** (उदंतपुरी), destroyed **Nalanda** (नालंदा) and **Vikramshila** (विक्रमशिला), took **Nadia** (~**1204**), and made **Lakhnauti** his capital; **Lakshmana Sena** fled to East Bengal.
35. Ghori's coins (रूपक) show **Goddess Lakshmi** with Arabic **Kalma**; Mahmud issued bilingual silver (रूपक) with Sanskrit **"Avyaktamekam Muhammad Avatar Nripati Mahmud"**.
36. After Tarain, Ghori granted the first Indian **iqta** charge to **Qutbuddin Aibak** (कुतुबुद्दीन ऐबक) (**Kuhram** and **Samana**); **Iltutmish** later made Iqta the Sultanate's regular framework; **Timur** sacked Delhi in **1398**.
37. UP facts: **Chandawar 1194**; **Jaunpur** (जौनपुर) annexed **1484**; **Kol (Aligarh (अलीगढ़))** garrison; do not confuse **Sikandar (Agra)** with **Ibrahim (Panipat 1526)**.
38. Turkish success rested on Rajput (राजपूत) **disunity** after Pratihara (गुर्जर-प्रतिहार) decline — Chauhans, Gahadavalas, Chandelas (**Vidyadhar** alone held Mahmud in **1019–20**), and Paramaras fought separately.
39. Ghaznavids **raided**; Ghurids **conquered and stayed** — that contrast is the first Turkish-invasion trap. **Firdausi ≠ Firishta (फरिश्ता)** (Shahnama vs Bijapur (बीजापुर) chronicle).
40. Longest Sultanate house is often **Tughlaq**; shortest major house is often **Khalji**; first Afghan house is **Lodi**.
41. **Mubarak Shah Khalji** declared himself **Khalifa** and relaxed Alauddin's controls; **Khusrau Khan**'s brief usurpation ended with Ghazi Malik's victory (**1320**).
42. **Yahiya Sirhindi**'s *Tarikh-i-Mubarak Shahi* is the main Sayyid-age chronicle; **Mubarakabad** on the Yamuna is Mubarak Shah Sayyid's city, not a Khalji monument.
43. **Chahalgani / Chalisa (चहलगानी / चालीसा)** was the corporate body of forty powerful Turkish slave-officers created by **Iltutmish** and subsequently liquidated by **Balban** to restore absolute monarchical prestige.
44. **Balban** introduced the extreme Persian court ceremonies of **Sijda (प्रणिपात / prostration)** and **Paibos (चरण चुंबन / kissing the monarch's feet)**, tracing his own ancestry to the legendary Turanian hero **Afrasiyab**.
45. **Alauddin Khalji** was the first Delhi Sultan to fix land revenue strictly on **measurement of land (मसाहत / Masahat)** using the standard unit **Biswa**, charging **50% (half of gross produce)** in the fertile Doab.
46. **Dagh (घोड़ों को दागना / branding of horses)** and **Chehra (सैनिकों का हुलिया / descriptive roll of soldiers)** were strictly instituted by **Alauddin Khalji** to prevent fraudulent troop substitutions.

47. **Muhammad bin Tughlaq** established an advanced agricultural loan system termed **Sondhar (सोंधर)** and **Takkavi (तकावी)** loans distributed to peasants through his new agricultural ministry **Diwan-i-Kohi**.
48. **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** was the first Delhi Sultan to levy a dedicated **irrigation cess (हक-ए-शर्ब / Haqq-i-Sharb)** at the rate of **10% (1/10th of crop produce)** on lands irrigated by state canals.
49. **Sikandar Lodi** founded the city of **Agra in 1504 CE** and shifted the imperial capital there in **1506 CE** to better control the Rajput borderlands and trade routes of the Chambal-Yamuna basin.
50. **First Battle of Panipat (21 April 1526)** marked the decisive defeat and death of **Ibrahim Lodi** — the only Delhi Sultan to die on the battlefield — ending the Delhi Sultanate and establishing Mughal rule under **Babur**.

⏱️ Timeline / Chronology

```
[712 CE] Muhammad bin Qasim captures Sind (Chachnama; first Jizya at Debal)
   |
[1000–1027 CE] Mahmud of Ghazni's 17 Raids (Somnath Temple sacked c. 1025–26 CE; Al-Biruni arrives)
   |
[1175–1206 CE] Muhammad Ghori's Conquests (Tarain I 1191 ⚔️ Tarain II 1192 ⚔️ Chandawar 1194)
   |
[1206–1290 CE] SLAVE / MAMLUK DYNASTY (84 yrs): Aibak (1206) → Iltutmish (1210) → Razia (1236) → Balban (1266)
   |
[1290–1320 CE] KHALJI DYNASTY (30 yrs - Shortest): Jalaluddin → Alauddin (1296–1316; Markets, Deccan)
   |
[1320–1414 CE] TUGHLAQ DYNASTY (94 yrs - Longest): Ghiyasuddin → MBT (1325–51) → Firoz Tughlaq (1351–88)
   |               └── [1398 CE] Amir Timur sacks Delhi during reign of Nasiruddin Mahmud Tughlaq
   |
[1414–1451 CE] SAYYID DYNASTY (37 yrs): Khizr Khan (Raiyat-i-Ala) → Mubarak Shah → Alam Shah
   |
[1451–1526 CE] LODI DYNASTY (75 yrs - First Afghan): Bahlul Lodi → Sikandar Lodi (Agra 1504) → Ibrahim Lodi
   |
[21 Apr 1526] First Battle of Panipat: Babur defeats Ibrahim Lodi; Delhi Sultanate ends
```

Dynastic Overview of the Delhi Sultanate (1206–1526 CE)

DYNASTY	PERIOD & SPAN	FOUNDER	GREATEST / PIVOTAL RULER	LAST RULER	IMPERIAL CAPITAL
Slave / Mamluk / Ilbari	**1206–1290 CE** (84 years)	**Qutbuddin Aibak** (Lakhbaksh)	**Iltutmish** (real consolidator, Tanka & Jital, Chalisa) & **Balban** (Blood and Iron, Sijda/Paibos)	Kayumars (murdered by Jalaluddin)	Lahore → **Delhi** (Iltutmish made Delhi capital)
Khalji (*Shortest: 30 yrs*)	**1290–1320 CE** (30 years)	**Jalaluddin Khalji** (Khalji Revolution)	**Alauddin Khalji** (Market controls, Dagh & Chehra, South campaigns under Malik Kafur)	Khusrau Khan (usurper)	Delhi (**Siri Fort**)
Tughlaq (*Longest: 94 yrs*)	**1320–1414 CE** (94 years)	**Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq** (Ghazi Malik; Tughlaqabad)	**Muhammad bin Tughlaq** (Token currency, Daulatabad) & **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** (Canals, Jizya on Brahmins, Jaunpur)	Nasiruddin Mahmud (Timur invaded in **1398 CE**)	Delhi → Daulatabad → Delhi
Sayyid	**1414–1451 CE** (37 years)	**Khizr Khan** (Timur's Multan governor; title *Raiyat-i-Ala*)	**Mubarak Shah** (patron of Yahya Sirhindi's *Tarikh-i-Mubarak Shahi*)	Alam Shah (abdicated voluntarily to Bahlul Lodi)	Delhi
Lodi (*First Afghan Dynasty*)	**1451–1526 CE** (75 years)	**Bahlul Lodi** (issued copper Bahloli coins)	**Sikandar Lodi** (Founded **Agra 1504**, Gaz-i-Sikandari, pen-name *Gulrukhi*)	**Ibrahim Lodi** (Killed at First Battle of Panipat, 1526)	Delhi → **Agra** (capital shifted 1506)

📊 Quick Reference Grid

1. Battles & Military Clashes of the Sultanate Era

BATTLE / CONFLICT	YEAR	OPPOSING PARTIES	VICTOR / OUTCOME	HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE
Battle of Rawar	712 CE	Muhammad bin Qasim vs Raja Dahir of Sind	**Muhammad bin Qasim won**	Raja Dahir killed; first Islamic foothold and Jizya levy in Indian subcontinent
Battle of Bahraich	1033 CE	Ghazi Salar Masud vs Raja Suheldev of Shravasti	**Raja Suheldev won**	Salar Masud killed; checked Ghaznavid incursions into the Awadh plains for decades
First Battle of Tarain	1191 CE	Prithviraj Chauhan III vs Mu'izz al-Din Muhammad Ghori	**Prithviraj Chauhan won**	Ghori routed and wounded; Rajputs failed to pursue fleeing forces
Second Battle of Tarain	1192 CE	Prithviraj Chauhan III vs Muhammad Ghori	**Muhammad Ghori won**	Decisive Turkish victory; ended Chauhan rule at Ajmer/Delhi; established Turkish dominance
Battle of Chandawar	1194 CE	Muhammad Ghori vs Jay Chandra (Gahadavala King)	**Muhammad Ghori won**	Jay Chandra killed on the battlefield; opened Kannauj and Varanasi to Turkish conquest
Battle of Kili	1299 CE	Alauddin Khalji (led by Zafar Khan) vs Qutlugh Khwaja (Mongol)	**Alauddin Khalji won**	Mongol siege of Delhi broken; general Zafar Khan fought heroically and was killed
Siege of Ranthambore	1301 CE	Alauddin Khalji & Nusrat Khan vs Hammiradeva (Chauhan)	**Alauddin Khalji won**	First recorded Rajput **Jauhar** in Sultanate chronicles; Amir Khusrau witnessed siege
Siege of Chittor	1303 CE	Alauddin Khalji vs Rana Ratan Singh (Guhila)	**Alauddin Khalji won**	Chittor captured; renamed **Khizrabad**; Rani Padmini committed celebrated Jauhar
Battle of Amroha	1305 CE	Malik Nayak & Ghazi Malik (for Alauddin) vs Mongols (Ali Beg & Tartaq)	**Alauddin Khalji won**	Crushing defeat of Mongols in western UP; thousands of Mongol prisoners trampled by elephants
First Battle of Panipat	21 April 1526	Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi	**Babur won**	Ibrahim Lodi killed; Babur deployed *Tulughma* & *Araba* gun-carts; ended Delhi Sultanate

2. Architecture & Monument Builders of Delhi Sultanate

MONUMENT / STRUCTURE	BUILDER / PATRON	DYNASTY / YEAR	ARCHITECTURAL MILESTONE & FEATURES
Quwwat-ul-Islam Mosque	Qutbuddin Aibak	Slave Dynasty (1193–1197 CE)	First congregational mosque built in Delhi; constructed from ruins of 27 Hindu-Jain temples
Adhai Din Ka Jhonpra	Qutbuddin Aibak	Slave Dynasty (c. 1199 CE)	Mosque in Ajmer built upon the remnants of a Sanskrit college (*Saraswati Mandir*)
Qutb Minar (Delhi)	Aibak (started) → Iltutmish (completed) → Firoz Tughlaq (repaired 5th tier)	Slave / Tughlaq (1199–1368 CE)	72.5 m victory tower dedicated to Sufi saint Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki; red sandstone & marble
Sultan Garhi (Delhi)	**Iltutmish**	Slave Dynasty (1231 CE)	Earliest monumental Islamic tomb/mausoleum in India; built for eldest son Nasiruddin Mahmud
Tomb of Balban (Mehrauli)	Ghiyasuddin Balban	Slave Dynasty (c. 1287 CE)	**First true arch (यथार्थ मेहराब / pointed voussoir arch)** constructed in India
Alai Darwaza (Qutb complex)	**Alauddin Khalji**	Khalji Dynasty (**1311 CE**)	**First true dome (यथार्थ गुंबद)** and **horseshoe arch**; red sandstone with white marble inlay
Siri Fort & Hauz Khas	Alauddin Khalji	Khalji Dynasty (1303 CE)	Second city of Delhi built as defense against Mongols; large royal water reservoir (*Hauz-i-Alai*)
Tughlaqabad Fort & Tomb	Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq	Tughlaq Dynasty (1321–1325 CE)	Third city of Delhi; pentagonal tomb with sloping stone walls (**batter / ढलवां दीवारें**)
Jahanpanah Fort & Adilabad	Muhammad bin Tughlaq	Tughlaq Dynasty (c. 1326 CE)	Fourth city of Delhi enclosing the space between Qila Rai Pithora and Siri
Kotla Firoz Shah (Firozabad)	Firoz Shah Tughlaq	Tughlaq Dynasty (1354 CE)	Fifth city of Delhi; Ashokan pillar transported from Topra (Haryana) mounted on pyramidal palace
Tomb of Sikandar Lodi	Ibrahim Lodi	Lodi Dynasty (c. 1517–1518 CE)	**First double dome (दोहरा गुंबद)** in India; situated inside formal walled Charbagh garden
Moth ki Masjid (Delhi)	Miyan Bhoiya (Prime Minister)	Lodi Dynasty (reign of Sikandar Lodi)	Finest example of Lodi architecture; five-arched facade, small domed kiosks (chhatris)

3. Sultanate Central Administration & Departmental Hierarchy

DEPARTMENT (DIWAN)	DEPARTMENT HEAD / IN-CHARGE	CORE PORTFOLIO & KEY SULTANATE FUNCTIONS	FOUNDER / KEY SULTAN
Diwan-i-Wizarat	**Wazir** (Prime Minister)	Finance, taxation, budgeting, and general imperial administration	Established since Ghaznavid tradition
Diwan-i-Arz	**Ariz-i-Mamalik**	Military affairs, recruitment, inspection of troops, and salary rolls	**Created by Balban**; peak under Alauddin
Diwan-i-Insha	**Dabir-i-Mamalik**	Imperial secretariat, royal correspondence, firmans, and state edicts	Established early in Sultanate
Diwan-i-Risalat	**Sadr-us-Sudur / Qazi-ul-Quzat**	Foreign affairs, diplomatic appeals, religious endowments, and charity	Sadr handled religion; Qazi handled justice
Diwan-i-Mustakhraj	Mushrif / Special Officers	Recovery of arrears from corrupt revenue officials, Amils, and Muqtis	**Created by Alauddin Khalji**
Diwan-i-Riyasat	Naib-i-Riyasat / Shahna-i-Mandi	Ministry of markets, commerce registration, price fixation, and weights	**Created by Alauddin Khalji**
Diwan-i-Kohi	Amir-i-Kohi	Department of agriculture, state farming, crop rotation, and Sondhar loans	**Created by Muhammad bin Tughlaq**
Diwan-i-Khairat	Khairat Commissioner	Charity for poor Muslims, dowries for poor girls, care for widows	**Created by Firoz Shah Tughlaq**
Diwan-i-Bandagan	Ariz-i-Bandagan	Department of Slaves (managed over 180,000 royal slaves and craft training)	**Created by Firoz Shah Tughlaq**
Diwan-i-Istihqaq	Chief Almoner	Distribution of pensions, stipends, and financial maintenance allowances	**Created by Firoz Shah Tughlaq**
Dar-ul-Shafa	Chief Physician / Hakim	Free state charity hospital dispensing medical care and unani medicines	**Created by Firoz Shah Tughlaq**

4. Provincial & Local Administrative Officials

OFFICIAL TITLE	ADMINISTRATIVE TIER	PRIMARY JURISDICTION & RESPONSIBILITIES
Muqti / Wali / Iqtadar	**Iqta** (Province)	Provincial governor maintaining law, order, troop contingents, and collecting revenue
Shiqdar	**Shiq** (District)	Executive and military head of district; supervised maintenance of peace and law
Amil / Munsif	**Pargana** (Sub-District)	Revenue assessment and collection officer at the pargana level
Barid-i-Mamalik	Central / Provincial	Head of state intelligence, news-reporters, espionage, and courier posts
Muhtasib	Urban / City	Public censor of morals; prevented gambling/alcohol; verified weights & market measures
Kotwal	Urban / City	Chief of city police maintaining civil order, night watch, and criminal control
Khuts & Muqaddams	**Gram** (Village)	Traditional hereditary Hindu village headmen collecting taxes from peasants
Patwari	**Gram** (Village)	Traditional village accountant keeping land records and crop registers

🧠 Memory Anchors & Mnemonics

1. **Sultanate Dynasties Chronological Order: S–K–T–S–L** - **S**lave / Mamluk (1206–1290) — 84 yrs - **K**halji (1290–1320) — 30 yrs (*Shortest Reigning*) - **T**ughlaq (1320–1414) — 94 yrs (*Longest Reigning*) - **S**ayyid (1414–1451) — 37 yrs - **L**odi (1451–1526) — 75 yrs (*First Afghan Dynasty*) - *Mnemonic Hook:* "Sultan Khalji Took Sayyid's Land"
2. **Balban's Imperial Triad:** - **Blood and Iron (लौह एवं रक्त की नीति):** Ruthless suppression of Mewatis, Katehr Rajputs, and internal rebels. - **Persian Court Protocol:** Instituted **Sijda** (prostration) and **Paibos** (kissing monarch's feet). - **Iranian Culture:** Celebrated the solar New Year festival **Nauroz (नवरोज)** and claimed descent from **Afrasiyab**.
3. **Muhammad bin Tughlaq's Five Grand Experiments in Chronological Order:** - 1. **Tax Hike in Doab (1326):** Imposed during severe famine; sparked widespread peasant rebellion. - 2. **Transfer of Capital to Daulatabad / Devagiri (1327):** Attempt to control south; caused immense misery; reversed. - 3. **Token Copper / Brass Currency (1329–1330):** Massive domestic counterfeiting ("every Hindu house became a mint"). - 4. **Khurasan Expedition (1330):** Enormous army recruited and paid a full year in advance; project abandoned. - 5. **Qarachil Expedition (1330–1331):** Disastrous Himalayan expedition against Kullu-Kangra; army decimated by disease and monsoons.
4. **Firoz Shah Tughlaq's Four Quranic Taxes:** - **Kharaj:** Land tax (1/10th of agricultural produce). - **Zakat:** Religious tax on Muslims (2.5% of net wealth for charitable uses). - **Jizya:** Religious poll tax on non-Muslim subjects (first time levied on **Brahmins** by Firoz Tughlaq). - **Khams:**

1/5th share of war booty reserved for the state treasury (Alauddin took 4/5ths; Firoz reverted to 1/5th). - *Plus Water Tax:* **Haqq-i-Sharb** (1/10th) on lands irrigated by state canals.

5. **Coinage Reform Milestones:** - **Silver Tanka (175 grains)** & **Copper Jital** = Introduced by **Iltutmish** (inscribed with mint town name). - **Bahloli Coin** = Heavy copper currency introduced by **Bahlul Lodi**; remained chief medium of exchange till Akbar's reign.

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill

> **Mastery Rule:** Read the consolidated facts above, attempt these high-yield questions, and score ≥80% to conquer this chapter.

Q1.

Arrange the following victories of Alauddin Khalji in correct chronological order.

1. Ranthambore
2. Jaisalmer
3. Warangal
4. Chittor

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

Options: A. 1, 2, 3, 4 B. 2, 1, 4, 3 C. 2, 1, 3, 4 D. 1, 2, 4, 3

▶ Details

Q3.

Which of the following is **not** correctly matched?

A. Iltutmish — Father of Razia B. Shah Turkan — Wife of Iltutmish C. Hamida Banu Begum — Wife of Alauddin Khilji D. Gulbadan Begum — Daughter of Babur

▶ Details

Q5.

Match List-I (Building) with List-II (Builder):

LIST-I	LIST-II
A. Sultan Garhi	1. Alauddin Khilji
B. Red Palace	2. Qutbuddin Aibak
C. Jamat Khana Masjid	3. Iltutmish
D. Dhai Din Ka Jhopra	4. Balban

Row order in the table is not the answer code.

A. 3, 4, 1, 2 B. 3, 4, 2, 1 C. 4, 3, 1, 2 D. 4, 3, 2, 1

▶ Details

Q7.

Which of the following is NOT correctly matched? (Books / Writers)

A. Tabaqat-i-Nasiri — Minhaj-us-Siraj-Juzjani B. Tarikh-i-Firozshahi — Shams-i-Siruj-Alif C. Tughlaqnama — Ibn Battuta D. Humayunnama — Gulbadan Begam

▶ Details

Q9. Match List-I with List-II:

LIST-I (BATTLE)	LIST-II (YEAR / RESULT TAG)
A. Mount Abu	1. 1192; Ghori wins
B. First Tarain	2. 1178; Ghori's first India defeat
C. Second Tarain	3. 1191; Prithviraj wins
D. Chandawar	4. 1194; Jay Chandra killed

Row order is not the answer code.

Code:

A. A-3, B-2, C-4, D-1 B. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4 C. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4 D. A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4

▶ Details

Q11. Arrange the Delhi Sultanate dynasties in correct chronological order:

1. Khalji
2. Slave (Mamluk)
3. Lodi
4. Tughlaq
5. Sayyid

A. 2–4–1–5–3 B. 2–1–4–5–3 C. 1–2–4–5–3 D. 2–1–5–4–3

▶ Details

Q13. With reference to Alauddin Khalji's military reforms, which statements is/are correct?

1. He maintained a cash-paid standing army.
2. Dagh branded horses.
3. Chehra / Huliya were soldier descriptive rolls.

A. Only 1 B. Only 1 and 2 C. 1, 2 and 3 D. Only 2 and 3

▶ Details

Q15. Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Balban emphasised Blood and Iron and elevated royal dignity.

Reason (R): He used titles such as Zil-i-Ilahi / Niyabat-i-Khudai and rituals like Sijda and Paibos.

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) B. (A) is false, but (R) is true C. (A) is true, but (R) is false D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

▶ Show answer

Chapter 05: Regional Kingdoms (विजयनगर, बहमनी व प्रांतीय राज्य)

Current Affairs & High-Yield Updates

YEAR/REF	KEY FACT	EXAM RELEVANCE
2023–2024	**Hampi Heritage Conservation (UNESCO):** Development of electric vehicle tourism corridor and architectural stabilization of **Vittala Temple Stone Chariot**	UPPCS tests Vijayanagara capital (Hampi / Vijayanagara on Tungabhadra), Vittala temple musical pillars, and King Krishnadeva Raya
2023–2024	**Jaunpur Sharqi Circuit (UP Tourism):** Heritage lighting and preservation at **Atala Masjid** and **Shahi Pul**	Jaunpur was the capital of the Sharqi Sultanate (*Siraj-i-Hind / Shiraz of the East*), founded by Malik Sarwar; tested heavily in UP Special
2023	**Golconda Fort & Qutb Shahi Tombs:** Restoration of Baolis (stepwells) at Qutb Shahi necropolis in Hyderabad won **UNESCO Asia-Pacific Award of Distinction**	Focus on Qutb Shahi architecture, founder Quli Qutb Shah, and Charminar builder Muhammad Quli Qutb Shah (1591 CE)
2024	**Mandu Heritage Festival (MP Tourism):** Celebrated at Jahaz Mahal, Hindola Mahal, and **Hoshang Shah's Marble Tomb**	Hoshang Shah's tomb is India's first complete marble structure; prototype for Taj Mahal
2023	**Kashmir Shaivism & Syncretic Culture:** International seminars commemorating the syncretic legacy of Sultan **Zain-ul-Abidin (Budshah)**	Zain-ul-Abidin abolished Jizya, banned cow slaughter, repaired temples, and translated Rajatarangini into Persian

Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Firuz Shah** founded the city of **Jaunpur** (जौनपुर) in memory of cousin **Jauna Khan (Muhammad bin Tughlaq (मुहम्मद बिन तुगलक))**; **Malik Sarwar (Khwaja-i-Jahan / Malik-us-Sharq)** made it independent (**~1394**); **Ibrahim (इब्राहिम) Shah** made it **Siraj/Shiraz-i-Hind**.
2. **Atala Masjid** (अटाला मस्जिद) and **Lal Darwaza Masjid** are classic **Sharqi** (शर्की) monuments at Jaunpur in eastern **UP**.
3. Last Sharqi ruler **Hussain Shah** fell to **Bahlul Lodi** (**1479/1484** keys); **Vidyapati**'s *Kirtilata* praises Jaunpur under Ibrahim.
4. **Malik Muhammad Jaisi** composed **Padmavat** (पद्मावत) in the Jaunpur cultural circle.
5. **Zain-ul-Abidin** (**1420–1470**), called **Bud Shah**, abolished **jaziya** and cow slaughter and restored temples in Kashmir.
6. **Sriya Bhatt** was Zain-ul-Abidin's Hindu minister; **Zaina Lanka** was his island palace on **Wular Lake**.
7. **Sikandar Shah** of Kashmir is the temple-destruction contrast (**Butshikan**) to tolerant **Zain-ul-Abidin**.
8. **Vijayanagara** (विजयनगर) was founded in **1336** by **Harihara I** and **Bukka I** (Sangama) with capital at **Hampi** (हम्पी) on the Tungabhadra (तुंगभद्रा); tradition links guidance to **Vidyaranya**.
9. Vijayanagara dynasties ran **Sangama** → **Saluva** → **Tuluva** → **Aravidu**.
10. **Deva Raya I / II** mark Sangama military peak against Bahmani; **Saluva Narasimha** founded the Saluva house; **Krishnadevaraya** (कृष्णदेवराय) (**1509–1529**, Tuluva) wrote **Amuktamalyada** (आमुक्तमाल्यदा) and patronised the **Ashtadiggajas**.
11. Vijayanagara used the **Nayankara / amara** system and celebrated the **Mahanavami** festival; do not equate Nayankara with Delhi Sultanate (दिल्ली सल्तनत) **iqta** (इक्ता).
12. **Bahmani** was founded in **1347** by **Hasan Gangu** as **Alauddin Bahman Shah**; the capital moved **Gulbarga** → **Bidar**.
13. Bahmani politics pitted **Afaqis (foreigners)** against **Deccanis (locals)**; **Mahmud Gawan** (Afaqi wazir) wrote **Riyaz-ul-Insha** (रियाज-उल-इंशा), organised **eight tarafs**, and was executed in **1481**.
14. After **1518** Bahmani split into five Deccan Sultanates: **Bijapur (बीजापुर), Golkonda, Ahmadnagar, Bidar, and Berar**.
15. **Bijapur (Adil Shahi)** holds **Gol Gumbaz (गोल गुम्बद) / Gol Gumbad** (tomb of **Muhammad Adil Shah**; among the world's largest domes); **Ibrahim Adil Shah II** (**Jagatguru / Ablababa**) wrote **Kitab-i-Nauras** (किताब-ए-नौरस), founded **Nauraspur**; **Firishta** (फरिश्ता) worked at his court.
16. **Golkonda (Qutb (कुतुब) Shahi)** later centred on **Hyderabad** (हैदराबाद); **Abul Hasan Qutb Shah** fell to Aurangzeb (औरंगजेब) in **1687**.
17. **Ahmadnagar** = Nizam (निजाम) Shahi; **Bidar** = Barid (बरीद-ए-मुमालिक) Shahi; **Berar** = Imad Shahi.
18. **Talikota (1565)** Cause–Course–Result: Rama Raya (रामा राय)'s Deccan overreach after Krishnadevaraya → Deccan alliance crushed Vijayanagara at Rakkasa-Tangadi (**23 Jan 1565**) → **Hampi** sacked and the empire ceased to be a great power.
19. **Raichur (1520)** was a **Krishnadevaraya** victory — do not confuse it with Talikota **1565**.
20. **Riyaz-ul-Insha** is Gawan's letters; **Riyaz-us-Salatin** (रियाज-उस-सलातीन) is Bengal history (इतिहास) — never swap the two.
21. **Tin Darwaza** stands at **Bidar Fort**, not Ahmedabad (अहमदाबाद); Ahmedabad's gate is **Teen Darwaza**. **Lal Darwaza–Jaunpur** is correctly matched.
22. Among these regional states, only **Sharqi Jaunpur** has its capital in modern **Uttar Pradesh** (उत्तर प्रदेश).

23. Chronology spine: Vijayanagara **1336** → Bahmani **1347** → Sharqi **1394** → Zain-ul-Abidin **1420–1470** → Gawan executed **1481** → Jaunpur annexed **1484** → Bahmani split **1518** → Talikota **1565**.
24. **Vitthala Temple** at Hampi is Vijayanagara; **Charminar** (चारमीनार) is Qutb Shahi Hyderabad.
25. **Kitab-i-Nauras** is Bijapur (Ibrahim Adil Shah II); **Amuktamalyada** is Krishnadevaraya's Telugu epic.
26. **Manucharitramu** by **Allasani Peddana** belongs to Krishnadevaraya's Ashtadiggajas circle.
27. **Burhan-e-Masir** is an Ahmadnagar chronicle; **Mirat-e-Sikandari** is a Gujarat narrative.
28. **Muzaffar Shah (1407)** founded Gujarat; **Mahmud Begada** took **Champaner** and **Girnar**; **Bahadur Shah** conceded **Diu** to the Portuguese.
29. **Yusuf Adil Shah** founded **Bijapur**; **Malik Ahmad** founded **Ahmadnagar** — do not swap founders.
30. **Jami Masjid (Jaunpur)** joins Atala and Lal Darwaza in the Sharqi UP monument set.
31. Vijayanagara–Bahmani rivalry centred on the **Raichur Doab** and Krishna–Tungabhadra frontier long before Talikota.
32. Deccan Sultanate common pattern used Persianate courts with local Telugu/Marathi/Kannada intermediaries under the five successor houses.
33. **Abul Hasan Tana Shah** is the last Qutb Shah memory paired with Aurangzeb's **1687** Golkonda annexation.
34. **Ibrahim Shah Sharqi**'s cultural peak (**Siraj-i-Hind**) is the UP Sharqi identity line before Lodi annexation.
35. **Chand Bibi** of Ahmadnagar is the Deccan defence memory against Akbar's late campaigns — do not place her at Talikota **1565**.
36. Post-Talikota Aravidu rulers shifted power southward; Hampi ceased to be the imperial capital after the **1565** sack.
37. **Vijayanagara Coinage:** The standard gold coin of Vijayanagara was the **Varaha (वराह / Pagoda)** weighing approximately **52 grains**, depicting images of Hindu deities like Venkateshwara, Shiva-Parvati, and Gandabherunda (double-headed eagle).
38. **Ayagar System (आयंगार व्यवस्था):** In Vijayanagara village administration, a body of **12 hereditary village functionaries** (known as Ayagars) conducted civil, judicial, and revenue duties, remunerated through tax-free village land grants called **Manya**.
39. **Nayankara System (नायंकर व्यवस्था):** The military-feudal system where the king granted territories called **Amaram** to military commanders (**Amaranayakas**) in lieu of service, troop maintenance, and fixed annual tribute to the royal treasury.
40. **Ibrahim Adil Shah II (इब्राहिम आदिल शाह द्वितीय)** of Bijapur was renowned for his profound religious syncretism, earning the popular titles **Jagat Guru (जगत गुरु)** and **Abla Baba (अबला बाबा / protector of the poor)**; he authored the musical treatise ***Kitab-i-Navras*** in Dakhini Urdu.
41. **Gol Gumbaz (गोल गुंबद)** at Bijapur, the mausoleum of Muhammad Adil Shah, features one of the largest single domes in the world (diameter 44 m) constructed without external pillar support, celebrated for its acoustic **Whispering Gallery**.
42. **Charminar (चारमीनार)** at Hyderabad was constructed in **1591 CE** by the fifth Qutb Shahi Sultan, **Muhammad Quli Qutb Shah**, to commemorate the eradication of a devastating plague epidemic and establish his new capital.
43. **Malik Ambar (मलिक अंबर)**, the Ethiopian (*Habshi*) prime minister of Ahmadnagar, pioneered guerrilla warfare (**Bargigiri / बर्गीगिरी**) in the Deccan against Mughal forces and introduced a systematic land revenue assessment based on the **Kathi** measuring rod.
44. **Zain-ul-Abidin (जैन-उल-आबिदीन)** constructed the artificial island **Zaina Lanka (जैना लंका)** in Wular Lake, established the translation bureau *Dar-ul-Tarjuma*, and was affectionately designated by Kashmiris as **Budshah (बड़शाह / Great King)**.
45. **Atala Masjid (अटाला मस्जिद)** in Jaunpur, completed in **1408 CE** by Sultan **Ibrahim Shah Sharqi**, represents the pinnacle of the Sharqi architectural style, featuring towering sloping pylon gateways (*propylons*) and no minarets.
46. **Hoshang Shah's Tomb** at **Mandu (Madhya Pradesh)** is celebrated as India's **earliest monumental edifice built entirely of white marble**, serving as an architectural prototype for Shah Jahan's Taj Mahal.
47. **Adina Mosque (अदीना मस्जिद)** at **Pandua (Bengal)**, constructed by Sultan Sikandar Shah in **1374 CE**, was the largest mosque in the entire Indian subcontinent, housing over 370 domed bays supported by basalt pillars.
48. **Alauddin Husain Shah** of Bengal was an enlightened patron of Bengali literature, conferring the titles ***Gunaraja Khan*** on Maladhar Basu (translator of Bhagavata into *Sri Krishna Vijaya*) and ***Satyaraja Khan*** on his son.
49. **Nicolo de Conti (निकोलो डी कोंटी)**, an Italian merchant, visited Vijayanagara in **1420 CE** during the reign of **Deva Raya I**, leaving detailed records of the city's vast 60-mile perimeter and the Diwali and Navaratri festivals.
50. **Abdur Razzaq (अब्दुर रज्जाक)**, the Persian ambassador from Timurid ruler Shah Rukh of Samarkand, visited Vijayanagara in **1443 CE** during the reign of **Deva Raya II**, writing: '*The eye has not seen, nor the ear heard of any place to resemble Vijayanagara upon the whole earth.*'

⏱ Timeline / Chronology

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[1336 CE] Vijayanagara Empire founded by Harihara I & Bukka I on Tungabhadra (Sangama dynasty)
   |
[1347 CE] Bahmani Kingdom founded by Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah (Hasan Gangu) at Gulbarga
   |
[1394 CE] Sharqi Sultanate established at Jaunpur by Malik Sarwar (Shiraz of the East)
   |
[1420–1470 CE] Golden Age of Kashmir under Sultan Zain-ul-Abidin (Akbar of Kashmir / Budshah)
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   |
[1481 CE] Mahmud Gawan executed; Bahmani Kingdom disintegrates into Five Deccan Sultanates
   |       └── Ahmadnagar (1490), Bijapur (1489), Berar (1490), Bidar (1492), Golconda (1512)
   |
[1509–1529 CE] Zenith of Vijayanagara under Krishnadeva Raya (Tuluva Dynasty)
   |
[23 Jan 1565] Battle of Talikota (Rakshasi-Tangadi): Deccan Alliance crushes Vijayanagara
   |           (Bijapur + Ahmadnagar + Golconda + Bidar; BERAR WAS ABSENT!)
   |
[1591 CE] Charminar built in Hyderabad by Muhammad Quli Qutb Shah
   |
[1686–1687 CE] Mughal annexation of Bijapur (1686) and Golconda (1687) by Aurangzeb
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Dynastic Evolution of Vijayanagara Empire (1336–1646 CE)

DYNASTY	PERIOD	FOUNDER	GREATEST / PIVOTAL RULER	CAPITAL	KEY HIGHLIGHTS
1. Sangama (संगम)	1336–1485 CE	Harihara I & Bukka I	**Deva Raya II** (*Gajabetekara*)	Hampi (Vijayanagara)	Vidyaranya spiritual guide; travelers Nicolo de Conti (1420) & Abdur Razzaq (1443)
2. Saluva (सालुव)	1485–1505 CE	Saluva Narasimha	Saluva Narasimha	Hampi	First Usurpation (*Prathama Balapaharana*); restored internal order against Gajapatis
3. Tuluva (तुलुव)	1505–1570 CE	Vira Narasimha	**Krishnadeva Raya** (1509–1529)	Hampi	Second Usurpation; Golden Age; Ashtadiggajas; Battle of Talikota (1565) under Rama Raya
4. Aravidu (आरविडु)	1570–c. 1646 CE	Tirumala Raya	Venkata II	Penukonda → Chandragiri	Capital shifted after Talikota; granted site of Madras to British East India Company (1639)

📊 Quick Reference Grid

1. The Five Deccan Sultanates (Disintegration of Bahmani Kingdom)

SULTANATE	DYNASTY NAME	YEAR FOUNDED	FOUNDER	CAPITAL	FINAL FATE / ANNEXATION
Bijapur	**Adil Shahi** (आदिल शाही)	1489 CE	**Yusuf Adil Shah**	Bijapur	Annexed by **Aurangzeb in 1686 CE**; built Gol Gumbaz
Ahmadnagar	**Nizam Shahi** (निज़ाम शाही)	1490 CE	**Malik Ahmad**	Junnar → Ahmadnagar	Annexed by **Shah Jahan in 1636 CE**; heroics of Chand Bibi & Malik Ambar
Berar	**Imad Shahi** (इमाद शाही)	1490 CE	**Fathullah Imad-ul-Mulk**	Gavilgad / Ellichpur	Annexed by **Ahmadnagar in 1574 CE**; **ABSENT from Talikota (1565)**
Bidar	**Barid Shahi** (बरीद शाही)	1492 / 1528 CE	**Qasim Barid**	Bidar	Annexed by **Bijapur in 1619 CE**
Golconda	**Qutb Shahi** (कुतुब शाही)	1512 CE	**Sultan Quli Qutb Shah**	Golconda / Hyderabad	Annexed by **Aurangzeb in 1687 CE**; built Charminar; diamond mines

2. Foreign Travelers to Vijayanagara & Medieval Regional Courts

TRAVELER	ORIGIN COUNTRY	PERIOD / YEAR	RULER'S REIGN	CAPITAL / PLACE	KEY CHRONICLE / HISTORIC OBSERVATION
Nicolo de Conti	Italy (Venice)	1420–1421 CE	**Deva Raya I** (Sangama)	Vijayanagara	Recorded 60-mile city circumference, 90,000 armed men, Navaratri and Diwali
Abdur Razzaq	Persia (Herat)	1443–1444 CE	**Deva Raya II** (Sangama)	Vijayanagara	Envoy of Shah Rukh; described 7 concentric circular fortification walls and bazaars
Athanasius Nikitin	Russia (Tver)	1470–1474 CE	Muhammad Shah III / Mahmud Gawan	**Bahmani Kingdom** (Bidar)	Author of *Voyage Beyond the Three Seas*; noted sharp contrast between royal luxury and peasant poverty
Ludovico di Varthema	Italy (Bologna)	1502–1508 CE	Vira Narasimha (Tuluva)	Vijayanagara & Malabar	Detailed commercial report on horse trade and port operations
Duarte Barbosa	Portugal	1516–1518 CE	**Krishnadeva Raya** (Tuluva)	Vijayanagara & Gujarat	Detailed description of religious liberty, sati, King Mahmud Begarha's dietary legends
Domingo Paes	Portugal	1520–1522 CE	**Krishnadeva Raya** (Tuluva)	Vijayanagara	Described Krishnadeva Raya's physical appearance, Mahanavami festival, irrigation tanks
Fernao Nuniz	Portugal	1535–1537 CE	**Achyuta Deva Raya** (Tuluva)	Vijayanagara	Chronicled history of Vijayanagara from its foundation, Mahanavami sacrifice, women in royal palace
Caesar Frederick	Italy (Venice)	1567–1568 CE	Tirumala Raya (Aravidu)	Vijayanagara (Ruins)	Documented the desolate condition of Vijayanagara two years after the sack of Talikota

3. Regional Medieval Monuments & Architectural Milestones

MONUMENT	LOCATION	BUILDER / PATRON	REGIONAL SULTANATE / STATE	UNIQUE ARCHITECTURAL CHARACTERISTIC
Atala Masjid	Jaunpur (UP)	Sultan Ibrahim Shah Sharqi (**1408 CE**)	Sharqi Sultanate	Massive sloping arched pylons (*propylons*); no minarets; built on Atala Devi temple base
Jhanjhari & Lal Darwaza Masjid	Jaunpur (UP)	Ibrahim Shah & Queen Bibi Raji	Sharqi Sultanate	Fine screens (*jhanjharis*); indigenous Hindu stone carving motifs
Gol Gumbaz	Bijapur (Karnataka)	Muhammad Adil Shah (**1656 CE**)	Adil Shahi of Bijapur	Massive unsupported hemispherical dome; world-famous acoustic **Whispering Gallery**
Charminar	Hyderabad (Telangana)	Muhammad Quli Qutb Shah (**1591 CE**)	Qutb Shahi of Golconda	Four grand 48 m minarets, stucco decorations, commemorating eradication of plague
Hoshang Shah's Tomb	Mandu (Madhya Pradesh)	Hoshang Shah / Mahmud Khalji	Malwa Sultanate	**First full-marble tomb in India**; recessed arches, yellow marble inlays; prototype for Taj
Jahaz Mahal & Hindola Mahal	Mandu (Madhya Pradesh)	Ghiyasuddin Khalji	Malwa Sultanate	Jahaz Mahal looks like a ship floating between two artificial lakes (Kapur & Munj)
Adina Mosque	Pandua (Bengal)	Sultan Sikandar Shah (**1374 CE**)	Bengal Sultanate	Largest mosque in India at the time; 370 domed bays; central barrel-vaulted iwan
Hazara Rama Temple	Hampi (Karnataka)	**Krishnadeva Raya**	Vijayanagara Empire	Private royal temple; bas-relief carvings narrating the complete *Ramayana* epic
Vittala Temple Complex	Hampi (Karnataka)	Deva Raya II / Krishnadeva Raya	Vijayanagara Empire	Renowned monolithic **Stone Chariot** (*Garuda Shrine*) and 56 musical acoustic pillars
Bara Sona & Chhota Sona Masjid	Gaur (Bengal)	Nusrat Shah & Wali Muhammad	Bengal Sultanate	Brick and terracotta architecture with carved stone facing; curved Bengali eaves (*chala*)

🧠 Memory Anchors & Mnemonics

1. **Vijayanagara Dynasties Order: S–S–T–A** - **S**angama (1336–1485) — Founded by Harihara & Bukka - **S**aluva (1485–1505) — Founded by Saluva Narasimha - **T**uluva (1505–1570) — Golden Age of **Krishnadeva Raya** - **A**ravidu (1570–1646) — Capital moved to Penukonda / Chandragiri - *Mnemonic Hook:* "South States Take Action"
2. **The Talikota Alliance Formula (23 January 1565):** - **B–A–G–B (Bijapur + Ahmadnagar + Golconda + Bidar)** - *SUPER TRAP ALERT:* **Berar was ABSENT!** (Due to intense inter-state rivalry with Ahmadnagar).
3. **Krishnadeva Raya's Literary Triad:** - ***Amuktamalyada:*** Masterpiece on statecraft and politics written in **Telugu**. - ***Jambavati Kalyanam:*** Sanskrit drama on Krishna and Jambavati. - ***Usha Parinayam:*** Sanskrit poetic work. - Court Jewel: **Ashtadiggajas** (Eight great Telugu poets

led by Allasani Peddana).

4. **Deccan Sultanates & Founder Matching Hook:** - **Adil** = **B**ijapur (**A–B**) - **Nizam** = **A**hmadnagar (**N–A**) - **Qutb** = **G**olconda (**Q–G**) - **Imad** = **B**erar (**I–B**) - **Barid** = **B**idar (**B–B**)
5. **Zain-ul-Abidin's Reforms ("Budshah"):** - **A**bolished Jizya & cow slaughter - **B**rought back exiled Kashmiri Pandits - **C**reated *Dar-ul-Tarjuma* (translated Mahabharata & Rajatarangini into Persian) - **D**eveloped Zaina Lanka artificial island in Wular Lake.

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill

> **Mastery Rule:** Read the consolidated facts above, attempt these high-yield questions, and score ≥80% to conquer this chapter.

Q1. With reference to Sharqi Jaunpur, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Firuz Shah founded the city in memory of cousin Jauna Khan.
2. Malik Sarwar made it independent about 1394.
3. Ibrahim Shah made it Siraj / Shiraz-i-Hind.

A. 1 and 2 B. 1, 2 and 3 C. 2 and 3 D. Only 1

▶ Details

Q3. Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): The Battle of Talikota (1565) crippled Vijayanagara as a great power.

Reason (R): A Deccan alliance killed Rama Raya and sacked Hampi.

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) B. (A) is false, but (R) is true C. (A) is true, but (R) is false D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

▶ Details

Q5. Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Riyaz-ul-Insha — Mahmud Gawan's letters
2. Riyaz-us-Salatin — Bengal history
3. Riyaz-us-Salatin — Gawan's official letters

A. 1 only B. 3 only C. 2 and 3 only D. 1 and 2 only

▶ Details

Q7. Consider the following statements about Bahmani administration:

1. Hasan Gangu founded Bahmani as Alauddin Bahman Shah in 1347.
2. Mahmud Gawan organised eight tarafs.
3. Gawan was executed in 1481.

A. Only 1 B. Only 1 and 2 C. 1, 2 and 3 D. 2 and 3

▶ Details

Q9. Match List-I with List-II:

LIST-I	LIST-II
A. Ahmadnagar	1. Barid Shahi
B. Bidar	2. Nizam Shahi
C. Berar	3. Imad Shahi
D. Kitab-i-Nauras	4. Ibrahim Adil Shah II

Row order is not the answer code.

Code:

A. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4 B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3 C. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4 D. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

▶ Details

Q11. Which one of the following is NOT correctly matched?

A. Atala Masjid — Sharqi Jaunpur B. Teen Darwaza — also Bidar Fort's only name for the same gate C. Tin Darwaza — Bidar Fort D. Lal Darwaza Masjid — Sharqi Jaunpur

▶ Details

Q13. Consider the following statements:

1. Nayankara / amara is identical with Delhi Sultanate iqta practice.
2. Nayankara is identical with Delhi Sultanate iqta.
3. Mahanavami was a major Vijayanagara festival.

A. 1 and 2

B. 2 and 3

C. Only 3

D. 1 and 3

▶ Details

Q15. Arrange Vijayanagara dynasty houses in order:

1. Tuluva
2. Sangama
3. Aravidu
4. Saluva

A. 2–4–1–3 B. 2–1–4–3 C. 4–2–1–3 D. 2–4–3–1

▶ Show answer

Chapter 06: Bhakti & Sufi Movements

📰 Current Affairs & High-Yield Updates

YEAR/REF	KEY FACT	EXAM RELEVANCE
2023–2024	**Sant Mirabai 525th Birth Anniversary:** National celebrations in Mathura; release of **₹525 commemorative silver coin** and stamp	UPPCS tests Mirabai's Guru (Sant Ravidas), family ties (Merta, Mewar / Rana Sanga's son Bhojraj), and devotion in Brajbhasha
Aug 2023	**Sant Ravidas Memorial & Temple (Badtuma, Sagar, MP):** Foundation laid for ₹100 crore grand memorial complex	Sant Ravidas was born in Varanasi (Seer Goverdhanpur), disciple of Ramananda, prominent Nirguna Bhakti poet; heavily tested in UP-PCS
Dec 2023	**Veer Bal Diwas (26 December):** National observance commemorating the supreme sacrifice of **Sahibzada Zorawar Singh and Sahibzada Fateh Singh**	Sons of 10th Sikh Guru Gobind Singh executed at Sirhind under Mughal governor Wazir Khan in 1704 CE
2022–2024	**Statue of Equality (Hyderabad) & Statue of Oneness (Omkareshwar):** Commemorating **Ramanujacharya** (1,000th birth yr) & **Adi Shankaracharya** (108 ft)	Tests *Vishishtadvaita* vs *Advaita* Vedanta, four cardinal mathas, and Srirangam temple traditions
2023–2024	**Maghar Kabir Mahotsav (Sant Kabir Nagar, UP):** Cultural and spiritual circuit development	Kabir breathed his last at Maghar (UP) to shatter the superstition of Kashi vs Maghar; tests *Bijak*, *Sakhi*, and weaver background

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. Southern Bhakti began with **Nayanars (नायनार) (Shiva)** and **Alvars (आलवार) (Vishnu)** in **7th–12th** century Tamil land, before the north Indian sant wave.
2. The north chain runs roughly **Namdev → Ramananda → Kabir → Nanak → Chaitanya → Surdas → Tulsidas**.
3. **Saguna** (सगुण) bhakti worships a formed deity such as Rama or Krishna (कृष्ण); **Nirguna** (निर्गुण) worships the formless One (Kabir, Nanak).
4. Guru–disciple facts: **Kabir** (कबीर) and **Ravidas** under **Ramananda**; **Surdas** under **Vallabhacharya** (शुद्धाद्वैत); **Amir Khusrau** (अमीर खुसरो) under **Nizamuddin Auliya**; **Mardana** (मरदाना) under **Guru Nanak** (गुरु नानक).
5. Saint chronology: **Namdev** (नामदेव) (~1270–1350) → **Kabir** (15th c.) → **Nanak** (1469–1539) → **Chaitanya** (चैतन्य) (1486–1533).
6. Later saints: **Surdas** (1478–1581) → **Tulsidas** (तुलसीदास) (1532–1623) → **Dadu Dayal** (1544–1603).
7. The **Chishti** line runs **Moinuddin → Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki → Baba Farid → Nizamuddin → Nasiruddin Chiragh**, stressing poverty, **sama** (समा), and ziyarat.
8. Great Chishti shrines include **Ajmer** (अजमेर), **Delhi (Nizamuddin)**, **Ajodhan (Farid)**, **Nagaur**, and **Pakpattan**.
9. **Suhrawardi** saints of Multan accepted state wealth; **Naqshbandi** reformers under **Ahmad Sirhindi** opposed syncretism.
10. **Qadiri** order entered India later (famous Multan–Uch and Deccan links); do not merge it with Chishti poverty or Suhrawardi office-holding.
11. **Ramcharitmanas** (रामचरितमानस) is Tulsidas in **Awadhi** (अवधी); **Sursagar** (सूरसागर) is Surdas in **Braj** (ब्रज).
12. **Fawaid-ul-Fuad** records **Nizamuddin** conversations compiled by **Amir Hasan Sijzi**, not by Amir Khusrau.
13. Vedanta schools: **Shankara (शंकराचार्य)–Advaita (अद्वैत)**; **Ramanuja (रामानुजाचार्य)–Vishishtadvaita (विशिष्टाद्वैत)**; **Madhva–Dvaita (द्वैत)**; **Nimbarka (द्वैताद्वैत)–Dvaitadvaita (द्वैताद्वैत)**; **Vallabhacharya–Shuddhadvaita (शुद्धाद्वैत)**.
14. **Ramananda** (born **Prayag** (प्रयाग), ~1299) taught Rama bhakti in **Hindi** first among north sants; do not confuse with south **Ramanuja** (Vishishtadvaita).
15. **Basavanna** led Lingayat / Virashaiva reform in Karnataka with **Ishtalinga**, Kayaka, and Anubhava Mantapa.
16. The **Varkari** tradition centres on **Pandharpur / Vithoba** through **Jnaneshwar** (ज्ञानेश्वरी), Namdev, and Tukaram (तुकाराम).
17. **Jayadeva** wrote **Gita Govinda** (गीत गोविंद) in Odisha; **Shankaradeva** led Assam Vaishnavism (वैष्णव) with **satra** and **kirtana-ghosha**.
18. UP Kabir facts: **Bijak** (बीजक) (Ramaini/Sabda/Sakhi); dialogues with **Dharamdas** = *Amarmul* (अमरमूल); death at **Maghar** (Sant Kabir Nagar).
19. **Tulsidas** belongs to Awadhi **UP**; **Surdas** to the **Braj** belt (Mathura (मथुरा)–Vrindavan (वृंदावन)); **Gorakhnath** to **Gorakhpur** (गोरखपुर).
20. **Nath / Nathpanthi** yogis under **Gorakhnath** stress Hatha yoga and guru lineage; they are distinct from north nirguna sants and from Chishti Sufis.
21. **Mirabai** (मीराबाई) is the Rajasthan Krishna devotee; **Andal** (आंडाल) is the Tamil Alvar (आलवार) woman saint — do not swap them.
22. **Chaitanya** of Bengal taught **Gaudiya Vaishnavism** with **sankirtan** and ecstatic Krishna bhakti; do not merge him with Kabir's nirguna line.
23. **Guru Nanak** taught **Ik Onkar**, the householder path, **langar**, and **sangat**; he founded Sikhism, not a Kabirpanth offshoot.
24. **Baba Farid** was the Chishti saint of Ajodhan with verses in the **Adi Granth** (आदि ग्रंथ); he is not Kabir.

25. **Chishti** orders rejected state wealth; **Suhrawardi** accepted patronage and office.
26. A **pir** (पीर) is the Sufi spiritual master; a **guru** is the Bhakti preceptor.
27. **Narsi Mehta** belongs to Gujarat; **Namdev** is an early Vithoba / Varkari saint.
28. Bhakti was mainly **intra-Hindu** reform against empty ritual (कर्मकांड), not a movement "against Islam," though it shared social space with Sufism.
29. **Moinuddin** (disciple of **Usman Haruni**) settled **Ajmer**; order name from **Chisht (Afghanistan)** (चिश्ती), not a village in Ajmer. **Bahauddin Zakariya** = **Multan** (Suhrawardi).
30. **Ravidas** is the Banaras Dalit (दलित) saint in Ramananda's circle.
31. Composite culture does not mean every saint mixed doctrines — **Ahmad Sirhindi** and **Kabir** rejected syncretic ritual.
32. Regional map: **Jayadeva** (Odisha), **Shankaradeva** / Ekasarana (**Kamarupa–Assam**), **Basavanna** (Karnataka). **Prem Vatika** (प्रेम वाटिका) = **Raskhan**; **Barahmasa** = **Malik Muhammad Jayasi** (मलिक मुहम्मद जायसी); **Dewa Sharif** (देवा शरीफ) (Barabanki) = Haji Waris Ali Shah (हाजी वारिस अली शाह).
33. **Ulema** are sharia scholars; a **Shaikh** is the authorised Sufi guide — do not treat every ulema as a silsilah pir.
34. **Firdausi / Firdausi order** memory in Bihar (Yahya Maneri line) is separate from the Delhi–Ajmer **Chishti** core.
35. **Dadu Dayal** of Rajasthan taught nirguna devotion after Kabir's generation; keep him after Surdas–Tulsidas in the later sant list.
36. **Akka Mahadevi** (Kannada Virashaiva woman saint) pairs with Basavanna's Karnataka reform, not with Mirabai's Rajasthan Krishna bhakti.
37. **Nayanar Canon (तिरुमुराई / Tirumurai):** The 63 Shaivite Nayanars' devotional hymns were compiled into the 12-volume *Tirumurai* by **Nambiyandar Nambi**; the first seven volumes are celebrated as the **Tevaram** (hymns of Appar, Sambandar, and Sundarar).
38. **Alvar Canon (नालयिर दिव्य प्रबंधम्):** The 12 Vaishnavite Alvars' 4,000 Tamil verses were compiled by **Nathamuni** into the ***Nalayira Divya Prabandham***, often revered as the 'Tamil Veda'.
39. **Andal (आंडाल):** The only female Alvar saint, renowned as the 'Mirabai of the South', composed the devotional Tamil masterpieces ***Tiruppavai*** and ***Nachiyar Tirumozhi*** in ecstatic devotion to Lord Ranganatha.
40. **Shankaracharya's Four Cardinal Mathas (चार धाम पीठ):** Established in four corners of India to preserve Advaita Vedanta: **Sringeri Sharada Peetham** (South/Karnataka), **Govardhana Matha at Puri** (East/Odisha), **Kalika Matha at Dwarka** (West/Gujarat), and **Jyotirmath at Badrinath** (North/Uttarakhand).
41. **Statue of Equality (Hyderabad):** A 216-foot metallic statue inaugurated in 2022 to commemorate the 1,000th birth anniversary of **Ramanujacharya (1017–1137 CE)**, the propounder of **Vishishtadvaita (qualified non-dualism)**.
42. **Ramananda's Vernacular Revolution:** Ramananda was the first religious reformer in northern India to abandon Sanskrit and use **vernacular Hindi** for preaching, democratizing Bhakti across caste and gender divides.
43. **Kabir's Death at Maghar (मघहर):** Defying the orthodox Hindu superstition that dying in Kashi ensures heaven while dying in Maghar leads to rebirth as a donkey, Kabir intentionally traveled to **Maghar (Sant Kabir Nagar, UP)** to breathe his last.
44. **Guru Nanak's Institutions:** Founded **Sangat (संगत / holy congregation)** and **Pangat / Langar (पंगत / लंगर / free community kitchen)**, establishing radical social equality where princes and peasants ate identical food side by side.
45. **Chaitanya Mahaprabhu (चैतन्य महाप्रभु):** Popularized **Sankirtana (सामूहिक संकीर्तन / congregational singing of God's names with cymbals and mridanga)** and propounded the theological doctrine of ***Achintya Bhedabheda*** (inconceivable simultaneous oneness and difference).
46. **Shankardev (श्रीमंत शंकरदेव):** Founded the **Ekasarana Dharma** in 15th-century Assam, establishing prayer halls called **Namghars**, monastic institutions called **Sattras**, and inventing the classical dance form **Sattriya** and theatrical form **Ankiya Nat**.
47. **Varkari vs Dharakari Sampradaya:** The **Varkari** sect in Maharashtra focuses on peaceful pilgrimage to Lord Vithoba of Pandharpur (**Dnyaneshwar, Namdev, Tukaram**); the **Dharakari** sect emphasizes active, militant protection of dharma (**Samarth Ramdas**, spiritual mentor of Chhatrapati Shivaji).
48. **Sheikh Nizamuddin Auliya's Famous Retort:** When Sultan Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq threatened him while marching back to Delhi from Bengal, Nizamuddin calmly remarked: ***'Hunuz Dilli Dur Ast' (हनूज़ दिल्ली दूर अस्त / Delhi is still far away)***; the Sultan died at Afghanpur before entering Delhi.
49. **Sheikh Ahmad Sirhindi (Mujaddid Alif Sani):** Leader of the Naqshbandi order who spearheaded the orthodox Islamic reaction against Akbar's liberal religious policies and *Din-i-Ilahi*, advocating the doctrine of ***Wahdat-ul-Shuhud*** (unity of witness) against Ibn Arabi's ***Wahdat-ul-Wujud*** (unity of being).
50. **Dara Shikoh's Syncretic Masterpieces:** Patron of the Qadiri Sufi order; translated 52 Upanishads into Persian under the title ***Sirr-i-Akbar*** (The Great Secret) and authored ***Majma-ul-Bahrain*** (The Mingling of the Two Oceans), asserting the fundamental metaphysical identity of Vedanta and Sufism.

⏱ Timeline / Chronology

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[8th c. CE] Adi Shankaracharya (Advaita Vedanta; established 4 Cardinal Mathas)
   |
[11th–12th c. CE] Ramanujacharya (Vishishtadvaita; Srirangam; Bhakti in South)
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[1192 CE] Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti arrives in India with Muhammad Ghori (Ajmer Dargah)
   |
[13th c. CE] Madhvacharya (Dvaita) & Nimbarkacharya (Dvaitadvaita)
   |
[14th c. CE] Ramananda bridges South & North Bhakti in Hindi (Varanasi); Baba Farid (Pakpattan)
   |
[c. 1398–1518 CE] Kabir Das (Nirguna; Bijak; Varanasi & Maghar)
   |
[1469–1539 CE] Guru Nanak Dev (Nirguna; founded Sikhism; Sangat & Pangat)
   |
[1479–1531 CE] Vallabhacharya (Shuddhadvaita; Pushtimarg; Ashtachhap)
   |
[1486–1534 CE] Chaitanya Mahaprabhu (Gaudiya Vaishnavism; Achintya Bhedabheda; Sankirtana)
   |
[1498–1547 CE] Mirabai (Krishna devotion; Merta / Mewar / Vrindavan / Dwarka)
   |
[1532–1623 CE] Goswami Tulsidas (Ramcharitmanas in Awadhi; contemporary of Akbar)
   |
[17th c. CE] Maharashtra Saints: Tukaram (Abhangas) & Samarth Ramdas (Dasbodh; Shivaji's Guru)
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Chronological Ladder of Major Bhakti & Sufi Saints

SAINT / REFORMER	ERA / CENTURY	REGION / ORIGIN	CORE PHILOSOPHY / ORDER	MAJOR LITERARY WORK / LANDMARK
Adi Shankaracharya	c. 788–820 CE	Kaladi, Kerala	**Advaita** (Absolute Monism)	Commentaries on Brahma Sutras, Upanishads, Gita; 4 Mathas
Ramanujacharya	1017–1137 CE	Sriperumbudur, TN	**Vishishtadvaita** (Qualified Monism)	*Sri Bhashya*, *Gitabhashya*; worship of Vishnu/Narayana
Madhvacharya	1238–1317 CE	Udupi, Karnataka	**Dvaita** (Strict Dualism)	*Anuvyakhyana*; world and God are eternally distinct
Nimbarkacharya	13th Century CE	Andhra / Vrindavan	**Dvaitadvaita** (Bhedabheda)	*Vedanta Parijata Saurabha*; Radha-Krishna worship
Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti	1143–1236 CE	Sistan → Ajmer	**Chishti Silsila**	Ajmer Dargah (*Gharib Nawaz*); love for humanity and Sama
Ramananda	c. 14th Century	Prayagraj → Varanasi	Vaishnava / Rama Bhakti	First to preach in **Hindi**; 12 diverse-caste disciples
Kabir Das	c. 1398–1518 CE	Varanasi, UP	**Nirguna** Monotheism	*Bijak* (Sakhi, Sabad, Ramaini); died in Maghar
Guru Nanak Dev	1469–1539 CE	Talwandi, Punjab	**Nirguna** Sikhism	*Japji Sahib*; Sangat, Pangat, Guru ka Langar
Vallabhacharya	1479–1531 CE	Varanasi / Champaran	**Shuddhadvaita** (Pure Monism)	*Anubhashya*, *Subodhini*; **Pushtimarg** (Path of Grace)
Chaitanya Mahaprabhu	1486–1534 CE	Nadia, Bengal	**Achintya Bhedabheda**	Gaudiya Vaishnavism; congregational **Sankirtana**
Shankardev	1449–1568 CE	Assam (Brahmaputra)	**Ekasarana Dharma**	*Kirtana Ghosha*; Namghars, Sattras, and **Sattriya** dance
Mirabai	1498–1547 CE	Kudki, Merta (Rajasthan)	Saguna Krishna Bhakti	*Padavali*, *Rag Govind*; total surrender to Giridhar Gopal
Surdas	1478–1583 CE	Runkata / Agra (UP)	Saguna Krishna Bhakti	*Sur Sagar*, *Sur Saravali*, *Sahitya Lahari*; Ashtachhap head
Goswami Tulsidas	1532–1623 CE	Rajapur, Chitrakoot (UP)	Saguna Rama Bhakti	*Ramcharitmanas* (Awadhi), *Vinaya Patrika*, *Kavitavali*
Sant Tukaram	1608–1650 CE	Dehu, Maharashtra	Varkari Sampradaya	*Tukaram Gatha* (Abhangas); contemporary of Shivaji
Samarth Ramdas	1608–1681 CE	Jamb, Maharashtra	Dharakari Sampradaya	*Dasbodh*; spiritual guide and mentor to Chhatrapati Shivaji

📊 Quick Reference Grid

1. Six Schools of Vedanta Philosophy (High-Yield UPPCS Match List)

PHILOSOPHICAL DOCTRINE (DARSHANA)	MEANING / ENGLISH EQUIVALENT	PROPOUNDER / ACHARYA	THEOLOGICAL CONCEPTION OF GOD & SOUL
Advaita (अद्वैतवाद)	Absolute Monism (Non-Dualism)	**Adi Shankaracharya**	Brahman alone is real; world is Maya (illusion); Atman is identical with Brahman
Vishishtadvaita (विशिष्टाद्वैतवाद)	Qualified Non-Dualism	**Ramanujacharya**	Brahman is qualified by Cit (conscious souls) and Acit (matter); devotion leads to grace
Dvaita (द्वैतवाद)	Strict Dualism	**Madhvacharya**	God (Vishnu), soul (Jiva), and matter (Jada) are eternally distinct entities
Dvaitadvaita (द्वैताद्वैतवाद)	Dualistic Non-Dualism (Bhedabheda)	**Nimbarkacharya**	Soul and world are both distinct and non-distinct from God (like sun and its rays)
Shuddhadvaita (शुद्धाद्वैतवाद)	Pure Non-Dualism	**Vallabhacharya**	World is real (not Maya), an untainted manifestation of Krishna; **Pushtimarg**
Achintya Bhedabheda (अचिन्त्य भेदाभेद)	Inconceivable Oneness & Difference	**Chaitanya Mahaprabhu**	Soul is simultaneously one with and different from Krishna, incomprehensible to intellect

2. Major Sufi Silsilas (Orders) in India

SUFI SILSILA (ORDER)	KEY FOUNDING SAINTS IN INDIA	HEADQUARTERS / CENTER	SALIENT PRACTICES & ROYAL RELATIONS
Chishti (चिश्ती)	Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti, Bakhtiyar Kaki, Baba Farid, Nizamuddin Auliya	**Ajmer, Delhi, Pakpattan**	Practiced **Sama (musical audition)**; strict poverty; **shunned state service and royal courts**
Suhrawardi (सुहरावर्दी)	Sheikh Bahauddin Zakariya, Ruknuddin Abul Fath	**Multan & Uch (Sind/Punjab)**	**Accepted royal patronage and state offices**; lived comfortably; rejected extreme austerities
Qadiri (कादिरी)	Shah Niyamatullah, Muhammad Ghaus, Mian Mir, Mullah Shah	**Punjab, Sindh, Agra**	Moderate and orthodox; musical recitation allowed; patronized by **Prince Dara Shikoh**
Naqshbandi (नक़्शबंदी)	Khwaja Baqi Billah, **Sheikh Ahmad Sirhindi**	**Delhi & Sirhind (Punjab)**	**Most orthodox and puritanical**; totally rejected music (Sama) and non-Islamic practices; favored by **Aurangzeb**
Firdausi (फिरदौसी)	Sheikh Sharafuddin Yahya Maneri	**Bihar Sharif (Bihar)**	Offshoot of Suhrawardi; active social service and compilation of spiritual letters (*Maktubat*)
Shattari (शत्तारी)	Shah Abdullah Shattari, Muhammad Ghaus	**Malwa & Gwalior (MP)**	Synthesized Sufi mysticism with Hindu Yogic breath control; **Muhammad Ghaus mentored Tansen**

3. Disciples of Swami Ramananda (Social Diversity of Medieval Bhakti)

DISCIPLE	SOCIAL / CASTE BACKGROUND	REGION / CENTER	SPIRITUAL LEGACY
Kabir Das	**Julaha (Weaver / जुलाहा)**	Varanasi (UP)	Foremost Nirguna poet; denounced ritualism, idolatry, and caste hierarchy
Ravidas (Raidas)	**Chamar (Leather Worker / चर्मकार)**	Varanasi (UP)	Envisioned **Begampura** (city without sorrow); spiritual guru of Mirabai
Sena	**Nai (Barber / नाई)**	Rewa (MP)	Court barber who served God; hymns incorporated into Guru Granth Sahib
Sadhana	**Qasai (Butcher / कसाई)**	Sehwan (Sindh)	Taught that spiritual purity is internal and independent of worldly occupation
Dhanna	**Jat Farmer (किसान)**	Tonk (Rajasthan)	Renowned for unwavering, simple rural faith; worshipped divine in agricultural toil
Pipa	**Rajput Prince / King (राजा)**	Gagraun (Rajasthan)	King of Gagraun who renounced royal throne to embrace spiritual mendicancy
Padmavati & Surasari	**Women Ascetics (महिलाएं)**	Varanasi (UP)	Symbolized total gender equality in Ramananda's spiritual brotherhood

4. Maharashtra Dharma & Varkari Saints

SAINT	ERA	LITERARY MASTERPIECE	KEY CONTRIBUTION & EXAM ANCHOR
Dnyaneshwar (Jnaneshwar)	1275–1296 CE	***Bhavartha Dipika*** (*Dnyaneshwari*)	Oldest Marathi commentary on Bhagavad Gita; laid foundation of Varkari movement at Alandi
Namdev	1270–1350 CE	Verses in *Guru Granth Sahib*	Tailor by caste; traveled to Punjab; preached intense personal love for Lord Vitthala
Eknath	1533–1599 CE	***Bhavartha Ramayana***	Promoted Marathi as equal to Sanskrit; emphasized compassion toward untouchables
Sant Tukaram	1608–1650 CE	***Tukaram Gatha*** (*Abhangas*)	Shudra grain-merchant from Dehu; singing Abhangas inspired Shivaji's national awakening
Samarth Ramdas	1608–1681 CE	***Dasbodh***	Established Maruti (Hanuman) temples across Maharashtra; spiritual inspiration for Maratha Swaraj

🧠 Memory Anchors & Mnemonics

1. **Vedanta Philosophies Matching Formula:** - **A–S: A**dvaita = **S**hankaracharya - **V–R: V**ishishtadvaita = **R**amanujacharya - **D–M: D**vaita = **M**adhvacharya - **DV–N: D**vaitadvaita = **N**imbarkacharya - **S–V: S**huddhadvaita = **V**allabhacharya - **A–C: A**chintya = **C**haitanya
2. **Chishti Saints Spiritual Chronology: M–B–F–N–N** - **M**oinuddin Chishti (Ajmer) - **B**akhtiyar Kaki (Delhi) - **F**ariduddin Ganj-i-Shakar / Baba Farid (Pakpattan) - **N**izamuddin Auliya (Delhi) - **N**asiruddin Chirag-i-Dehlavi (Delhi)
3. **Maharashtra Saints Succession Order: J–N–E–T–R** - **J**naneshwar (13th c.) → **N**amdev (14th c.) → **E**knath (16th c.) → **T**ukaram (17th c.) → **R**amdas (17th c.) - *Mnemonic Hook:* "Just Name Every True Ruler"
4. **Saguna vs Nirguna Bhakti Classification:** - **Nirguna (Formless God):** Kabir, Guru Nanak, Dadu Dayal, Sant Ravidas, Malukdas. - **Saguna Rama Bhakti:** Ramananda, Goswami Tulsidas, Nabhadasa. - **Saguna Krishna Bhakti:** Vallabhacharya, Surdas, Mirabai, Chaitanya Mahaprabhu, Shankardev.
5. **Sufi Terms Quick Anchor:** - **Khanqah:** Sufi hospice / monastery. - **Sama:** Spiritual musical gathering. - **Ziyarat:** Pilgrimage to Sufi tombs (*Dargahs*). - **Murid:** Disciple; **Pir / Murshid:** Spiritual master. - **Fana:** Spiritual annihilation of individual ego in God.

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill

> **Mastery Rule:** Read the consolidated facts above, attempt these high-yield questions, and score ≥80% to conquer this chapter.

Q1. With reference to early southern Bhakti, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Nayanars were Shiva devotees.
2. Alvars were Vishnu devotees.
3. Both traditions flourished mainly in 7th–12th century Tamil land before the north sant wave.

A. Only 2 and 3 B. Only 1 C. 1 and 2 D. Only 1, 2 and 3

▶ Details

Q3. Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Saguna bhakti worships a formed deity such as Rama or Krishna.

Reason (R): Nirguna bhakti, as in Kabir and Nanak, worships the formless One.

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) B. (A) is false, but (R) is true C. (A) is true, but (R) is false D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

▶ Details

Q5. Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Ramananda — north Rama bhakti; Prayag birth; Hindi teaching
2. Ramanuja — south Vishishtadvaita philosopher
3. Ramananda — identical with Ramanuja as the same person

A. 1 only B. 3 only C. 2 and 3 only D. 1 and 2 only

▶ Details

Q7. Consider the following guru–disciple pairs:

1. Ramananda — Kabir and Ravidas
2. Vallabhacharya — Surdas

3. Nizamuddin Auliya — Amir Khusrau

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

A. Only 1 B. Only 1 and 2 C. All 1, 2 and 3 D. 2 and 3

▶ Details

Q9. Match List-I with List-II (Vedanta school ↔ founder):

LIST-I	LIST-II
A. Advaita	1. Ramanuja
B. Vishishtadvaita	2. Shankara
C. Dvaita	3. Madhva
D. Shuddhadvaita	4. Vallabhacharya

Row order is not the answer code.

Code:

A. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4 B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3 C. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4 D. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

▶ Details

Q11. Which one of the following is NOT correctly matched?

A. Andal — Tamil Alvar woman saint B. Baba Farid — nirguna Kashi weaver identical with Kabir C. Baba Farid — Chishti saint of Ajodhan; verses in Adi Granth D. Mirabai — Rajasthan Krishna devotee

▶ Details

Q13. Consider the following statements about Sufi orders:

1. Suhrawardi Multan saints accepted state wealth.
2. Naqshbandi reformers under Ahmad Sirhindi opposed syncretism.
3. Moinuddin's order name comes from Chisht in Afghanistan, not a village in Ajmer.

A. Only 1 B. Only 1 and 2 C. Only 1, 2 and 3 D. Only 2 and 3

▶ Details

Q15. Arrange the Chishti succession correctly:

1. Nizamuddin
2. Moinuddin
3. Baba Farid
4. Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki

A. 2–4–3–1 B. 2–3–4–1 C. 4–2–3–1 D. 2–4–1–3

▶ Show answer

Chapter 07: Medieval Literature & Chronicles

📰 Current Affairs & High-Yield Updates

YEAR/REF	KEY FACT	EXAM RELEVANCE
2023–2024	**National Manuscripts Mission & Rampur Raza Library:** Digitization of illustrated Mughal manuscripts including *Razmnama* and *Padshahnama*	UPPCS tests Persian translation bureau (*Maktab Khana*) under Akbar, Badauni's translations, and Lahori's *Padshahnama*
2024	**Amir Khusrau Heritage Memorials:** Cultural restoration at Kasganj (Patiyali, UP - birthplace of Amir Khusrau)	Amir Khusrau was born in **Patiyali (Kasganj, UP)** in 1253 CE; heavily tested in UP-PCS Prelims & UP Special
2023	**Al-Biruni International Conference:** Commemorating 1,050th birth anniversary of Abu Raihan al-Biruni (born 973 CE)	Al-Biruni's *Kitab-al-Hind*, mathematical methods, Arabic composition, and travels with Mahmud Ghazni
2023–2024	**Awadhi Literary Circuits:** Development of Jaisi Smarak at Amethi / Jais (UP)	Malik Muhammad Jaisi authored ***Padmavat*** in Awadhi in 1540 CE during the reign of **Sher Shah Suri**
2024	**Dara Shikoh Academic Chair & Monument Search:** Archaeological and literary symposium on Dara Shikoh's Persian Upanishads (*Sirr-i-Akbar*)	Dara Shikoh translated 52 Upanishads, authored *Majma-ul-Bahrain*, and patronized Qadiri Sufis

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. The court language of the Sultanate and Mughal empires was **Persian**; **Baburnama** (बाबरनामा) alone is written in **Chagatai (चगताई) Turki (तुर्की)**.
2. **Tabaqat-i-Nasiri** is by **Minhaj-us-Siraj**; **Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi** is by **Ziauddin Barani**.
3. **Tughlaqnama** (तुग़लक़नामा) is by **Amir Khusrau** (अमीर खुसरो) (his last historical masnavi, 1320); **Rihla** (रिहला) is **Ibn Battuta (इब्न बतूता)'s** travelogue.
4. **Fatawa-i-Jahandari** is Barani's political theory text, not a narrative history (इतिहास).
5. Both **Barani** (बरनी) and **Shams-i-Siraj Afif** wrote works titled **Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi** for different periods of Firuz's age.
6. **Taj-ul-Maasir** is by Hasan Nizami; **Kitab-ul-Hind** is by **Alberuni**.
7. **Amir Khusrau** wrote **Khamsa**, **Nuh Sipihr**, **Miftah-ul-Futuh**, **Khazain-ul-Futuh**, and **Ashiqa** (आशिक़ा); **Rag Vibodh** (राग विबोध) was written by **Somnath** (सोमनाथ) (1609).
8. **Miftah-ul-Futuh** covers Jalaluddin Khalji (खिलजी); **Khazain-ul-Futuh** covers Alauddin — keep the Khalji pair straight.
9. Vernacular & treatise matches: **Mulla Daud–Chandayan**; **Damodar (दामोदर) Kavi–Padmavati Katha (पद्मावती कथा)**; **Amir Khusrau–Ashiqa**; **Somnath–Rag Vibodh**.
10. **Padmavat** (पद्मावत) is **Malik Muhammad Jaisi's** Awadhi (अवधी) epic — not Damodar Kavi's Padmavati Katha.
11. **Baburnama** = Babur (बाबर); **Humayunnama** = Gulbadan Begum; **Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri** (तुजुक-ए-जहाँगीरी) = Jahangir (जहाँगीर)'s own memoir.
12. **Akbarnama** is Abul Fazl (अबुल फजल)'s narrative history; **Ain-i-Akbari** (आइन-ए-अकबरी) is his admin gazetteer, not a biography.
13. **Padshahnama** (पादशाहनामा) = Abdul Hamid Lahori (Shah Jahan (शाहजहाँ)); **Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh** = Badauni, who was critical of Akbar (अकबर).
14. Death chronology: **Faizi (फैजी) (1595)** → **Sheikh Mubarak (1597)** → **Abul Fazl murdered (1602)** → **Daniyal (1604)**.
15. Regional Persian facts: **Mirat-e-Sikandari** = Gujarat; **Burhan-e-Masir** = Ahmadnagar; **Riyaz-us-Salatin** (रियाज़-उस-सलातीन) = Bengal; **Riyaz-ul-Insha** (रियाज़-उल-इंशा) = Gawan's letters.
16. **Tutinama** is by **Nakhshabi**, not by Amir Khusrau.
17. **Amir Khusrau** belongs to the Sultanate age; do not place him in the Akbar–Tansen (तानसेन) court.
18. **Alamgirnama** is by Mirza Muhammad Kazim (Aurangzeb (औरंगजेब)); **Futuh-us-Salatin** is by Abdul Malik Isami.
19. **Fatwa-i-Firuz Shahi** is Firuz Shah's own regulations — not Barani's **Fatawa-i-Jahandari**.
20. **Tarikh** (तारीख) means continuous annals; **tabaqat** (तबक़ात) means generational "classes" of biographies.
21. UP literary facts: **Jaisi–Padmavat** and **Mulla Daud–Chandayan** for Awadhi / Hindavi romance.
22. **Hindavi** bridge literature is especially associated with Amir Khusrau.
23. **Badauni** stands for hostile historiography; **Abul Fazl** (अबुल फजल) stands for official panegyric under Akbar.
24. Akbar's (अकबर) translation peak rendered the Mahabharata (**Razmnama** (रज्मनामा)), Ramayana (रामायण), and related texts into Persian with Faizi's circle.
25. **Gulbadan Begum** is a rare female voice in Mughal prose through **Humayunnama**.
26. Court Persian ran from **Iltutmish** (इल्तुतमिश) through **Aurangzeb** (औरंगजेब) as the main administrative literary language.

27. Vernacular Bhakti (भक्ति) poetry of Kabir (कबीर), Tulsidas (तुलसीदास), and Surdas (सूरदास) ran parallel to Persian court literature.
28. **Afif** covers later Firuz; Barani's Tarikh stops earlier — that period split is the double-title trap.
29. **Al-Biruni's *Kitab-al-Hind* (किताब-अल-हिंद):** Composed in **Arabic** by Abu Raihan al-Biruni (who accompanied Mahmud of Ghazni), covering Indian astronomy, mathematics, philosophy, religion, and social customs in **80 systematic chapters**.
30. **Utbi's *Tarikh-i-Yamini* (तारीख-ए-यामिनी):** Written in ornate **Arabic** by Abu Nasr Utbi, court secretary to Mahmud of Ghazni, chronicling the expeditions of Sabuktigin and Mahmud up to 1020 CE.
31. **Hasan Nizami's *Taj-ul-Maasir* (ताज-उल-मासिर):** The first official history written in India in mixed Persian prose and verse, detailing the military campaigns of **Qutbuddin Aibak** and **Iltutmish** from 1191 to 1217 CE.
32. **Minhaj-us-Siraj's *Tabaqat-i-Nasiri* (तबकात-ए-नासिरी):** General history from Adam to 1260 CE written in Persian and dedicated to Delhi Sultan **Nasiruddin Mahmud**, providing the primary eyewitness account of Muhammad Ghori's campaigns and the early Mamluk Sultans.
33. **Amir Khusrau's *Nuh Sipihr* (नूह सिपिहर):** Meaning 'Nine Skies', composed in 1318 CE during the reign of Mubarak Shah Khalji, passionately praising India's flora, fauna, intellectual prowess (invention of zero, chess), and declaring India superior to all other nations.
34. **Amir Khusrau's *Ashiqa* (आशिका):** A historical masnavi commissioned by Prince Khizr Khan narrating the tragic love story between Khizr Khan (son of Alauddin Khalji) and Deval Rani (princess of Gujarat).
35. **Ziauddin Barani's *Fatwa-i-Jahandari* (फतवा-ए-जहाँदारी):** An aristocratic manual of Islamic political theory and statecraft advising Muslim rulers on governance, suppression of rebellion, maintaining royal prestige, and strict caste-based exclusion in civil service.
36. **Shams-i-Siraj Afif's *Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi*:** Distinct from Barani's work of the identical title, Afif's chronicle picks up where Barani left off, focusing entirely on the 37-year peaceful and prosperous reign of **Firoz Shah Tughlaq**.
37. **Isami's *Futuh-us-Salatin* (फुतुह-उस-सलातीन):** An epic versified chronicle in the style of Firdausi's *Shahnama*, written in 1350 CE under the patronage of **Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah** (founder of the Bahmani Kingdom), criticizing Muhammad bin Tughlaq.
38. **Yahya bin Ahmad Sirhindi's *Tarikh-i-Mubarak Shahi*:** Dedicated to Sayyid Sultan Mubarak Shah, this chronicle is the **sole surviving contemporary primary source** for the history of the **Sayyid Dynasty (1414–1451 CE)**.
39. **Babur's *Tuzuk-i-Baburi* (तुजुक-ए-बाबरी):** An unvarnished autobiography written in pure **Chagatai Turkish**, celebrated for its frank botanical observations, geographical descriptions of Hindustan, and vivid character portraits of contemporary kings.
40. **Persian Translations of *Baburnama*:** Commissioned by Akbar, the definitive Persian translation was rendered by **Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khanan** in 1589 CE; English translation was completed by Annette Beveridge.
41. **Gulbadan Begum's *Humayun-nama* (हुमायूँनामा):** Authored by Babur's daughter and Humayun's sister at Akbar's personal request, offering an invaluable domestic and psychological insight into the Mughal royal zenana.
42. **Abbas Khan Sarwani's *Tarikh-i-Sher Shahi*:** Commissioned by Akbar around 1580 CE to compile an authentic record of **Sher Shah Suri's** administrative innovations, land reforms, and road networks.
43. **Structure of *Ain-i-Akbari*:** Forms the **third volume** of Abul Fazl's *Akbarnama*, divided into **five daftars (books)**: Manzil-abadi (imperial household), Sipah-abadi (military and civil administration), Mulk-abadi (statistical land revenue tables of all subahs), Hindu philosophy/sciences, and sayings of Akbar.
44. **Badauni's *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh* (मुंतखब-उत-तवारीख):** Written in secret by Abdul Qadir Badauni because of its virulent criticism of Akbar's heterodox religious policies, Abul Fazl's rationalism, and *Din-i-Ilahi*; kept hidden until Jahangir's accession.
45. ***Razmnama* (रज़्मनामा / Book of War):** The magnificent Persian translation of the Hindu epic **Mahabharata** produced at Akbar's *Maktab Khana* (translation bureau) by Badauni, Naqib Khan, and Faizi, illustrated with 168 master miniatures.
46. **Abdul Hamid Lahori's *Padshahnama* (पादशाहनामा):** The official chronicle of Emperor **Shah Jahan**, detailing the first twenty regnal years with lavish descriptions of the Peacock Throne, architectural construction, and royal court ceremonies.
47. **Inayat Khan's *Shah Jahan-nama*:** An abridged and accessible contemporary history of Shah Jahan's complete reign compiled by Inayat Khan.
48. **Saqi Mustaid Khan's *Maasir-i-Alamgiri* (मआसिर-ए-आलमगीरी):** Written after Aurangzeb's death in 1707 with access to confidential imperial archives; hailed by Sir Jadunath Sarkar as the 'Dictionary of Mughal State Administration'.
49. **Khafi Khan's *Muntakhab-ul-Lubab (मुंतखब-उल-लुबाब):* Written in absolute secrecy by Muhammad Hashim (Khafi Khan) because Aurangzeb had formally banned the writing of history in his 21st regnal year; contains the celebrated sobriquet** Shahe Bekhabar*** for Bahadur Shah I.
50. **Malik Muhammad Jaisi's *Padmavat* (पद्मावत):** Composed in **Awadhi** around **1540 CE** during the reign of **Sher Shah Suri**; an allegorical Sufi romance revolving around the historic siege of Chittor by Alauddin Khalji and Queen Padmini.

⏱ Timeline / Chronology

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[c. 1020–1030 CE] Al-Biruni (*Kitab-al-Hind*) & Utbi (*Tarikh-i-Yamini*)
   |
[1206–1217 CE] Hasan Nizami (*Taj-ul-Maasir* – First Sultanate Official History)
   |
[1260 CE] Minhaj-us-Siraj (*Tabaqat-i-Nasiri* – Nasiruddin Mahmud)
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[1289–1325 CE] Amir Khusrau's Master Masnavis: *Qiran-us-Sadain*, *Miftah*, *Ashiqa*, *Nuh Sipihr*, *Tughlaq Nama*
   |
[1357 CE] Ziauddin Barani (*Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi* & *Fatwa-i-Jahandari*)
   |
[c. 1434 CE] Yahya bin Ahmad Sirhindi (*Tarikh-i-Mubarak Shahi* – Sayyid Dynasty)
   |
[1526–1530 CE] Babur (*Tuzuk-i-Baburi* in Chagatai Turkish)
   |
[1540 CE] Malik Muhammad Jaisi (*Padmavat* in Awadhi)
   |
[c. 1587–1598 CE] Abul Fazl (*Akbarnama* & *Ain-i-Akbari*) & Badauni (*Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh* & *Razmnama*)
   |
[1624 CE] Jahangir (*Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri* in Persian)
   |
[c. 1650 CE] Abdul Hamid Lahori (*Padshahnama* – Shah Jahan)
   |
[1657 CE] Dara Shikoh (*Sirr-i-Akbar* – 52 Upanishads in Persian)
   |
[Post-1707 CE] Saqi Mustaid Khan (*Maasir-i-Alamgiri*) & Khafi Khan (*Muntakhab-ul-Lubab*)
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Dynastic Evolution of Medieval Chronicles

ERA / EMPIRE	CHRONICLE TITLE	AUTHOR	LANGUAGE	PRIMARY HISTORICAL THEME
Early Invasions	***Kitab-al-Hind***	**Al-Biruni**	Arabic	Indian astronomy, mathematics, philosophy, religion, caste rules
Ghaznavid	***Tarikh-i-Yamini***	Utbi	Arabic	Expeditions of Sabuktigin and Mahmud of Ghazni
Early Sultanate	***Taj-ul-Maasir***	Hasan Nizami	Persian	Reign of Qutbuddin Aibak and Iltutmish; first official Sultanate history
Slave Dynasty	***Tabaqat-i-Nasiri***	Minhaj-us-Siraj	Persian	General history dedicated to Sultan Nasiruddin Mahmud; Turkish conquest
Khalji / Tughlaq	***Khazain-ul-Futuh***	**Amir Khusrau**	Persian	Victories of Alauddin Khalji; Deccan conquests of Malik Kafur
Tughlaq Dynasty	***Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi***	**Ziauddin Barani**	Persian	Detailed narrative from Balban to early years of Firoz Shah Tughlaq
Sayyid Dynasty	***Tarikh-i-Mubarak Shahi***	Yahya Sirhindi	Persian	Sole contemporary primary authority for the Sayyid rulers
Early Mughal	***Tuzuk-i-Baburi***	**Babur**	**Chagatai Turkish**	Frank autobiography; geography, fauna, flora, and politics of Hindustan
Mughal Zenana	***Humayun-nama***	**Gulbadan Begum**	Persian	Domestic harem life, struggles, and character of Humayun
Sur Interregnum	***Tarikh-i-Sher Shahi***	Abbas Khan Sarwani	Persian	Detailed chronicle of Sher Shah Suri's administrative institutions
Akbar's Reign	***Akbarnama***	**Abul Fazl**	Persian	Official biography of Akbar in 3 volumes (Vol III = *Ain-i-Akbari*)
Akbar's Reign	***Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh***	**Badauni**	Persian	Secret history highly critical of Akbar's religious policies
Jahangir's Reign	***Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri***	**Jahangir**	Persian	Royal autobiography covering painting, justice, natural history
Shah Jahan's Reign	***Padshahnama***	**Abdul Hamid Lahori**	Persian	Official history of first two decades of Shah Jahan's reign
Aurangzeb's Reign	***Maasir-i-Alamgiri***	Saqi Mustaid Khan	Persian	Post-1707 official record; "Dictionary of Mughal Administration"

📊 Quick Reference Grid

1. Master Match List: Medieval Authors and Their Masterpieces

AUTHOR / CHRONICLER	LITERARY MASTERPIECE	LANGUAGE	PATRON MONARCH / SETTING
Al-Biruni	***Kitab-al-Hind*** (*Tahqiq-i-Hind*)	Arabic	Mahmud of Ghazni
Firdausi	***Shahnama***	Persian	Mahmud of Ghazni ("Homer of the East")
Minhaj-us-Siraj	***Tabaqat-i-Nasiri***	Persian	Nasiruddin Mahmud (Slave Dynasty)
Amir Khusrau	***Tughlaq Nama***	Persian	Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq
Amir Khusrau	***Khazain-ul-Futuh*** (*Tarikh-i-Alai*)	Persian	Alauddin Khalji
Ziauddin Barani	***Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi*** & ***Fatwa-i-Jahandari***	Persian	Firoz Shah Tughlaq
Shams-i-Siraj Afif	***Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi***	Persian	Firoz Shah Tughlaq
Yahya bin Ahmad Sirhindi	***Tarikh-i-Mubarak Shahi***	Persian	Mubarak Shah (Sayyid Dynasty)
Babur	***Tuzuk-i-Baburi*** (*Baburnama*)	**Chagatai Turkish**	Self-authored autobiography
Gulbadan Begum	***Humayun-nama***	Persian	Sister of Humayun / Commissioned by Akbar
Jauhar Aftabchi	***Tazkirat-ul-Waqiat***	Persian	Ewer-bearer of Humayun
Abbas Khan Sarwani	***Tarikh-i-Sher Shahi***	Persian	Commissioned by Akbar
Abul Fazl	***Akbarnama*** & ***Ain-i-Akbari***	Persian	Emperor Akbar
Abdul Qadir Badauni	***Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh***	Persian	Contemporary of Akbar
Nizamuddin Ahmad	***Tabaqat-i-Akbari***	Persian	Mir Bakhshi under Akbar
Jahangir	***Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri***	Persian	Imperial autobiography
Abdul Hamid Lahori	***Padshahnama***	Persian	Emperor Shah Jahan
Inayat Khan	***Shah Jahan-nama***	Persian	Emperor Shah Jahan
Dara Shikoh	***Sirr-i-Akbar*** & ***Majma-ul-Bahrain***	Persian	Crown Prince (Son of Shah Jahan)
Mirza Muhammad Kazim	***Alamgirnama***	Persian	First 10 years of Aurangzeb
Saqi Mustaid Khan	***Maasir-i-Alamgiri***	Persian	Published post-1707 under Bahadur Shah I
Khafi Khan	***Muntakhab-ul-Lubab***	Persian	Secret history up to Muhammad Shah
Bhimsen Saxena	***Nuskha-i-Dilkusha***	Persian	Eyewitness account of Aurangzeb's Deccan wars
Malik Muhammad Jaisi	***Padmavat***	**Awadhi**	Sher Shah Suri (c. 1540 CE)
Krishnadeva Raya	***Amuktamalyada***	**Telugu**	Self-authored statecraft epic

2. Amir Khusrau's Major Works (Tuti-i-Hind / Kasganj, UP)

TITLE	MEANING / SUBJECT	HISTORICAL EVENT / PATRON
Qiran-us-Sadain (1289 CE)	*Conjunction of Two Auspicious Stars*	Historic meeting on Ghaghra river between Sultan Kaiqubad and his father Bughra Khan
Miftah-ul-Futuh (1291 CE)	*Key to the Victories*	Military campaigns of Sultan Jalaluddin Khalji against Malik Chhajju
Khazain-ul-Futuh (1311 CE)	*Treasures of Victory* (in ornate prose)	Alauddin Khalji's northern sieges (Ranthambore, Chittor) and Malik Kafur's southern conquests
Ashiqa (*Deval Rani Khizr Khan*)	*The Lovers* (Tragic Masnavi)	Romance and marriage between Prince Khizr Khan and Gujarati princess Deval Rani
Nuh Sipihr (1318 CE)	*The Nine Spheres / Skies*	Dedicated to Mubarak Shah Khalji; celebrated eulogy of India's culture, languages, and nature
Tughlaq Nama (1320 CE)	*Book of the Tughlaqs* (Final Work)	Overthrow of usurper Khusrau Khan by Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq; foundation of Tughlaq Dynasty

3. Sanskrit to Persian Translations at Akbar's Maktab Khana

ORIGINAL SANSKRIT TEXT	PERSIAN TITLE	PRIMARY TRANSLATORS	CHIEF CHARACTERISTICS
Mahabharata	***Razmnama*** (*Book of War*)	Badauni, Naqib Khan, Abdul Qadir, Faizi	Illustrated with 168 paintings; Preface by Abul Fazl
Ramayana	*Ramayan*	Abdul Qadir Badauni	Completed after 4 years of reluctant translation
Atharva Veda	*Atharva Veda*	Haji Ibrahim Sirhindi & Badauni	Philosophical and Vedic hymns
Rajatarangini	*Bahr-ul-Asmar* (*Sea of Oceans*)	Mullah Shah Muhammad / Badauni	Chronicle of Kashmir kings
Lilavati (Mathematics)	*Lilavati*	Faizi (Poet Laureate)	Bhaskaracharya's mathematical treatise
Panchatantra	*Anwar-i-Suhaili / Ayār-i-Dānish*	Abul Fazl / Husain Waiz al-Kashifi	Classic moral fables and political parables
Harivamsa Purana	*Harivams*	Maulana Sheri	Lineage of Lord Krishna

🧠 Memory Anchors & Mnemonics

1. **Two Autocrats, Two Autographed Biographies:** - **Babur:** Wrote ***Baburnama*** in **Chagatai Turkish** (NOT Persian!). - **Jahangir:** Wrote ***Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri*** in **Persian**. - *Trap Alert:* Akbar did NOT write his biography (he was illiterate); Abul Fazl wrote *Akbarnama*.
2. **The Two *Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi* Authors:** - **Ziauddin Barani:** Covers Balban to the first 6 years of Firoz Shah Tughlaq (bitter, pessimistic tone). - **Shams-i-Siraj Afif:** Detailed continuation covering all 37 years of Firoz Shah Tughlaq (laudatory, peaceful tone).
3. **Abul Fazl's *Akbarnama Volume Architecture: - Volume 1: History of Timurids, Babur, and Humayun. - Volume 2: History of Akbar's reign up to 1602 CE. - Volume 3:** Ain-i-Akbari*** (Administrative, statistical, and geographic gazetteer in 5 books).
4. **Khafi Khan Mnemonic Hook:** - **Khafi** = **Khufiya** (Secret). Khafi Khan wrote *Muntakhab-ul-Lubab* in secret because Aurangzeb banned history writing! - Bestowed the title ***Shahe Bekhabar*** (The Heedless King) on Bahadur Shah I.

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill

> **Mastery Rule:** Read the consolidated facts above, attempt these high-yield questions, and score ≥80% to conquer this chapter.

Q1.

Which is NOT correctly matched?

A. Tabaqat-i-Nasiri — Minhaj-us-Siraj Juzjani B. Tarikh-i-Firozshahi — Shams-i-Siruj-Alif C. Tughlaqnama — Ibn Battuta D. Humayunnama — Gulbadan Begum

▶ Details

Q3.

Arrange the following events in chronological order:

1. Murder of Abul Fazl
2. Death of Sheikh Mubarak
3. Death of Faizi
4. Death of Daniyal

Options: A. 2-1-4-3 B. 3-2-1-4 C. 2-3-1-4 D. 2-4-3-1

▶ Details

Q5.

Match List-I (Disciple) with List-II (Guru):

LIST-I (DISCIPLE)	LIST-II (GURU)
A. Kabir	1. Guru Nanak Dev
B. Amir Khusrau	2. Swami Ramananda
C. Surdas	3. Nizamuddin Auliya
D. Mardana	4. Vallabhacharya

Options: A. 3 2 4 1 B. 3 2 1 4 C. 2 3 4 1 D. 2 3 1 4

▶ Details

Q7.

Match List-I (Historical Work) with List-II (Subject / Theme):

LIST-I (HISTORICAL WORK)	LIST-II (SUBJECT / THEME)
A. Mirat-e-Sikandari	1. History of Bengal
B. Burhan-e-Masir	2. History of Bahmani's Ahmadnagar
C. Riyaz-us-Salatin	3. Mahmud Gawan's letters
D. Riyaz-ul-Insha	4. Victory / History of Gujarat

Options: A. 4-2-1-3 B. 2-4-1-3 C. 1-2-4-3 D. 4-2-3-1

▶ Details

Q9. Match List-I with List-II:

LIST-I (BOOK)	LIST-II (AUTHOR)
A. Tabaqat-i-Nasiri	1. Ziauddin Barani
B. Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi	2. Minhaj-us-Siraj
C. Kitab-ul-Hind	3. Alberuni
D. Taj-ul-Maasir	4. Hasan Nizami

Row order is not the answer code.

Code:

A. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3 B. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4 C. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4 D. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

▶ Details

Q11. Arrange the following Akbar-circle deaths in chronological order:

1. Abul Fazl murdered (1602)
2. Faizi (1595)
3. Daniyal (1604)
4. Sheikh Mubarak (1597)

A. 4–2–1–3 B. 2–1–4–3 C. 2–4–1–3 D. 2–4–3–1

▶ Details

Q13. With reference to Amir Khusrau's works, which statements is/are correct?

1. Miftah-ul-Futuh covers Jalaluddin Khalji.
2. Khazain-ul-Futuh covers Jalaluddin Khalji.
3. Tutinama is also by Amir Khusrau.

A. 1 and 2 B. Only 1 C. 2 and 3 D. 1 and 3

▶ Details

Q15. Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Baburnama and Akbarnama are the same kind of text by the same author.

Reason (R): Baburnama is Babur's Chagatai Turki memoir, while Akbarnama is Abul Fazl's Persian history of Akbar.

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) B. (A) is false, but (R) is true C. (A) is true, but (R) is false D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

▶ Show answer

Chapter 08: Medieval Music, Painting & Culture

📰 Current Affairs & High-Yield Updates

YEAR/REF	KEY FACT	EXAM RELEVANCE
2023	**Gwalior declared UNESCO Creative City of Music:** Included in the UNESCO Creative Cities Network (UCCN)	Gwalior is the birthplace of **Tansen**, seat of Raja Man Singh Tomar's Dhrupad tradition, and annual Tansen Samaroh
2023–2024	**Tansen Samaroh Centenary Celebrations:** Annual national music festival at Tansen's Tomb in Gwalior	Questions on Tansen's original name (Ramtanu Pandey), preceptor (Swami Haridas & Muhammad Ghaus), and ragas
2024	**National Museum Miniature Exhibitions:** Highlighting **Ustad Mansur's** natural history paintings and Jahangiri portraits	UPPCS tests Mughal painters: Ustad Mansur (Siberian crane, dodo), Abul Hasan, Basawan, Daswant
2023–2024	**Vrindavan Heritage Corridor:** Conservation of Nidhivan and Banke Bihari temple complex	Linked with **Swami Haridas**, founder of Haridasi sampradaya and musical teacher to Tansen and Baiju Bawra
2023	**Pioneering Restoration of *Hamzanama* Folios:** Joint conservation by ASI and Victoria & Albert Museum	*Hamzanama* (nearly 1,400 cloth paintings) was started under Humayun and completed under Akbar by Mir Sayyid Ali and Abdus Samad

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. Sultanate music fused **Amir Khusrau** (अमीर खुसरो), Chishti (चिश्ती) **sama** (समा), and Hindavi synthesis before the Mughal dhrupad peak.
2. **Dhrupad** is the oldest art form, uses **pakhawaj** (पखावज), and runs from **Man Singh (मान सिंह) Tomar** to **Tansen** (तानसेन).
3. **Khayal** (ख्याल) is dominant today, uses **tabla** (तबला), and bloomed under **Muhammad Shah** through **Sadarang / Adarang**.
4. **Qawwali** (क़व्वाली) is the Sufi (सूफ़ी) chorus linked to **Amir Khusrau** and the **Nizamuddin Auliya** circle.
5. **Tappa** (टप्पा) was refined at **Muhammad Shah Rangeela (रंगीला)'s** court, not at Akbar (अकबर)'s (अकबर) court.
6. **Tarana** (तराना) uses nonsense syllables and is traditionally linked to Khusrau.
7. Before Akbar, **Raja (राजा) Ramchandra of Bhata (Rewa)** patronised **Tansen**.
8. Under Akbar, Tansen was a **Navratna** and dhrupad master; his honorific was **Miyan Tansen**.
9. Tansen ragas include **Miyan Ki Todi**, **Miyan Ki Malhar**, and **Darbari Kanada (वैशेषिक)**.
10. **Amir Khusrau** (1253–1325) was a disciple of **Nizamuddin** and served Balban (बलबन) / Alauddin / Ghiyasuddin courts — not Akbar.
11. Music-treatise facts: **Ragamala (रागमाला)–Pundrik Vitthal**; **Rasa (रस) Kaumudi–Sri Kantha**; **Raga (राग) Vibodh–Somanath (सोमनाथ)**; **Chaturdandi Prakashika (चतुर्दंडी प्रकाशिका)–Venkatamakhin**.
12. **Raga Vibodh** belongs to **Somanath** (1609); **Ashiqa** belongs to **Amir Khusrau** — never swap them.
13. **Akbar** (अकबर) marks the dhrupad peak; **Muhammad Shah** marks the later khayal and tappa bloom.
14. **Tabla** accompanies khayal and thumri (ठुमरी); **pakhawaj** accompanies dhrupad — do not swap the drums.
15. **Thumri** (ठुमरी) is Awadh (अवध)–Banaras romantic light classical; do not confuse it with camel-song **tappa**.
16. UP music geography: **Agra gharana (घराना)** for khayal; **Lucknow (लखनऊ)–Banaras thumri**; **Kajri** (कजरी) of the Mirzapur (मिर्ज़ापुर)–Banaras belt.
17. Theory roots remain **Natyashastra** (नाट्यशास्त्र), **Brihaddeshi** (बृहद्देशी) (Matanga; clear use of "raga"), and **Sangeet Ratnakar** (संगीत रत्नाकर) (Sharngadeva (शार्ङ्गदेव)).
18. After the 12th–13th century, **Hindustani** (हिंदुस्तानी) (north) and **Carnatic** (कर्नाटक) (south) classical branches diverged.
19. **Sama** is the Chishti musical assembly; **qawwali** is the related Sufi chorus form.
20. **Aurangzeb** (औरंगजेब) reduced court music patronage, but music survived in regional courts and private mehfils.
21. Early Mughals favoured **dhrupad**; later Mughals favoured **khayal** and lighter forms.
22. Tansen and Amir Khusrau were **not** contemporaries — one is Akbar-age, the other Sultanate-age.
23. Folklore credits Khusrau with sitar, tabla, and qawwali (क़व्वाली) inventions, but key facts keep him as the Nizamuddin–Hindavi music bridge.
24. Gwalior / Behat tradition feeds Tansen's origin story before the Rewa and Akbar courts.
25. **Amir Khusrau's Instrument Inventions:** Credited in oral tradition with inventing the **Sitar** (by adapting the Persian three-stringed *Sehtar* and the Indian *Veena*) and the **Tabla** (by bifurcating the traditional two-headed *Mridangam* or *Pakhawaj*).
26. **Invention of Qawwali and Tarana:** Amir Khusrau pioneered **Qawwali** as a Sufi musical genre using Persian poetry set to fast rhythmic cycles at Nizamuddin Auliya's Khanqah, and invented **Tarana** using rhythmic syllables (*nom-tom*).
27. **Tansen's Origin and Real Name:** Born as **Ramtanu Pandey** (or Trilochan) in a Gaur Brahmin family near **Gwalior**; initially patronized by King **Ramchandra Baghela of Rewa**, who sent him to Akbar upon royal imperial request in **1562 CE**.

28. **Title and Burial of Tansen:** Akbar conferred upon him the imperial title ***Mian Tansen*** and enrolled him as one of the **Navratnas (Nine Jewels)**; Tansen was buried near his spiritual preceptor, the Sufi saint **Muhammad Ghaus**, in **Gwalior**.
29. **Swami Haridas of Vrindavan:** Master of the Dhrupad style, founder of the **Haridasi Sampradaya** (Kelimal), and guru to both **Tansen** and **Baiju Bawra**; refused to sing at the royal court, leading Akbar to visit his Vrindavan hermitage in disguise.
30. **Raja Man Singh Tomar of Gwalior:** Passionate patron of **Dhrupad** music who established the celebrated **Gwalior School of Music** and authored the seminal Hindi musical treatise ***Man Kautuhal***.
31. **Dhrupad's Four Vanis (Styles):** The classical Dhrupad tradition bifurcated into four distinct vocal lineages (*vanis*): **Gauhar Vani** (associated with Tansen), **Khandar Vani** (associated with Raja Sammokhan Singh), **Nauhar Vani**, and **Dagar Vani**.
32. **Ragas Created by Tansen:** Innovated major classical ragas including **Mian ki Todi**, **Mian ki Malhar**, **Darbari Kanada**, and **Mian ki Sarang**, transforming traditional temple melodies into regal court compositions.
33. **Golden Age of Khayal under Rangeela: Muhammad Shah 'Rangeela' (1719–1748)** provided royal patronage to court musicians Niyamat Khan (pen-name **Sadarang**) and his nephew Firoz Khan (pen-name **Adarang**), establishing **Khayal** as the preeminent Hindustani classical vocal genre.
34. **Humayun and Safavid Persian Painters:** While returning from exile in Persia, Humayun recruited two celebrated master painters of the Safavid school: **Mir Sayyid Ali** and **Khwaja Abdus Samad** (given the title *Shirin Qalam* / Sweet Pen), founding the Mughal atelier.
35. ***Dastan-i-Amir Hamza* (*Hamzanama*):** The first monumental illustrated manuscript project of the Mughal imperial atelier (begun under Humayun, completed under Akbar), comprising nearly **1,400 large paintings on cloth**, illustrating the heroic adventures of Prophet Muhammad's uncle.
36. **Akbar's Tasvir-khana (Imperial Atelier):** Supervised by Abdus Samad; celebrated master Indian painters included **Daswant** (son of a palanquin bearer / *kahar*, illustrated the *Razmnama*), **Basawan** (master of realistic portraiture and spatial depth), Kesu Das, Lal, and Mukund.
37. **European Influence in Mughal Painting:** Jesuit missions visiting Akbar's court (1580 onwards) presented Flemish illustrated bibles and Christian oil paintings, introducing **linear perspective, chiaroscuro (light and shade), and atmospheric depth** into the imperial Mughal style.
38. **Jahangir's Golden Age of Painting:** Jahangir shifted imperial preference from mass narrative book illustrations to **individual miniature portraits, natural history studies, and ornate decorative borders (*hashiyas*)**.
39. **Ustad Mansur (*Nadir-ul-Asr*):** Jahangir's chief natural history painter, awarded the title 'Wonder of the Age'; renowned for breathtaking botanical and zoological accuracy, painting the **Siberian crane**, the **Bengal florican**, the now-extinct **Mauritius Dodo**, and over 100 Kashmiri wildflowers.
40. **Abul Hasan (*Nadir-uz-Zaman):* Awarded the title 'Wonder of the Time' by Jahangir; painted the magnificent coronation portrait for the frontispiece of** Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri* *and the celebrated painting Squirrels on a Chenar Tree*.
41. **Bishandas's Diplomatic Mission to Persia:** Sent by Jahangir with the Mughal diplomatic embassy led by Khan Alam to Safavid Isfahan in 1613 CE; produced remarkably lifelike portraits of **Shah Abbas I** and the Persian royal family.
42. **Shah Jahan's Formal Miniature Aesthetic:** Painting under Shah Jahan became highly formal, stylized, and ceremonial, characterized by lavish gold embellishments, jewelled portraits, and strict court etiquette seen in the ***Padshahnama*** miniatures.
43. **Aurangzeb's Veena Mastery:** While Aurangzeb banned court vocal music, dismissed court musicians in his 10th regnal year, and ordered frescoes in royal palaces whitewashed, he was an accomplished, virtuoso player of the **Veena (वीणा)** in his personal chambers.
44. **Musical Treatises under Aurangzeb:** Paradoxically, more Persian treatises on Indian classical music were authored during the puritanical reign of **Aurangzeb** than in any other period of Mughal history (e.g., Fakirullah's *Rag Darpan* and Mirza Khan's *Tuhfat-ul-Hind*).
45. **Fakirullah's *Rag Darpan* (1666 CE):** A comprehensive Persian translation and commentary on Raja Man Singh Tomar's earlier Gwalior treatise *Man Kautuhal*, dedicated to Aurangzeb.
46. ***Tuhfat-ul-Hind* by Mirza Khan:** An encyclopedic Persian treatise composed in 1675 CE for Prince Azam Shah (son of Aurangzeb), analyzing Indian classical music, dance, prosody, dramaturgy, and erotics.
47. ***Sangeeta Ratnakara* by Sharangadeva:** Written in the 13th century at the Yadava court of Devagiri; universally recognized as the foundational bridge text separating ancient Indian music from the distinct northern Hindustani and southern Carnatic traditions.
48. ***Chaturdandi Prakasika* by Venkatamakhin:** Composed in the 17th century in Tamil Nadu, this treatise formulated the definitive **72 Melakarta (parent raga) system** that forms the mathematical backbone of classical Carnatic music.
49. ***Sangeeta Parijata* by Ahobala (1665 CE):** The earliest Indian musical treatise to mathematically establish the exact placement of musical notes (swaras) on the physical strings of the Veena based on measurement.
50. **Karnatak Trinity of Music (कर्नाटक संगीत त्रिमूर्ति):** The late 18th-century golden era of Carnatic classical music in Thanjavur was defined by the contemporaries **Tyagaraja**, **Muthuswami Dikshitar**, and **Syama Sastri**, who standardized the modern *kriti* format.

⏱️ Timeline / Chronology

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[13th c. CE] Sharangadeva authors *Sangeeta Ratnakara* at Yadava court of Devagiri
   |
[c. 1290–1325 CE] Amir Khusrau innovates Qawwali, Tarana, Sitar, and Tabla at Delhi
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[c. 1486–1516 CE] Raja Man Singh Tomar of Gwalior compiles *Man Kautuhal* and patronizes Dhrupad
   |
[1555–1556 CE] Humayun brings Safavid master painters Mir Sayyid Ali & Abdus Samad from Persia
   |
[1562 CE] Tansen joins Akbar's imperial court from Rewa; made Navratna (*Mian Tansen*)
   |
[c. 1565–1582 CE] Akbar establishes imperial *Tasvir-khana* (Hamzanama, Razmnama; Basawan & Daswant)
   |
[1605–1627 CE] Jahangir's Golden Age of Painting (Ustad Mansur, Abul Hasan, Bishandas)
   |
[1620 CE] Venkatamakhin systematizes 72 Melakarta system in Carnatic music (*Chaturdandi Prakasika*)
   |
[1665–1675 CE] Musical treatises under Aurangzeb: Fakirullah's *Rag Darpan* & Mirza Khan's *Tuhfat-ul-Hind*
   |
[1719–1748 CE] Khayal flourishes under Muhammad Shah 'Rangeela' (Sadarang & Adarang)
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Evolutionary Trajectory of Mughal Painting Styles

REIGN / PERIOD	IMPERIAL FOCUS	MASTER PAINTERS	LANDMARK ARTISTIC MILESTONES
Humayun (1530–56)	Persian / Safavid court tradition	**Mir Sayyid Ali** & **Abdus Samad**	Miniature foundation; began *Dastan-i-Amir Hamza* (*Hamzanama*) on large cloth
Akbar (1556–1605)	Fusion of Persian, Indian & European styles	**Daswant**, **Basawan**, Kesu Das, Lal, Mukund	Imperial *Tasvir-khana*; *Razmnama*, *Akbarnama*; European perspective & chiaroscuro
Jahangir (1605–27)	**Golden Age:** Portraiture & Natural History	**Ustad Mansur**, **Abul Hasan**, Bishandas, Manohar	Realistic flora/fauna; margins (*hashiyas*); sovereign psychological portraiture
Shah Jahan (1628–58)	Imperial formalism, pomp & jewelry	Muhammad Nadir, Bichitr, Chitarman	Symmetrical court scenes; *Padshahnama*; heavy gold illumination; stiff figures
Aurangzeb (1658–1707)	Decline of court patronage; provincial migration	Scattered artists	Court artists dispersed to regional courts (Kangra, Kishangarh, Bundi, Awadh)

📊 Quick Reference Grid

1. Master Table: Eminent Mughal Painters and Their Specialties

PAINTER NAME	PATRON EMPEROR	ROYAL TITLE / EPITHET	CELEBRATED PAINTINGS & ARTISTIC SPECIALTY
Khwaja Abdus Samad	Humayun & Akbar	***Shirin Qalam*** (*Sweet Pen*)	Persian master; directed imperial *Tasvir-khana*; mint master at Fatehpur Sikri
Mir Sayyid Ali	Humayun & Akbar	***Nadir-ul-Mulk***	Persian master of detail; initiated illustrated *Hamzanama* folios
Daswant	Akbar	—	Son of a *kahar* (palanquin bearer); illustrated the *Razmnama*; committed suicide
Basawan	Akbar	—	Master of realistic portraiture, physical anatomy, and spatial background depth
Ustad Mansur	Jahangir	***Nadir-ul-Asr*** (*Wonder of the Age*)	Specialized in animals, birds, and flowers: *Siberian Crane*, *Bengal Florican*, *Dodo*
Abul Hasan	Jahangir	***Nadir-uz-Zaman*** (*Wonder of the Time*)	Specialized in royal court portraits; frontispiece of *Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri*; *Chenar Tree*
Bishandas	Jahangir	—	Unequalled portraitist; sent on diplomatic mission to Persia to paint **Shah Abbas I**
Govardhan	Akbar, Jahangir, Shah Jahan	—	Master of painting holy men, dervishes, ascetics, and Indian rural life
Bichitr	Jahangir & Shah Jahan	—	Celebrated allegorical portraits: *Jahangir Preferring a Sufi Shaikh to Kings*

2. Major Medieval Music Treatises (High-Yield UPPCS Match List)

TREATISE TITLE	AUTHOR / SCHOLAR	CENTURY & DYNASTY	CORE MUSICAL THEME & SIGNIFICANCE
Sangeeta Ratnakara	**Sharangadeva**	13th c. (Yadava of Devagiri)	Foundational bridge text classifying swaras, ragas, talas, and Indian musical instruments
Man Kautuhal	**Raja Man Singh Tomar**	15th–16th c. (Tomar of Gwalior)	Standardized Dhrupad vocal music in Hindi; established Gwalior as music hub
Rag Darpan	**Fakirullah**	1666 CE (Reign of Aurangzeb)	Persian translation and expansion of *Man Kautuhal*, dedicated to Aurangzeb
Tuhfat-ul-Hind	**Mirza Khan**	1675 CE (Reign of Aurangzeb)	Encyclopedic Persian work for Prince Azam Shah analyzing Indian ragas and erotics
Swaramelakalanidhi	**Ramamatya**	1550 CE (Vijayanagara Empire)	Earliest southern treatise classifying ragas under a systematic *mela* framework
Chaturdandi Prakasika	**Venkatamakhin**	17th c. (Thanjavur, Tamil Nadu)	Created the **72 Melakarta system** that governs all modern classical Carnatic music
Sangeeta Parijata	**Ahobala**	1665 CE (Northern India)	First text to calculate exact mathematical placements of swaras on the Veena
Kitab-i-Navras	**Ibrahim Adil Shah II**	c. 1599 CE (Adil Shahi of Bijapur)	Collection of 59 musical songs in Dakhini Urdu dedicated to Saraswati, Shiva, and music

3. Comparison of Hindustani Classical Vocal Forms

FEATURE / TRAIT	DHRUPAD (ध्रुपद)	KHAYAL (ख्याल)	THUMRI & GHAZAL (ठुमरी व ग़ज़ल)
Origin & Nature	Ancient, devotional, spiritual, austere	Developed from Dhrupad; romantic, imaginative	Semi-classical; lyrical, emotional, romantic
Language & Theme	Brajbhasha / Sanskrit; praises of deities & kings	Brajbhasha / Urdu / Hindi; divine & human love	Brajbhasha / Awadhi / Urdu; Radha-Krishna love
Accompaniment	**Pakhawaj (Mridang)** & Tanpura	**Tabla** & Harmonium / Sarangi	**Tabla**, Sarangi, and Harmonium
Key Champions	Swami Haridas, Tansen, Baiju Bawra	Sadarang & Adarang (Muhammad Shah Rangeela)	Nawab Wajid Ali Shah of Awadh (*Akhtarpiya*)
Structural Feel	Elaborate non-verbal *Alap*; rigid Tala (Chautal)	Short *Alap*; fast *Taans* and improvisations	Expressive gestures (*Bhav*), flexible tempo

🧠 Memory Anchors & Mnemonics

1. **Jahangir's Two Star Painters & Titles:** - **Mansur** = **Nadir-ul-Asr** (**M–A**: Mansur paints **A**nimals & birds; title ends in **Asr**). - **Abul Hasan** = **Nadir-uz-Zaman** (**H–Z**: Hasan paints **H**umans & portraits; title ends in **Zaman**).
2. **Tansen's Four Real-Life Fact-Locks:** - **Real Name:** Ramtanu Pandey (born near Gwalior). - **First Patron:** Raja Ramchandra Baghela of Rewa. - **Imperial Patron:** Akbar (awarded title *Mian Tansen* as Navratna). - **Spiritual Guru:** Swami Haridas (Vrindavan) & Sufi Muhammad Ghaus (Gwalior).
3. **Mughal Painting Triad of Firsts:** - **First Large Project on Cloth:** *Hamzanama* (nearly 1,400 paintings). - **First Master Hindu Painters:** Daswant (*Kahar* son) & Basawan (Akbar's court). - **First Natural History Master:** Ustad Mansur (Jahangir's court).
4. **The Aurangzeb Music Irony:** - Banned royal vocal music at court in 1668 CE. - Dispersed court painters and dancers. - **YET:** Expert **Veena player** himself, and the **highest number of Persian music treatises** were penned during his reign!

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill

> **Mastery Rule:** Read the consolidated facts above, attempt these high-yield questions, and score ≥80% to conquer this chapter.

Q1. With reference to medieval music forms, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Dhrupad is the oldest art form and uses tabla as its main drum.
2. Dhrupad's main drum is tabla.
3. Khayal is dominant today and uses tabla.

A. 1 and 2 B. 2 and 3 C. Only 3 D. 1 and 3

▶ Details

Q3. Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Tansen and Amir Khusrau were contemporaries at Akbar's court.

Reason (R): Amir Khusrau was a Sultanate-age disciple of Nizamuddin, while Tansen was Akbar's dhrupad Navratna.

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) B. (A) is false, but (R) is true C. (A) is true, but (R) is false D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

▶ Details

Q5. Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Tappa — refined at Muhammad Shah Rangeela's court
2. Tappa — refined at Akbar's court as his signature form
3. Thumri — Awadh–Banaras romantic light classical

A. 1 only B. 2 only C. 2 and 3 only D. 1 and 3 only

▶ Details

Q7. Consider the following Tansen raga tags:

1. Miyan Ki Todi
2. Miyan Ki Malhar
3. Darbari Kanada

Which of the above is/are associated with Tansen?

A. Only 1 and 2 B. Only 1, 2 and 3 C. 2 and 3 D. Only 1

▶ Details

Q9. Match List-I with List-II:

LIST-I (FORM)	LIST-II (TAG)
A. Khayal	1. Nonsense syllables; Khusrau tradition
B. Tarana	2. Muhammad Shah / Sadarang–Adarang bloom
C. Thumri	3. Awadh–Banaras romantic light classical
D. Sama	4. Chishti musical assembly

Row order is not the answer code.

Code:

A. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3 B. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4 C. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4 D. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

▶ Details

Q11. Which one of the following is NOT correctly matched?

A. Agra gharana — khayal B. Lucknow–Banaras — thumri C. Mirzapur–Banaras belt — Kajri D. Agra gharana — Carnatic kriti school of Tyagaraja alone

▶ Details

Q13. Consider the following statements about later Mughal music:

1. Aurangzeb marks khayal and tappa bloom at the imperial court.
2. Sadarang / Adarang are linked with Muhammad Shah's khayal flowering.
3. Aurangzeb increased imperial court music patronage above Akbar's level.

A. Only 2 B. 1 and 2 C. 2 and 3 D. 1 and 3

▶ Details

Q15. Arrange the following patron–musician links in historical order:

1. Akbar–Tansen (Navratna dhrupad)
2. Nizamuddin circle–Amir Khusrau
3. Muhammad Shah–khayal/tappa (Sadarang–Adarang)

A. 1–2–3 B. 2–1–3 C. 2–3–1 D. 3–2–1

▶ Show answer

Chapter 09: Mughal Empire (1526–1707)

Current Affairs & High-Yield Updates

YEAR/REF	KEY FACT	EXAM RELEVANCE
2023–2024	**Red Fort & Agra Fort Heritage Upgradation (ASI):** New museum corridors and light-and-sound shows	UPPCS tests Shah Jahan's construction of Shahjahanabad, Diwan-i-Am, Diwan-i-Khas, Moti Masjid (Agra by Shah Jahan vs Delhi by Aurangzeb)
2024	**Fatehpur Sikri World Heritage Conservation:** 450 years of Ibadat Khana foundation (1575–2025)	Ibadat Khana theological debates, Mahzar (1579), Sulh-i-Kul, and Buland Darwaza built after Gujarat conquest
2023	**Taj Mahal Air Pollution & Marble Conservation (Supreme Court TTZ Updates):** Taj Trapezium Zone monitoring	Taj Mahal architect **Ustad Ahmad Lahori**; dome builder Ismail Khan; completed c. 1648 CE
2023–2024	**Allahabad Fort (Prayagraj) Tourism Access:** Akshayavat and Saraswati Koop corridor development	Built by **Akbar in 1583 CE** on the confluence of Ganga and Yamuna; largest fort built by Akbar
2024	**Dara Shikoh Tomb Search & Publications:** Academic symposiums on Dara Shikoh's *Sirr-i-Akbar* and *Majma-ul-Bahrain*	Battle of Dharmat, Samugarh, and Deorai (War of Succession 1658–59); philosophical syncretism

Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Babur** (बाबर) founded the Mughal empire after defeating **Ibrahim (इब्राहिम) Lodi** at the **First Battle of Panipat (पानीपत)** on **21 April 1526** (GC; also cited as 20 April), using **Tulughma** flanking and **Araba** cart-forts.
2. **Panipat I (1526)** Cause–Course–Result: divided Afghan nobles vs Babur's claim → Tulughma + Araba + guns broke Lodi's mass → Ibrahim killed and the Delhi Sultanate ended.
3. At **Khanwa (खानवा) in 1527**, Babur defeated **Rana Sanga (सांगा)**'s Rajput confederacy; **Chanderi 1528** and **Ghagra 1529** followed against Medini Rai (राई) and eastern Afghans.
4. **Khanwa (1527)** Cause–Course–Result: Sanga's post-Panipat confederacy → Babur's artillery and cart-forts → Rajput challenge to the early Mughal core crushed.
5. **Baburnama** (बाबरनामा) (Tuzk-e-Babri) was written in **Chagatai (चगताई) Turki (तुर्की)**, not Persian; the Mughal **court language** was **Persian** (फ़ारसी).
6. The Mughals were **Chagatai** Turks (तुर्क) (from **Chinggis Khan's second son**); Babur took **Padshah** at **Kabul (1504)**, not only after Panipat (पानीपत).
7. **Alam Khan** (आलम खान) was Ibrahim Lodi's uncle and a throne pretender; **Daulat Khan** (दौलत खान), **Dilawar Khan**, and **Rana Sanga** also invited Babur.
8. Tomb fact: **Babur–Kabul**, **Humayun–Delhi**, **Akbar–Sikandra**, **Jahangir–Lahore**, and **Shah Jahan–Agra** (Taj for Mumtaz).
9. Humayun lost **Chausa (चौसा) in 1539** and **Kannauj (कन्नौज)/Bilgram (बिलग्राम) in 1540** to Sher Shah (शेरशाह), returned in **1555**, and died in **1556**.
10. **Daurah (दौराह) (1532)** was Humayun versus Afghan chiefs; do not confuse it with **Dharmat (धर्मत) (April 1658)**, Aurangzeb versus Jaswant Singh.
11. Battle chronology fact: **Daurah 1532 → Chausa 1539 → Kannauj 1540 → Samugarh (समुगढ़) 1658**.
12. At the **Second Battle of Panipat on 5 November 1556**, Akbar and **Bairam Khan** (बैरम खान) defeated **Hemu** and secured the throne.
13. **Panipat II (1556)** Cause–Course–Result: Hemu seized Delhi after Humayun's death → Bairam's army struck Hemu near Panipat → Akbar's throne secured and Sur-Afghan bid collapsed.
14. **Bairam Khan** received the title **Khan-i-Khana** from **Akbar** (अकबर) — only that statement is true; the claim that the title came when he was appointed Vazir (वक़ील) is false.
15. Akbar's **mansabdari** (मनसबदारी व्यवस्था) used dual ranks **zat** (जात - personal rank/pay) and **sawar** (सवार - cavalry quota); salary came from rotated **jagir** (जागीर) or cash; the system was **not hereditary** (गैर-वंशानुगत).
16. Centre offices: **Wakil/Vazir**, **Diwan-i-Wizarat** (finance), **Mir Bakhshi** (army/mansabs), **Sadr-us-Sudur**, **Mir Saman**, **Diwan-i-Insha**; provinces ran **Suba → Sarkar → Pargana → village** with dual **Subahdar** and **Diwan**.
17. **Todar Mal**'s **zabt** (ज़ब्ती - measurement-based assessment) measured land for a cash demand; **dahsala (1580–81)** (दहसाला बंदोबस्त) used a **10-year average** of yield and price.
18. Akbar continued Sher Shah's coinage: silver (रूपक) **rupiya** (रुपिया), copper **dam** (दाम - about **1/40** of a rupiya), and gold **mohur** (मोहर).
19. Akbar's expansion order: **Malwa (1561–62) → Chittor (1567–68) → Gujarat (1572–73) → Bengal after Tukaroi (1575–76) → Kashmir (1586)** plus Kabul–Sind–Deccan beginnings.
20. **Buland Darwaza** (बुलंद दरवाज़ा) at Fatehpur Sikri (फतेहपुर सीकरी) commemorates the **Gujarat victory of 1572**, not Jahangir's birth.

21. Akbar made **Fatehpur Sikri** (फतेहपुर सीकरी) capital about **1571–85** and built **Allahabad (इलाहाबाद)/Ilahabad fort in 1583**; **Ibadat Khana** debates began about **1575**.
22. Akbar's **Rajput policy** began with the **1562** Amber marriage (**Harkha / Jodha Bai**); loyal rajas took mansabs; **Man Singh** (~**7000** zat) fought at **Haldighati 1576**.
23. **Sulh-i-Kul** (सुलह-ए-कुल - universal peace / concord) was Akbar's universal peace policy; **Din-i-Ilahi (1582)** (दीन-ए-इलाही) remained only a small court circle (**Birbal** joined).
24. Akbar abolished **jizya (जज़िया) in 1564** (जज़िया कर); Aurangzeb **reimposed** it in **1679**.
25. Court death order: **Sheikh Mubarak 1593 → Faizi 1595 → Abul Fazl murdered 1602 → Daniyal 1605**.
26. **Abul Fazl** wrote *Akbarnama* and *Ain-i-Akbari* (आइन-ए-अकबरी); **Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khana** translated Baburnama into Persian; **Tansen** and **Birbal** were Navratnas.
27. Painting spine: Humayun's Safavid contact → Akbar's **Hamzanama / Akbarnama** kitabkhana → Jahangir's naturalism (**Ustad Mansur**) → Shah Jahan albums → Aurangzeb cut patronage and artists moved to Rajput–Deccan courts.
28. **Nur Jahan** (नूरजहाँ) (Mehr-un-Nisa) married Jahangir in **1611**, appeared on coins and farmans, and patronised **Itimad-ud-Daula's** Agra tomb (early pietra dura); Jahangir remained emperor.
29. **William Hawkins (हॉकिन्स)** reached Jahangir in **1608** speaking Turkish; **Sir Thomas Roe (रो)** stayed at court **1615–19**.
30. Shah Jahan's **Nahr-i-Bihisht** in Shahjahanabad drew water from the restored **Firuz Rajabwah**; **Taj Mahal** and **Red Fort / Jama Masjid** mark his architecture peak.
31. **Kavindra Acharya Saraswati (सरस्वती)** of Banaras was patronised by **Shah Jahan** (शाहजहाँ).
32. Aurangzeb succession order: **Shuja beaten near Banaras → Dharmat April 1658 → Samugarh May 1658 → Deorai 1659**.
33. Aurangzeb annexed **Bijapur (बीजापुर) in 1686** and **Golkonda in 1687**; the last Qutb (कुतुब) Shah was **Abul Hasan Qutb Shah**.
34. **Jajau in 1707** came after Aurangzeb's death, when Bahadur Shah I (बहादुर शाह I) defeated Azam Shah.
35. Akbar organised about **12 subahs**; under Aurangzeb the empire reached about **21 subahs**.
36. **Hamida Banu** was Humayun's wife; **Gulbadan** wrote *Humayunnama*.
37. **Dara Shikoh** (दारा शिकोह) wrote *Majma-ul-Bahrain* and *Sirr-i-Akbar*; Aurangzeb had him killed in **1659**.
38. Later Mughals: **Bahadur Shah I** wins **Jajau 1707**; **Sayyid (सैयद) Brothers** (सैय्यद) under **Farrukhsiyar** (फ़र्रुख़); **Muhammad Shah Rangeela (रंगीला)** faces **Nadir Shah (नादिर शाह) at Karnal 1739**; last emperor **Bahadur Shah II Zafar (ज़फ़र)** in **1857**.
39. **Maham Anaga** built **Khayr-ul-Manazil** near Purana Qila in early Akbar years — not a Sher Shah monument.
40. **Panch Mahal** is the five-storey Sikri palace; do not confuse it with **Buland Darwaza** (Gujarat victory gate).
41. **Shah Jahan's Balkh–Badakhshan (1646–47)** was a prestige failure; do not treat it as equal to Aurangzeb's Deccan annexations.
42. **Khalsa** (ख़ालिसा) under Mughals means crown land; **jagir** is the assigned revenue unit of a mansabdar — keep both distinct from Sikh **Khalsa (1699)**.
43. **Babur's Military Tactics:** Deployed the Ottoman tactics of **Tulughma (तुलुगमा / flanking movement)** and **Araba (अराबा / chained gun-carts)** with master artillery gunners **Ustad Ali Quli** and **Mustafa**, revolutionizing Indian warfare at Panipat and Khanwa.
44. **The Mahzar of 1579 (महज़रनामा):** Drafted by Sheikh Mubarak and signed by leading Ulema; declared Akbar the supreme arbiter (**Imam-i-Adil / Amir-ul-Muminin**) empowered to select between differing interpretations of Islamic law if consistent with the Quran and public interest.
45. **Akbar's Dahsala / Zabt System (1580 CE):** Introduced by finance minister **Raja Todar Mal**; calculated average crop yield and prices over the preceding **10 years (1570–1580 CE)**; state revenue demand was fixed in cash at **one-third (33.3%)** of the average produce.
46. **Mansabdari Rank Architecture (Zat vs Sawar): Zat (ज़ात)** determined the personal status, hierarchical standing, and baseline salary of the noble; **Sawar (सवार)** determined the exact number of mounted cavalrymen the mansabdar was legally obligated to maintain.
47. **Jahangir's Du-aspa Sih-aspa System:** Introduced the **Du-aspa Sih-aspa (दो-अस्पा सिह-अस्पा)** rank within the Mansabdari framework, allowing a noble to maintain a double or triple cavalry contingent without arbitrarily raising his Zat status.
48. **War of Succession Chronology (1658–1659 CE):** Strict sequence of decisive battles: **Bahadurpur** (Feb 1658) → **Dharmat** (Apr 1658) → **Samugarh** (May 1658) → **Khajwa** (Jan 1659) → **Deorai** (Mar 1659).
49. **Hindu Nobles under Aurangzeb:** In contrast to popular perception, the proportion of Hindu mansabdars reached its **highest imperial peak of 31.6% to 33% under Aurangzeb** (compared to ~22.5% under Akbar), largely due to the induction of Maratha nobles following Deccan conquests.
50. **Mughal Imperial Administrative Core (Mir Bakhshi vs Mir Saman): Mir Bakhshi (मीर बख्शी)** was the military administrative chief who signed salary pay-orders (**Sarkhat**) and inspected troops; **Mir Saman (मीर सामाँ)** was in charge of the imperial royal household, stores, and manufacturing workshops (**Karkhanas**).

⏱️ Timeline / Chronology

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[1526–1530 CE] BABUR: Panipat I (1526) ⚔ Khanwa (1527) ⚔ Chanderi (1528) ⚔ Ghaghra (1529)
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[1530–1540 CE] HUMAYUN (First Reign): Chausa (1539) ⚔ Kannauj/Bilgram (1540) → Sur Exile
   │
[1540–1555 CE] Sur Interregnum (Sher Shah Suri & Islam Shah)
   │
[1555–1556 CE] HUMAYUN Restored: Sirhind (1555); Death on Sher Mandal library stairs (1556)
   │
[1556–1605 CE] AKBAR (Zenith): Panipat II (1556) ⚔ Abolition of Jizya (1564) ⚔ Fatehpur Sikri
   │               └── Ibadat Khana (1575) ⚔ Haldighati (1576) ⚔ Mahzar (1579) ⚔ Dahsala (1580)
   │
[1605–1627 CE] JAHANGIR: Zanjir-i-Adil; Guru Arjan executed (1606); Mewar Treaty (1615); Roe (1615)
   │
[1628–1658 CE] SHAH JAHAN: Taj Mahal (1631–48); Red Fort Delhi; Peacock Throne; Golden Age of Arch.
   │
[1658–1659 CE] War of Succession: Dharmat (Apr 1658) ⚔ Samugarh (May 1658) ⚔ Deorai (Mar 1659)
   │
[1658–1707 CE] AURANGZEB: Reimposition of Jizya (1679); Bijapur (1686); Golconda (1687); Death (1707)
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Chronological Ladder of the Great Mughals (1526–1707 CE)

EMPEROR	REGNAL YEARS	BIRTH & DEATH PLACES	RESTING PLACE (TOMB)	DEFINING MILESTONE & IMPERIAL LEGACY
Babur	1526–1530 CE	Andijan (Fergana) → Agra	**Kabul** (Bagh-e-Babur)	Founded empire; deployed artillery & *Tulughma*; *Baburnama* in Turkish
Humayun	1530–40 & 1555–56	Kabul → Delhi	**Delhi** (Humayun's Tomb)	Reclaimed throne with Safavid help; patronized Mir Sayyid Ali & Abdus Samad
Akbar	1556–1605 CE	Amarkot (Sindh) → Agra	**Sikandra** (near Agra)	Universal peace (*Sulh-i-Kul*), Dahsala revenue system, Mansabdari, Fatehpur Sikri
Jahangir	1605–1627 CE	Fatehpur Sikri → Lahore	**Shahdara** (Lahore)	Chain of Justice, golden age of miniature painting, patronized Roe & Hawkins
Shah Jahan	1628–1658 CE	Lahore → Agra Fort	**Taj Mahal** (Agra)	Zenith of Mughal architecture: Taj Mahal, Shahjahanabad, Peacock Throne
Aurangzeb (Alamgir)	1658–1707 CE	Dahod (Gujarat) → Ahmadnagar	**Khuldabad** (near Aurangabad)	Territorial peak (21 subahs); reimposed Jizya (1679); annexed Bijapur & Golconda

📊 Quick Reference Grid

1. Major Battles & Military Campaigns of the Mughal Empire

BATTLE / CAMPAIGN	EXACT DATE / YEAR	OPPOSING FORCES	VICTORIOUS PARTY	DECISIVE HISTORICAL CONSEQUENCE
First Battle of Panipat	**21 April 1526**	Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi	**Babur won**	Ibrahim Lodi killed; ended Delhi Sultanate; established Mughal Empire
Battle of Khanwa	**16 March 1527**	Babur vs **Rana Sanga** (Mewar Confederacy)	**Babur won**	Babur assumed title **Ghazi**; shattered united Rajput threat to Mughal rule
Battle of Chanderi	20 January 1528	Babur vs Medini Rai of Chanderi	**Babur won**	Fortress captured; Rajput defenders committed Jauhar; Malwa secured
Battle of Ghaghra	6 May 1529	Babur vs Mahmud Lodi & Nusrat Shah	**Babur won**	Fought simultaneously on land and river; crushed eastern Afghan confederacy
Battle of Chausa	26 June 1539	Sher Khan (Sur) vs Humayun	**Sher Khan won**	Sher Khan assumed title **Sher Shah**; Humayun narrowly saved from drowning
Battle of Kannauj (Bilgram)	17 May 1540	Sher Shah Suri vs Humayun	**Sher Shah won**	Humayun decisively routed and driven into 15-year exile; Second Afghan Empire
Battle of Sirhind	22 June 1555	Humayun & Bairam Khan vs Sikandar Suri	**Humayun won**	Ended Sur dynasty; restored Humayun to the throne of Delhi and Agra
Second Battle of Panipat	**5 November 1556**	Young Akbar (Bairam Khan) vs **Hemu**	**Akbar won**	Hemu (Vikramaditya) struck by arrow and executed; cemented Mughal restoration
Battle of Haldighati	**18 June 1576**	Raja Man Singh & Asaf Khan vs **Maharana Pratap**	**Mughal tactical win**	Maharana Pratap escaped to hills; heroically sustained guerilla warfare
Battle of Dharmat	15 April 1658	Aurangzeb & Murad vs Raja Jaswant Singh & Qasim Khan	**Aurangzeb won**	Royalist imperial army routed; paved way for Aurangzeb's advance to Agra
Battle of Samugarh	**29 May 1658**	Aurangzeb & Murad vs **Dara Shikoh**	**Aurangzeb won**	Decisive battle for Mughal throne; Dara routed; Shah Jahan imprisoned at Agra
Battle of Deorai	12–14 April 1659	Aurangzeb vs Dara Shikoh (near Ajmer)	**Aurangzeb won**	Final stand of Dara Shikoh; captured, humiliated, and executed in Delhi

2. Mughal Architecture & Master Builders

MONUMENT / STRUCTURE	COMMISSIONED BY	YEAR / PERIOD	LOCATION	UNIQUE ARCHITECTURAL LANDMARK & STYLE
Humayun's Tomb	Haji Begum / Bega Begum	1565–1572 CE	Delhi	Designed by Persian architect **Mirak Mirza Ghiyas**; first full Charbagh garden tomb; prototype for Taj
Agra Fort	**Akbar**	1565–1573 CE	Agra	Massive red sandstone ramparts, Jahangiri Mahal, Bengal-style brackets
Fatehpur Sikri Complex	**Akbar**	1571–1585 CE	Near Agra	Planned imperial capital: Panch Mahal, Jodha Bai's Palace, Diwan-i-Khas, Salim Chishti Tomb
Buland Darwaza	**Akbar**	**1601–1602 CE**	Fatehpur Sikri	54 m high gateway built to commemorate **Gujarat conquest**; inscribed with Jesus's humility quote
Allahabad Fort	**Akbar**	1583 CE	Prayagraj (UP)	Largest fort constructed by Akbar, built directly on the Sangam of Ganga & Yamuna
Tomb of Itimad-ud-Daulah	**Nur Jahan**	1622–1628 CE	Agra	Built for her father Mirza Ghiyas Beg; **first building in India completely faced with white marble and extensive Pietra Dura**
Taj Mahal	**Shah Jahan**	1631–1648 CE	Agra	Chief architect **Ustad Ahmad Lahori**; Makrana white marble, bulbous dome, calligraphy by Amanat Khan
Red Fort & Jama Masjid	**Shah Jahan**	1638–1648 CE	Delhi (Shahjahanabad)	Shifted capital from Agra to Delhi; Peacock Throne housed in Diwan-i-Khas ("*If there is paradise on earth...*")
Moti Masjid (Agra Fort)	**Shah Jahan**	1648–1654 CE	Agra Fort	Constructed entirely of flawless white marble inside the red sandstone fort
Moti Masjid (Delhi Red Fort)	**Aurangzeb**	1659–1660 CE	Delhi Red Fort	Personal private marble mosque constructed by Aurangzeb inside the palace complex
Bibi ka Maqbara	**Aurangzeb** (Prince Azam Shah)	1660–1678 CE	Aurangabad (MH)	Built for Dilras Banu Begum (Rabia-ud-Daurani); known as **"Dakkani Taj"** or **"Poor Man's Taj"**
Badshahi Mosque	**Aurangzeb**	1671–1673 CE	Lahore	Grand congregational red sandstone mosque with three white marble domes

3. Mughal Central Administration & Ministry Portfolio

OFFICER / MINISTER TITLE	CORE ADMINISTRATIVE PORTFOLIO & KEY DUTIES
Wazir / Diwan-i-Ala	Prime Minister and Supreme Finance Minister; supervised revenue collection, imperial budgets, and state treasuries
Mir Bakhshi	Head of Military and Intelligence Department; maintained Mansabdari records, reviewed troops, signed salary certificates (**Sarkhat**)
Mir Saman / Khan-i-Saman	Chief of Imperial Household and State Workshops (**Karkhanas**); supervised royal personal expenses, stores, and palace staff
Sadr-us-Sudur	Head of Religious Endowments and Charity; granted tax-free revenue lands (**Madad-i-Maash / Sayurghal**) to scholars and saints
Qazi-ul-Quzat	Supreme Judicial Officer of the Empire (frequently combined with the office of Sadr-us-Sudur); head of Islamic law courts
Muhtasib	Public Censor of Morals (appointed with great vigor by Aurangzeb); verified weights and measures; enforced public decency
Mir Atish / Darogha-i-Topkhana	Head of the Imperial Artillery Corps
Darogha-i-Dak Chauki	Postmaster-General and Head of State Intelligence, News-Couriers, and Espionage networks

4. Provincial & Local Administration (Subah → Sarkar → Pargana → Gram)

ADMINISTRATIVE TIER	PRIMARY OFFICIAL	SPECIALIZED FUNCTION
Subah (Province)	**Subahdar / Sipahsalar**	Executive, military, and law-and-order head of the province
Subah (Province)	**Diwan (Provincial)**	Independent finance officer reporting directly to the imperial Diwan-i-Ala
Sarkar (District)	**Faujdar**	Executive and military commander; maintained law and suppressed rebellions
Sarkar (District)	**Amalguzar**	Land revenue assessment and collection officer of the Sarkar
Sarkar (District)	**Kotwal**	Chief of urban city police, night-watch, and market regulations
Pargana (Sub-District)	**Shiqdar**	Executive head and police officer of the Pargana
Pargana (Sub-District)	**Amil / Munsif**	Pargana revenue assessment and collection officer
Pargana (Sub-District)	**Fotadar**	Pargana treasurer
Pargana (Sub-District)	**Karkuns**	Persian and local language revenue clerks and book-keepers
Gram (Village)	**Muqaddam / Chaudhari**	Village headman responsible for law, order, and delivering village taxes
Gram (Village)	**Patwari**	Village land record-keeper and crop register accountant

5. Land Revenue Classifications under the Dahsala System

LAND CATEGORY	CULTIVATION FREQUENCY	REVENUE ASSESSMENT STATUS
Polaj (पोलज)	Cultivated continuously every year without interruption	Assessed annually at standard full rate (most fertile)
Parauti (परौती)	Left fallow for 1 or 2 years to recover natural soil fertility	Assessed at standard rate once brought under cultivation
Chachar (चाचर)	Left uncultivated/fallow for 3 or 4 consecutive years	Progressive concessional rates for first 3 years of recultivation
Banjar (बंजर)	Uncultivated for 5 or more years (least fertile/waste land)	Highly nominal concessional rates in cash/kind to encourage reclamation

🧠 Memory Anchors & Mnemonics

1. **The Six Great Mughals Succession Order: B–H–A–J–S–A** - **B**abur (1526–1530) - **H**umayun (1530–1540 & 1555–1556) - **A**kbar (1556–1605) - **J**ahangir (1605–1627) - **S**hah Jahan (1628–1658) - **A**urangzeb (1658–1707) - *Mnemonic Hook:* "BHAJSA" (like BJP/BHAJPA)
2. **Babur's Four Battles in Yearly Sequence (1526–1529):** - 1526: **Panipat I** (Babur drank *Paani* / पानी पिया) - 1527: **Khanwa** (Ate food / *Khana* खाया) - 1528: **Chanderi** (Went to Chanderi / *Chanderi* गया) - 1529: **Ghaghra** (Returned home / *Ghar* गया) - 1530: **Died in Agra** (Died / मर गया)
3. **War of Succession Battles Order (1658–1659): B–D–S–K–D** - **B**ahadurpur (Feb 1658 - Shuja defeated by Sulaiman Shikoh) - **D**harmat (Apr 1658 - Jaswant Singh defeated by Aurangzeb) - **S**amugarh (May 1658 - Dara Shikoh decisively defeated) - **K**hajwa (Jan 1659 - Shuja finally crushed) - **D**eorai (Mar 1659 - Dara Shikoh captured near Ajmer) - *Mnemonic Hook:* "Big Dogs Shall Kill Deer"
4. **Akbar's Religious Reform Milestones in Exact Order:** - 1562: Abolition of enslavement of war prisoners - 1563: Abolition of Pilgrimage Tax on Hindus - 1564: Abolition of **Jizya** - 1575: Establishment of **Ibadat Khana** at Fatehpur Sikri - 1579: Promulgation of the **Mahzar** (Infallibility Decree) - 1582: Promulgation of **Din-i-Ilahi** (Tauhid-i-Ilahi)
5. **Mughal Imperial Tombs Outside Present-Day India:** - **Babur:** Buried in **Kabul** (Afghanistan). - **Jahangir:** Buried in **Shahdara, Lahore** (Pakistan). - **Bahadur Shah II Zafar:** Buried in **Yangon / Rangoon** (Myanmar). - *All other Great Mughals (Humayun, Akbar, Shah Jahan, Aurangzeb) are buried in India.*

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill

> **Mastery Rule:** Read the consolidated facts above, attempt these high-yield questions, and score ≥80% to conquer this chapter.

Q1. With reference to the First Battle of Panipat (1526), which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Babur used the Tulghuma (flanking) tactical formation.
2. Babur's artillery was commanded by Ustad Ali and Mustafa.
3. Ibrahim Lodi was killed on the battlefield.

A. 1 and 2 B. 2 and 3 C. Only 1 D. All 1, 2 and 3

▶ Details

Q3. Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Zat — personal rank and basic salary
2. Sawar — number of cavalrymen required to be maintained
3. Zat — cavalry obligation alone

A. 1 only B. 3 only C. 2 and 3 only D. 1 and 2 only

▶ Details

Q5. Arrange the following battles in chronological order:

1. Kannauj (Bilgram)
2. Daurah
3. Samugarh
4. Chausa

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 4-2-1-3 B. 2-4-1-3 C. 2-4-3-1 D. 4-2-3-1

▶ Details

Q7. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below:

LIST-I (BATTLE)	LIST-II (YEAR / TAG)
A. Khanwa	1. 1556 — Akbar–Bairam vs Hemu
B. Second Panipat	2. 1527 — Babur vs Rana Sanga
C. Dharmat	3. Apr 1658 — Aurangzeb vs Jaswant Singh
D. Jajau	4. 1707 — Bahadur Shah I vs Azam

Row order is not the answer code.

A. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4 B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3 C. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4 D. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

▶ Details

Q9. Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Buland Darwaza at Fatehpur Sikri commemorates Akbar's Gujarat victory of 1572.

Reason (R): It was built to mark the birth of Jahangir.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) B. (A) is false, but (R) is true C. (A) is true, but (R) is false D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

▶ Details

Q11. Consider the following statements about mansabdari:

1. It used dual ranks of zat and sawar.
2. Jagir lands were assigned to mansabdars, while khalsa was crown land.
3. Mansabs were hereditary like jagir succession in all cases.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A. Only 3 B. 1 and 3 C. Only 1 D. Only 1 and 2

▶ Details

Q13. With reference to Aurangzeb's war of succession, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. At Dharmat (April 1658) Aurangzeb defeated Jaswant Singh.
2. At Samugarh (May 1658) Aurangzeb defeated Dara Shikoh.
3. Deorai (1659) closed the succession struggle.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 1 B. Only 1 and 2 C. All 1, 2 and 3 D. 2 and 3

▶ Details

Q15. Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): At the Second Battle of Panipat (1556), Akbar and Bairam Khan defeated Hemu.

Reason (R): Victory at Second Panipat secured the young Akbar's throne after Humayun's death.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) B. (A) is false, but (R) is true C. (A) is true, but (R) is false D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

▶ Show answer

Chapter 10: Sher Shah Suri & Sur Interregnum (1540–1555)

Current Affairs & High-Yield Updates

YEAR/REF	KEY FACT	EXAM RELEVANCE
2023–2024	**Grand Trunk Road (NH-19) Heritage Upgradation:** Development of cultural tourism corridors and historical Sarais preservation by NHAI	GT Road (*Sadak-i-Azam*) was built by **Sher Shah Suri** from Sonargaon (Bengal) to Rohtas Fort (Indus), with 1,700 Sarais
2023–2024	**Kalinjar Fort (Banda, UP) Eco-Tourism Master Plan:** Infrastructure and light-and-sound show on Sher Shah's final siege	Sher Shah died on **22 May 1545** at Kalinjar Fort (Banda district, UP) due to an accidental gunpowder explosion (*Uqqa*)
2023	**Purana Qila (Delhi) ASI Excavations:** Discovery of pre-Mauryan, PGW, and Rajput-Sultanate-Mughal cultural continuity	Sher Shah constructed the **Qila-i-Kuhna Mosque** and **Sher Mandal** (octagonal red sandstone pavilion) inside Purana Qila
2024	**Sasaram Tourism Master Plan (Bihar Tourism):** Heritage conservation of Sher Shah Suri's Tomb in Sasaram	Octagonal three-tiered tomb in middle of lake, designed by **Mir Muhammad Aliwal Khan**; prototype for Indo-Islamic tombs
2023	**Reserve Bank of India Monetary Heritage Display:** Tracing the roots of the Indian Rupee (*Rupiya*)	Sher Shah Suri introduced the standard silver **Rupiya** of 178 grains and copper **Dam** of 380 grains (ratio 1:64)

Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Farid Khan** (फरीद खान) of **Sasaram** (सासाराम) became **Sher Khan** (शेर खान) after the tiger-kill tradition, then **Sher Shah Suri** as Padshah from **1540**.
2. The Sur empire lasted only about **1540–1545**, yet its admin, roads, and revenue model shaped later Mughal (मुग़ल) practice.
3. At **Chausa (चौसा) on 26 June 1539**, Sher Shah defeated Humayun (हुमायूँ), who escaped across the Ganga (गंगा) on a mashak.
4. At **Kannauj (कन्नौज)/Bilgram (बिलग्राम) on 17 May 1540**, Sher Shah won decisively and Humayun fled into exile.
5. **Daurah (दौराह) (1532)** was Humayun versus Afghan chiefs; it is **not** Sher Shah's Chausa battle.
6. Chronology fact: **Daurah 1532 → Chausa 1539 → Kannauj 1540 → Samugarh (समुगढ़) 1658**.
7. Sher Shah died in **May 1545** at the **Kalinjar** (कालिंजर) siege from a **gunpowder** blast; his tomb is the lake mausoleum at **Sasaram**.
8. Successor **Islam Shah (Jalal Khan)** ruled **1545–1553**; Humayun returned to Delhi–Agra in **1555**.
9. Each pargana (परगना) had a **Shiqdar** (शिक़दार) for law and order, a **Munsif** (मुंसिफ़) for accounts and justice, and an **Amil/Desai** (आमिल / देसाई) for collection.
10. **Jarib** (जरीब) is the **measuring rope** used to fix the bigha; it is **not** a tax. Taxes included **Jaribana** (जरीबाना - survey fee) and **Muhasilana** (मुहसिलाना - tax collection fee). **Desai** is the revenue collector.
11. Land was classed good, middle, or bad; **rai** (राय) was the crop rate per **bigha**; **zabt** (ज़ब्ती) fixed an annual cash demand.
12. The state issued a **patta** (पट्टा - title deed) to the peasant; **qabuliat** (क़बूलियत - acceptance agreement) was the peasant's written acceptance.
13. **Todar Mal** (टोडर मल) trained under Sher Shah's revenue system before carrying measurement practice into Akbar (अकबर)'s court.
14. The **Grand Trunk Road** (सड़क-ए-आज़म) ran from **Sonargaon** in Bengal to **Peshawar**, with **sarais** (सराय) about every **12 kos**.
15. Currency fact: silver (रूपक) **rupiya** (रुपिया - ~178 grains), copper **dam** (दाम - ~1/40 of a rupiya), and gold **mohur** (मोहर); Akbar continued the **dam**.
16. Key forts include **Rohtas** (रोहतास) in Bihar against Humayun's return and **Purana (पुराण) Qila** (पुराना किला) in Delhi.
17. At **Sammel/Giri-Sumel in 1544**, Sher Shah fought **Rao Maldeo Rathore of Marwar (मारवाड़)**.
18. **Jayata and Kumpa** were loyal **Marwar** Rathore captains who died fighting; they were **not** Mewar (मेवाड़) warriors.
19. Centre offices: **Diwan-i-Wazarat** (दीवान-ए-विज़ारत) for finance, **Diwan-i-Ariz** (दीवान-ए-अर्ज़) for the army (सेना), and **Diwan-i-Risalat** (दीवान-ए-रसालत) for grants.
20. Monument order places **Sher Shah's Sasaram tomb** after Atala Jaunpur (जौनपुर) and before Humayun's tomb at Delhi.
21. **Barid** (बरीद - spy) watched officers; the **qazi** (क़ाज़ी) judged by sharia and stayed outside the revenue chain.
22. Horses were branded with **dagh** (दाग़) and soldiers with **chehra** (चेहरा / हुलिया), a precursor to the later Mughal chehra–dagh system.
23. Sher Shah kept a standing force with registered men; he did **not** create hereditary mansabdari (मनसबदारी व्यवस्था) like Akbar.
24. **Farid Khan** was educated at **Jaunpur** (जौनपुर) (**Siraj-i-Hind**). He took **Hazrat-e-Ala** (हज़रत-ए-आला) in Bengal service, then **Sher Shah** (शेरशाह) after **Chausa (1539)**.
25. **Khayr-ul-Manazil** near Purana Qila was built by **Maham Anaga** in Akbar's era, not by Sher Shah. **Qila-i-Kuhna** mosque stands **inside** Purana Qila — Sher Shah's work.
26. **Farid's Early Administrative Training:** Acquired profound first-hand agrarian experience between 1497 and 1518 CE managing his father Hasan Khan's jagirs of **Sasaram, Khawaspur, and Tanda** in Bihar, where he experimented with survey-based revenue collection.

27. **Title 'Sher Khan':** Conferred upon Farid by **Bahar Khan Lohani** (Sultan Muhammad), the Afghan governor of South Bihar, after Farid killed a full-grown tiger with a single blow of his sword.
28. **Service under Babur:** Sher Khan served in the Mughal army of Babur for a brief period in 1527–1528 CE, participating in the Chanderi campaign; he astutely observed the internal weaknesses, arrogance, and corrupt habits of the Mughal ruling elite.
29. **Capture of Chunar Fort (1530 CE):** Acquired the impregnable strategic fort of **Chunar (Mirzapur, UP)** — the 'Gateway of Eastern India' — through marriage with **Lad Malika**, the wealthy widow of Taj Khan Sarangkhani.
30. **Battle of Surajgarh (1534 CE):** Sher Khan defeated the combined armies of Sultan Mahmud of Bengal and the Lohani Afghans, making himself the undisputed master of Bihar.
31. **Rescue of Humayun by Nizam at Chausa:** Following the rout of the Mughal army at the **Battle of Chausa (June 1539)**, Humayun was thrown into the flooded Ganges and saved from drowning by a humble water-carrier named **Nizam** (whom Humayun rewarded with a half-day reign in Agra).
32. **Assumption of Royal Dignity (1539 CE):** Following victory at Chausa, Sher Khan formally crowned himself king, assuming the regal style ***Farid-ud-Din Sher Shah Alam Sultan-ul-Adil***, minting coins and reading the Khutba in his own name.
33. **Expulsion of Humayun at Bilgram (1540 CE):** The **Battle of Kannauj (Bilgram, 17 May 1540)** was won by Sher Shah without artillery superiority, relying on brilliant cavalry maneuvers that drove Humayun across the Yamuna into exile in Iran.
34. **Territorial Extent of Second Afghan Empire:** By 1545 CE, Sher Shah's empire extended from the Brahmaputra in Bengal to the Indus in the west, and from the Himalayas in the north to Malwa and Gwalior in the south.
35. **Conquest of Malwa and Raisen (1542–1543 CE):** Captured the fortress of **Raisen** from Rajput chieftain **Puranmal**; when Rajput forces surrendered under oath of safe conduct, they were attacked following a fatwa by fanatic theologians — universally viewed as the sole dark stain on Sher Shah's honor.
36. **Campaign in Marwar (1544 CE):** Fought the bloody **Battle of Sammel (Giri-Sumel)** against **Maldeo of Marwar** and his brave generals **Jaita and Kumpa**; Sher Shah barely avoided defeat by forging letters that caused distrust between Maldeo and his chieftains.
37. **Famous Quote on Marwar Campaign:** Relieved by the narrow and costly victory at Sammel, Sher Shah famously exclaimed: **'*For a handful of bajra (millet), I had nearly lost the empire of Hindustan.*'**
38. **Division into 47 Sarkars:** Sher Shah reorganized his entire realm into **47 administrative divisions termed Sarkars**, completely bypassing hereditary feudal governors (*Muqtis*) to prevent regional warlordism.
39. **Officers of the Sarkar (Shiqdar-i-Shiqdaran & Munsif-i-Munsifan):** The **Shiqdar-i-Shiqdaran** maintained military forces and executive peace; the **Munsif-i-Munsifan** supervised revenue settlement and functioned as the chief civil judge.
40. **Officers of the Pargana:** Each Pargana was staffed by five standing officials: one **Shiqdar** (police officer), one **Munsif / Amil** (revenue collector), one **Fotadar** (treasurer), and two **Karkuns** (clerks recording in Persian and Hindi).
41. **Standard Measuring Unit (Gaz-i-Sikandari):** Sher Shah standardized the yard-stick as the **Gaz-i-Sikandari** comprising **39 anguls (digits)**, and instituted the **Jarib** (measuring rope joined with iron links) to precisely demarcate arable fields.
42. **Patta and Qabuliyat:** Established the legal system of **Patta (पट्टा / royal title deed)** detailing the peasant's land boundaries and tax assessment, matched by the peasant's signed **Qabuliyat (कबूलियत / deed of agreement)**.
43. **Revenue Cesses (Jaribana & Mahasilana):** In addition to the standard 1/3rd land revenue, the state levied **Jaribana (सर्वेक्षण शुल्क / survey fee at 2.5%)** and **Mahasilana (संग्रह शुल्क / collection fee at 5%)** to remunerate field surveyors and amils.
44. **Introduction of Pure Silver Rupiya:** Abolished debased billon currency and issued the pure silver **Rupiya** weighing **178 grains** (containing 173 grains of pure silver), which became the precursor of the modern Indian Rupee and remained standard under Mughals and British.
45. **The Copper Dam:** Introduced the heavy copper coin termed **Dam** weighing **380 grains**; fixed the official monetary exchange ratio at **1 Silver Rupiya = 64 Copper Dams**.
46. **Sadak-i-Azam (Grand Trunk Road):** Constructed four major national highways with planted fruit trees and wells; the primary highway (**Sadak-i-Azam**) ran 1,500 kos from **Sonargaon (Bengal) through Kolkata, Varanasi, Agra, Delhi, and Lahore to Rohtas Fort on the Indus**.
47. **Sarais and Dak Chauki Network:** Constructed **1,700 Sarais (inns)** along imperial highways at every 2 kos; each sarai had separate boarding and drinking facilities for Hindus and Muslims, a market, and two fresh post-horses for royal couriers (**Dak Chauki**).
48. **Principle of Collective Police Responsibility:** Imposed absolute law and order by holding local village headmen (**Muqaddams**) criminally liable: '*If a robbery occurred on a highway, the Muqaddams of the adjoining villages had to apprehend the culprit or pay the compensation themselves.*'
49. **Architecture of Sher Shah's Tomb (Sasaram):** Designed by master architect **Mir Muhammad Aliwal Khan**; a 150-foot majestic octagonal three-tiered red sandstone mausoleum set on a square plinth in the middle of a large artificial lake.
50. **Tragic Death at Kalinjar (22 May 1545):** Besieging Raja Kirat Singh at **Kalinjar Fort (Banda, UP)**, an explosive grenade/rocket (**Uqqa**) ricocheted off the fort wall and detonated the surrounding powder magazine, fatally burning Sher Shah, who lived just long enough to hear the fort had fallen.

⏱️ Timeline / Chronology

```
[c. 1472 / 1486 CE] Birth of Farid Khan (Sher Shah) in Narnaul / Sasaram
   |
[1497–1518 CE] Farid manages his father Hasan Khan's jagir in Sasaram (agrarian experiments)
   |
[c. 1522 CE] Conferred the title 'Sher Khan' by Bahar Khan Lohani of South Bihar
   |
[1530 CE] Acquires Chunar Fort through marriage with Lad Malika
   |
[1534 CE] Battle of Surajgarh: Sher Khan crushes the combined forces of Bengal and Lohanis
   |
[26 June 1539] Battle of Chausa: Sher Khan routs Humayun; assumes royal title 'Sher Shah'
   |
[17 May 1540] Battle of Kannauj (Bilgram): Humayun expelled; Second Afghan Empire founded
   |
[1540–1545 CE] Administrative Peak: GT Road, Silver Rupiya, 47 Sarkars, Patta & Qabuliyat
   |
[1544 CE] Battle of Sammel (Giri-Sumel) against Maldeo of Marwar (*"For a handful of bajra..."*)
   |
[22 May 1545] Fatal explosion of gunpowder missile (*Uqqa*) at the Siege of Kalinjar (Banda, UP)
   |
[1545–1553 CE] Reign of Islam Shah (Jalal Khan); codified civil and military laws
   |
[22 June 1555] Battle of Sirhind: Sikandar Suri defeated by Humayun; Sur Dynasty overthrown
```

Dynastic Succession of the Sur Empire (1540–1555 CE)

RULER	REGNAL SPAN	KEY LANDMARK & EVENTS	CAPITAL / CENTER
Sher Shah Suri	1540–1545 CE	Founder; GT Road, Silver Rupiya, land revenue reforms; died at Kalinjar (1545)	Delhi / Agra / Sasaram
Islam Shah Suri (Jalal Khan)	1545–1553 CE	Second son; codified regulations, maintained father's roads and forts; built Mankot Fort	Delhi / Gwalior
Firuz Shah Suri	1553 CE (12 days)	12-year-old son of Islam Shah; murdered by his maternal uncle Mubariz Khan	Gwalior
Muhammad Adil Shah (Mubariz Khan)	1553–1557 CE	Debauched ruler; appointed Hindu general **Hemu** as Prime Minister (*Vikramaditya*)	Chunar
Ibrahim Shah Suri	1555 CE	Rebelled against Adil Shah; seized Delhi and Agra; defeated by Sikandar Suri	Agra
Sikandar Shah Suri	1555 CE	Defeated by Humayun and Bairam Khan at **Battle of Sirhind (June 1555)**; Sur rule ended	Delhi / Punjab

📊 Quick Reference Grid

1. Sur Central, Provincial & Local Administration Hierarchy

TIER / DIVISION	IN-CHARGE OFFICIAL(S)	PRIMARY JURISDICTIONAL MANDATE
Central Ministries	**Diwan-i-Wizarat**	Finance and revenue department headed by the Wazir
Central Ministries	**Diwan-i-Arz**	Military recruitment, troop inspections, and muster-rolls
Central Ministries	**Diwan-i-Insha**	Imperial secretariat, royal edicts (*firmans*), and correspondence
Central Ministries	**Diwan-i-Risalat**	Religious affairs, charitable endowments, and foreign relations
Central Ministries	**Diwan-i-Qaza**	Judicial administration headed by the Chief Qazi
Central Ministries	**Diwan-i-Barid**	Intelligence, espionage network, and postal courier horses
Sarkar (District) (47 total)	**Shiqdar-i-Shiqdaran**	Chief military and executive officer; maintained law and order in the Sarkar
Sarkar (District)	**Munsif-i-Munsifan**	Chief judicial officer for civil suits and supervisor of revenue assessment
Pargana (Sub-District)	**Shiqdar**	Executive officer and magistrate of the Pargana
Pargana (Sub-District)	**Amil / Munsif**	Pargana land revenue assessment and tax collection officer
Pargana (Sub-District)	**Fotadar (Khazanchi)**	Pargana treasurer in charge of coin receipts
Pargana (Sub-District)	**Two Karkuns (Clerks)**	One clerk recording accounts in **Persian**, one in **Hindi (vernacular)**
Village (Gram)	**Muqaddam / Chaudhari**	Village headman responsible for maintaining peace and delivering tax quota
Village (Gram)	**Patwari**	Village land record-keeper and crop register accountant

2. Economic, Agrarian & Currency Innovations

SYSTEM / INNOVATION	STANDARD VALUE / METRIC	OPERATIONAL DETAIL & HISTORICAL IMPORTANCE
Silver Rupiya (चांदी का रुपया)	**178 grains** (173 gr pure silver)	Established standard silver currency that replaced debased billon coins; ancestor of modern Rupee
Copper Dam (तांबे का दाम)	**380 grains**	Heavy, durable copper currency for day-to-day common market transactions
Coinage Exchange Ratio	**1 Rupiya = 64 Dams**	Fixed state exchange ratio between standard silver and copper coins
Gaz-i-Sikandari	**39 anguls (digits)**	Standard unit of linear measurement for agricultural field surveys
Measuring Instrument	**Jarib (जरीब)**	Iron-linked measuring chain replacing earlier twisting hemp ropes for survey accuracy
State Revenue Demand	**1/3rd (one-third)**	Fixed share of the average crop produce, payable either in cash or in kind
Patta (पट्टा)	Official Land Deed	Royal document issued to peasants certifying exact land title and assessed dues
Qabuliyat (कबूलियत)	Acceptance Agreement	Written document signed by peasant acknowledging legal liability to pay state tax
Jaribana (जरीबाना)	**2.5% cess**	Survey fee paid by peasant to fund official land measurement parties
Mahasilana (महाशिलाना)	**5.0% cess**	Collection tax paid by peasant to maintain the state tax collection machinery

3. Highways (*Sadak-i-Azam*) & Sarais Network

HIGHWAY ROUTE	STARTING POINT → TERMINAL POINT	KEY INTERMEDIATE CITIES
Road 1: Sadak-i-Azam (GT Road)	**Sonargaon (Bengal) → Rohtas Fort (Indus)**	Kolkata, Varanasi, Prayagraj, Agra, Delhi, Lahore
Road 2: Western Route	**Agra → Burhanpur**	Dholpur, Gwalior, Malwa, Burhanpur
Road 3: Rajputana Route	**Agra → Jodhpur & Chittor**	Fatehpur Sikri, Amber, Ajmer, Jodhpur
Road 4: Punjab Route	**Lahore → Multan**	Connects Punjab plains with the lower Indus basin

4. Monuments & Architecture of the Sur Period

MONUMENT	LOCATION	PATRON / BUILDER	ARCHITECTURAL LANDMARK & SALIENT FEATURES
Sher Shah's Tomb	Sasaram (Bihar)	Mir Muhammad Aliwal Khan (architect)	Majestic 150 ft octagonal tomb in the middle of a lake; transition from Lodi to Mughal style
Qila-i-Kuhna Mosque	Purana Qila, Delhi	Sher Shah Suri (1541 CE)	Pointed horseshoe arches, white marble inlays, five-bay facade; pinnacle of Afghan style
Sher Mandal	Purana Qila, Delhi	Sher Shah Suri (c. 1541 CE)	Octagonal two-storey red sandstone pavilion; later used by Humayun as library
Rohtas Fort	Jhelum (Punjab, Pak)	Sher Shah Suri (1541–1543 CE)	Massive defensive fortification built to check the rebellious Gakhars and Mughal re-entry

🧠 Memory Anchors & Mnemonics

1. **Sher Shah's Two Battles Against Humayun:** - 1539: **Chausa** (Sher Shah became king; Nizam water-carrier saved Humayun). - 1540: **Kannauj / Bilgram** (Humayun driven into 15-year exile; Second Afghan Empire founded). - *Trap Alert:* Kannauj is Bilgram (Hardoi district, UP). Never confuse with Chausa (Buxar, Bihar).
2. **Currency Ratio Lock:** - **Silver Rupiya (178 grains)** = **64 Copper Dams (380 grains)**. - *Mnemonic Hook:* "1 Silver = 64 Copper Dams".
3. **Administration Hierarchy Hook: S–S–P–G** - **S**ubah (De facto military zones) - **S**arkar (47 divisions; Shiqdar-i-Shiqdaran + Munsif-i-Munsifan) - **P**argana (Shiqdar + Amil + Fotadar + 2 Karkuns) - **G**ram (Muqaddam + Patwari)
4. **Kalinjar Death Trap:** - Died on **22 May 1545** at **Kalinjar Fort (Banda district, UP)**. - Cause: An explosive rocket/grenade (**Uqqa**) bounced off the fort wall and detonated the gunpowder depot.

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill

> **Mastery Rule:** Read the consolidated facts above, attempt these high-yield questions, and score ≥80% to conquer this chapter.

Q1. With reference to Sher Shah's rise, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Farid Khan of Sasaram became Sher Khan after the tiger-kill tradition and later Sher Shah as Padshah from 1540.
2. The Sur imperial phase lasted roughly 1540–1545 yet shaped later Mughal admin practice.
3. Sher Shah created hereditary mansabdari exactly as Akbar later did.

A. Only 3 B. Only 1 and 3 C. Only 1 D. Only 1 and 2

▶ Details

Q3. Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Jarib — measuring rope used to fix the bigha
2. Rai — crop rate per bigha
3. Desai — measuring rope tax collected as a separate levy name

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 only B. 3 only C. 1 and 2 only D. 2 and 3 only

▶ Details

Q5. Arrange the following in chronological order:

1. Kannauj / Bilgram
2. Daurah
3. Kalinjar death of Sher Shah
4. Chausa

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 2-4-1-3 B. 4-2-1-3 C. 2-4-3-1 D. 2-1-4-3

▶ Details

Q7. With reference to Sher Shah's currency, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Rupiya was silver (~178 grains).
2. Dam was copper, about 1/40 of a rupiya.
3. Mohur was gold; Akbar continued the dam.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 1, 2 and 3 B. Only 1 and 2 C. 2 and 3 D. 1 and 3

▶ Details

Q9. Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Jarib was a major land tax under Sher Shah.

Reason (R): Land was classed good, middle, or bad and rai fixed the crop rate per bigha.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) B. (A) is false, but (R) is true C. (A) is true, but (R) is false D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

▶ Details

Q11. Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Qila-i-Kuhna Mosque — Delhi (Purana Qila)
2. Sher Mandal — Delhi (Purana Qila)
3. Rohtas Fort (Punjab, Jhelum) — Built to suppress Gakhars
4. Sher Shah Tomb — Kalinjar

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 B. 3 only C. 4 only D. 2 and 4

▶ Details

Q13. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below:

LIST-I (RULER/DYNASTY)	LIST-II (MONUMENT)
A. Ibrahim Shah Sharqi	1. Atala Mosque, Jaunpur
B. Sher Shah Suri	2. Sasaram Tomb & Purana Qila
C. Bega Begum / Akbar	3. Humayun's Tomb, Delhi
D. Prince Azam Shah	4. Bibi ka Maqbara, Aurangabad

Row order is not the answer code.

A. A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4 B. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3 C. A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4 D. A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4

▶ Details

Q15. With reference to name titles of Farid, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Farid Khan was his original birth name.
2. Bahar Khan Lohani of Bihar bestowed the title Sher Khan upon him.
3. He assumed the title Sher Shah Sultan-i-Adil after the Battle of Chausa and Kannauj.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 1 and 2 B. 1, 2 and 3 C. Only 2 and 3 D. Only 1

▶ Show answer

Chapter 11: Medieval Rajputs & Regional Resistance

Current Affairs & High-Yield Updates

YEAR/REF	KEY FACT	EXAM RELEVANCE
2023–2024	**UNESCO World Heritage Hill Forts of Rajasthan:** Upgradation of tourist infrastructure at **Chittorgarh, Kumbhalgarh, Ranthambore, Gagron, Amber, and Jaisalmer**	Six hill forts of Rajasthan inscribed as UNESCO World Heritage (2013); focus on Rana Kumbha's fortifications and Jauhar memorials
2024	**Maharana Pratap Jayanti National Commemorations:** Celebrations at Haldighati, Chavand, and Udaipur	Focus on **Battle of Haldighati (18 June 1576)**, generals (Hakim Khan Sur, Man Singh), and Chetak horse memorial
2023	**Jaipur Jantar Mantar Astronomical Restoration:** High-precision calibration of astronomical instruments by ASI	**Sawai Jai Singh II** built observatories at **Delhi, Jaipur, Ujjain, Varanasi, Mathura**; astronomical tables *Zij-i-Muhammad Shahi*
2023–2024	**Chittorgarh Vijay Stambha Preservation:** Restoration of the 9-storeyed victory tower by ASI	Built by **Rana Kumbha in 1448 CE** to commemorate victory over Mahmud Khalji of Malwa; chief architect Jaita
2024	**Durgadas Rathore Memorial Initiatives:** Commemorating the 30-year Marwar war of liberation	Resistance against Aurangzeb to install **Ajit Singh** on Jodhpur throne; called 'Ulysses of the Rathores' by Col. Tod

Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Sisodia** ruled **Mewar** (Chittor (चित्तौड़) → Udaipur (उदयपुर)); **Rathore** ruled **Marwar** (मारवाड़) (Jodhpur); **Kachhwaha** ruled **Amber/Jaipur**.
2. Title fact: **Maharana/Rana** for Mewar; **Rao** for Marwar and Bikaner.
3. At **Khanwa (खानवा) on 16 March 1527**, Babur (बाबर) defeated **Rana Sanga**'s confederacy; never pair **Pratap** with Khanwa.
4. **Maharana Pratap**, son of Udai Singh II, refused Akbar (अकबर)'s mansab (मनसब) and held out from Aravalli (अरावली) bases such as **Kumbhalgarh** and **Gogunda**.
5. At **Haldighati on 18 June 1576**, Pratap faced **Raja (राजा) Man Singh** (राजा मान सिंह) of Amber; **Akbar was not** present in the pass.
6. Haldighati was tactically indecisive; Pratap escaped, fought a guerrilla war, and died in **1597**.
7. Pratap's son **Amar Singh** made peace with **Jahangir (जहाँगीर) in 1615**, keeping Mewar honour without personal court attendance.
8. **Alauddin** sacked **Chittor in 1303**; **Akbar** (अकबर) took it in **1567–68** after Jaimal–Patta (पट्टा) resistance and jauhar (जौहर).
9. Alauddin conquest order: **Gujarat 1299 → Ranthambore (रणथंभौर) 1301 → Chittor 1303 → Warangal (वारंगल) ~1310**.
10. **Udaipur** became Mewar capital from **1559**, while **Chittor** remained the prestige fort.
11. **Rana Hamir (हमीर)** belongs to **Mewar**; **Rana Chunda** (राणा चुंडा) is also Mewar, while **Rao Chunda** (राव चुंडा) is the **Marwar** line.
12. **Rana Hammir (मेवाड़ हमीर) (c. 1326)** restored Mewar after the Khalji (खिलजी) sack; he is **not Hamir Deva (रणथम्भौर हमीर)** of Ranthambore (died 1301).
13. **Vijay Stambha** (विजय स्तम्भ) is **Kumbha** (कुम्भा)'s victory tower; **Kirti Stambha** (कीर्ति स्तम्भ) is the older Jain tower — both stand at Chittor.
14. **Jayata and Kumpa** fought for **Marwar** against Sher Shah (शेरशाह) at Sammel in **1544**.
15. **Jauhar** is women's immolation at a falling fort; **saka** (साका) is the warriors' last charge.
16. Pratap's allies included **Bhils under Punja** and Afghan commander **Hakim Khan Sur**.
17. Other states: **Bhati–Jaisalmer**, **Hada–Bundi–Kota**, and **Bikaner** as a Rathore branch.
18. **Rao Jodha** founded **Jodhpur in 1459**.
19. After Akbar, most Rajput houses took mansabs; **Man Singh** (मान सिंह) of Amber held about **7000** zat (जात) and fought at Haldighati.
20. **Malik Sarwar** founded **Jaunpur** (जौनपुर), not Malwa — a common distractor beside ruler–state match lists.
21. Khanwa sits near the **Agra–Fatehpur Sikri (फतेहपुर सीकरी)** belt; Haldighati is a narrow **Aravalli** (अरावली) pass near Gogunda.
22. Cause–course–result for Khanwa: Sanga built a post-Panipat confederacy, Babur used Araba and Tulughma, and the Rajput challenge to early Mughal (मुग़ल) power broke.
23. Cause–course–result for Haldighati: Pratap refused submission, Man Singh led the imperial wing, and Pratap withdrew to continue guerrilla resistance.
24. **Tansen** (तानसेन) served Rewa/Bhata before Akbar; do not treat **Udai Singh of Mewar** as his pre-Akbar patron fact.
25. **Agnikula Myth of Rajput Origin:** First articulated in Chand Bardai's ***Prithviraj Raso***; relates that sage Vashistha performed a great yajna on **Mount Abu** to rid the world of demons, from whose sacrificial fire-altar (*Agnikunda*) sprang the four clans: **Pratiharas, Chauhans, Paramaras, and Chaulukyas (Solankis)**.

26. **Vigraharaja IV (Visaladeva):** The Chauhan monarch who captured **Delhi (Dhillika)** from the Tomara Rajputs around 1152 CE, transforming the Chauhans into an imperial power; authored the celebrated Sanskrit drama ***Harakeli Nataka*** (inscribed on slabs at Adhai Din Ka Jhonpra, Ajmer).
27. **Prithviraj Chauhan's Courts and Titles:** Styled **Rai Pithora**; ruled from Ajmer and Delhi; built the fortified city of **Qila Rai Pithora** in Delhi; patronized poet Chand Bardai (*Prithviraj Raso*) and Kashmiri court poet Jayanaka (*Prithviraja Vijaya*).
28. **Rana Kumbha's Musical Polymathy:** Celebrated sovereign of Mewar (1433–1468 CE) who authored monumental musical treatises including ***Sangeeta Raja***, ***Sangeeta Mimamsa***, and a learned commentary on Jayadeva's *Gita Govinda* titled ***Rasika Priya***.
29. **Vijay Stambha (Chittorgarh):** A 9-storeyed, 122-foot monumental 'Tower of Victory' erected by **Rana Kumbha in 1448 CE** to commemorate his crushing victory over Sultan Mahmud Khalji of Malwa; chief architects were **Jaita** and his sons Napa, Poma, and Punja.
30. **Rana Sanga's Martial Valor:** Sovereign of Mewar who bore the scars of **80 battlefield wounds**, having lost an eye, an arm, and a leg in combat; defeated Ibrahim Lodi at the **Battle of Khatoli (1517)** and **Battle of Dholpur (1519)** before confronting Babur at Khanwa.
31. **Battle of Khanwa (16 March 1527):** Rana Sanga assembled an unprecedented Rajput confederacy (including Prithviraj of Amber, Hasan Khan Mewati, and Mahmud Lodi); betrayed by Silhadi of Raisen, leading to Babur's decisive victory via firearms and *Tulughma*.
32. **First Rajput Matrimonial Alliance with Akbar (1562 CE): Raja Bharmal (Bihari Mal) of Amber (Kachhwaha)** was the first Rajput sovereign to voluntarily submit to Akbar, marrying his eldest daughter Harkha Bai (Mariam-uz-Zamani) to Akbar at **Sambhar** in 1562 CE.
33. **Battle of Haldighati (18 June 1576):** Fought between Mughal army under **Raja Man Singh of Amber and Asaf Khan** against **Maharana Pratap of Mewar**; Pratap's vanguard was led by Afghan general **Hakim Khan Sur** and Bhil chieftain **Rana Punja**; horse Chetak perished after saving the Rana.
34. **Maharana Pratap's Recapture of Mewar:** Following Haldighati, Pratap adopted scorched-earth guerrilla warfare from the Aravalli hills, winning the **Battle of Dewair (1582)** and reclaiming nearly all of Mewar (except Chittor and Mandalgarh), establishing his new capital at **Chavand**.
35. **Mewar-Mughal Peace Treaty (1615 CE):** Concluded between **Rana Amar Singh** (son of Pratap) and Prince Khurram (Shah Jahan) under Jahangir; the Rana was exempt from personal attendance at the Mughal court, and Chittorgarh fort was returned with the condition that its ramparts never be repaired.
36. **Founding of Jodhpur by Rao Jodha (1459 CE):** Built the imposing cliff-top **Mehrangarh Fort** on the hill known as *Bhakurcheeria* (Mountain of Birds), shifting the Rathore capital from ancient Mandore.
37. **Battle of Giri-Sumel (Sammel, 1544 CE):** Rathore generals **Jaita and Kumpa** led a ferocious surprise night attack on Sher Shah Suri's 80,000-strong army with barely 12,000 warriors, nearly routing the Afghan sultan before dying heroically.
38. **Maharaja Jaswant Singh I of Marwar:** Commander of royalist forces against Aurangzeb at the **Battle of Dharmat (1658 CE)**; eminent scholar who authored the Hindi rhetorical masterpiece ***Bhasha Bhushan***.
39. **Durgadas Rathore's 30-Year Epic Struggle:** Celebrated as the 'Ulysses of the Rathores'; single-handedly organized the heroic Rathore resistance against Aurangzeb's armies from 1679 to 1707 CE, successfully safeguarding child prince **Ajit Singh** and restoring him to the throne of Jodhpur.
40. **Mirza Raja Jai Singh I (Amber):** Veteran general under Jahangir, Shah Jahan, and Aurangzeb; surrounded Shivaji at Purandar Fort and negotiated the **Treaty of Purandar (11 June 1665)**, compelling Shivaji to surrender 23 forts and visit the Mughal court at Agra.
41. **Sawai Jai Singh II (1688–1743 CE):** Astronomical polymath and statesman; founded the planned city of **Jaipur in 1727 CE** with Bengali town-planner **Vidyadhar Bhattacharya** according to principles of Shilpa Shastra.
42. **The Five Jantar Mantar Observatories:** Sawai Jai Singh II constructed massive stone astronomical observatories (**Jantar Mantar**) across North India at exactly **five cities: Delhi, Jaipur, Ujjain, Varanasi, and Mathura** (Jaipur observatory houses the world's largest stone sundial, the *Samrat Yantra*).
43. ***Zij-i-Muhammad Shahi*:** *A set of astronomical calculation tables compiled in Persian by Sawai Jai Singh II** in 1733 CE, dedicated to the Mughal Emperor Muhammad Shah to correct calendar discrepancies and planetary orbits.
44. **Ashvamedha Yajna Revival:** Sawai Jai Singh II was the **last Hindu sovereign** to perform the ancient Vedic sacrifices **Ashvamedha (horse sacrifice)** and **Vajapeya** in 1716 and 1734 CE in Jaipur.
45. **Three Famous Historical Jauhars of Chittorgarh:** First in **1303 CE** against Alauddin Khalji (led by Rani Padmini); second in **1535 CE** against Bahadur Shah of Gujarat (led by Rani Karnavati); third in **1568 CE** against Akbar (following the defense of Jaimal and Patta).
46. **Jaimal and Patta Statues:** Akbar was so profoundly impressed by the superhuman valor of Rajput commanders **Jaimal of Merta** and **Patta of Kelwa** during the 1568 siege of Chittor that he erected life-sized stone statues of both heroes mounted on elephants at the gates of **Agra Fort**.
47. **Dilwara Jain Temples (Mount Abu):** The **Vimal Vasahi Temple** was built in **1031 CE** by Vimal Shah (minister to Solanki King Bhima I), and the **Luna Vasahi Temple** was built in **1230 CE** by brothers Tejapala and Vastupala; famed for exquisite, translucent marble filigree carving.
48. **Ranthambore Siege (1301 CE):** Defended heroically by Chauhan king **Hammiradeva** (celebrated in *Hammira Mahakavya* by Nayachandra Suri and *Hammir Raso* by Jodharaj/Sharangadeva); witnessed the first Persian-recorded Jauhar described by Amir Khusrau.
49. **Bhoja Paramara's Polymath Works:** Raja Bhoja (1010–1055 CE) of Dhara authored 84 scholarly treatises including ***Samarangana Sutradhara*** (classical architecture and mechanical automata) and ***Saraswati Kanthabharana*** (rhetoric and Sanskrit grammar).

50. **Hawa Mahal (Palace of Winds):** Built in **1799 CE** in Jaipur by **Sawai Pratap Singh**, designed by architect Lal Chand Ustad; features 953 ornate honeycomb casements (*jharokhas*) enabling royal women to observe street processions without being seen.

⏱️ Timeline / Chronology

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[c. 1152 CE] Vigraharaja IV captures Delhi from Tomaras; authors *Harakeli Nataka*
   |
[1191–1192 CE] Prithviraj Chauhan III: Wins Tarain I (1191) ⚔️ Loses Tarain II (1192) to Ghori
   |
[1301–1303 CE] Alauddin Khalji's Rajput Sieges: Ranthambore (1301) ⚔️ Chittorgarh Jauhar (1303)
   |
[1448 CE] Rana Kumbha builds the 9-storeyed **Vijay Stambha** at Chittorgarh (victory over Malwa)
   |
[1459 CE] Rao Jodha founds **Jodhpur** and builds Mehrangarh Fort
   |
[1527 CE] Battle of Khanwa: Babur defeats **Rana Sanga** of Mewar
   |
[1544 CE] Battle of Giri-Sumel: Sher Shah Suri narrowly defeats Jaita & Kumpa (Marwar)
   |
[1562 CE] Raja Bharmal of Amber forms first matrimonial alliance with Akbar at Sambhar
   |
[18 June 1576] Battle of Haldighati: Mughal forces (Man Singh) clash with **Maharana Pratap**
   |
[1615 CE] Mewar-Mughal Peace Treaty signed between Rana Amar Singh and Prince Khurram
   |
[1665 CE] Treaty of Purandar: Mirza Raja Jai Singh I compels Shivaji to surrender 23 forts
   |
[1679–1707 CE] Durgadas Rathore leads the 30-Year Marwar War of Independence against Aurangzeb
   |
[1727 CE] Sawai Jai Singh II founds **Jaipur**; builds five **Jantar Mantar** observatories
```

Dynastic Grid of Major Rajput Houses

RAJPUT CLAN / DYNASTY	PRINCELY CAPITAL(S)	LEGENDARY / HISTORIC FOUNDER	MOST CELEBRATED SOVEREIGN(S)	ROYAL CITADEL / FORT
Chauhans (Chahamanas)	Shakambhari / **Ajmer** & Delhi	Vasudeva / Ajayaraja	**Prithviraj Chauhan III** (Rai Pithora), Vigraharaja IV	Taragarh (Ajmer) & Qila Rai Pithora
Guhilas / Sisodias	Nagda → **Chittorgarh** → Udaipur	Bappa Rawal / Rana Hamir	**Rana Kumbha**, **Rana Sanga**, **Maharana Pratap**	Chittorgarh & Kumbhalgarh Fort
Rathores	Mandore → **Jodhpur**	Rao Siha / Rao Jodha	Rao Maldeo, Maharaja Jaswant Singh I, Durgadas	**Mehrangarh Fort** (Jodhpur)
Kachhwahas	Dausa → **Amber** → **Jaipur**	Dulha Rai / Raja Bharmal	Raja Man Singh I, Mirza Raja Jai Singh I, **Sawai Jai Singh II**	**Amer Fort** & Jaigarh Fort
Paramaras	Ujjain → **Dhara (Dhar, MP)**	Upendra / Siyaka II	**Raja Bhoja (1010–1055 CE)**, Vakpati Munja	Dhara Fort & Mandu
Chandelas	**Khajuraho / Mahoba / Kalinjar**	Nannuka (c. 831 CE)	Yashovarman, Dhanga, Vidyadhara, Parmardi Deva	**Kalinjar Fort** (Banda, UP)
Solankis (Chaulukyas)	**Anhilwada (Patan, Gujarat)**	Mularaja I	Bhima I, Jayasimha Siddharaja, Kumarapala	Patan & Modhera Sun Temple
Bhatis	**Jaisalmer**	Deoraj / Rawal Jaisal	Rawal Jaisal (founded Jaisalmer in 1156 CE)	**Sonar Qila** (Jaisalmer Golden Fort)

📊 Quick Reference Grid

1. Major Battles & Sieges Involving Rajput Kingdoms

BATTLE / SIEGE	YEAR	OPPOSING BELLIGERENTS	VICTORIOUS SIDE	DECISIVE CONSEQUENCE / SIGNIFICANCE
First Battle of Tarain	1191 CE	Prithviraj Chauhan III vs Muhammad Ghori	**Prithviraj Chauhan won**	Ghori routed; Rajput confederacy spared fleeing Turkish cavalry
Second Battle of Tarain	1192 CE	Prithviraj Chauhan III vs Muhammad Ghori	**Muhammad Ghori won**	Decisive Turkish conquest; ended Rajput sovereignty over Delhi-Ajmer
Battle of Chandawar	1194 CE	Muhammad Ghori vs Jay Chandra (Gahadavala)	**Muhammad Ghori won**	Defeat of Kannauj; opened middle Ganga plain to Turkish rule
Siege of Ranthambore	1301 CE	Alauddin Khalji vs **Hammiradeva Chauhan**	**Alauddin Khalji won**	First Persian-recorded Rajput **Jauhar**; Amir Khusrau eyewitness
Siege of Chittor	1303 CE	Alauddin Khalji vs Rana Ratan Singh	**Alauddin Khalji won**	Rani Padmini's celebrated Jauhar; Chittor renamed **Khizrabad**
Battle of Khatoli	1517 CE	**Rana Sanga (Mewar)** vs Ibrahim Lodi	**Rana Sanga won**	Lodi forces routed; established Mewar's supremacy across Rajasthan
Battle of Khanwa	1527 CE	Babur vs **Rana Sanga** & Rajput Alliance	**Babur won**	Babur took title **Ghazi**; secured Mughal foothold in North India
Battle of Giri-Sumel	1544 CE	Sher Shah Suri vs Jaita & Kumpa (Marwar)	**Sher Shah won (narrowly)**	Sher Shah's famous quote: "*For a handful of bajra...*"
Battle of Haldighati	18 June 1576	Raja Man Singh (Mughals) vs **Maharana Pratap**	**Mughal tactical victory**	Maharana Pratap refused submission; sustained guerrilla warfare
Battle of Dewair	1582 CE	**Maharana Pratap** vs Mughal forces (Sultan Khan)	**Maharana Pratap won**	Termed 'Marathon of Mewar' by Col. Tod; liberated central Mewar
Battle of Dharmat	1658 CE	Aurangzeb & Murad vs Raja Jaswant Singh	**Aurangzeb won**	Royalist army defeated; Jaswant Singh retreated to Jodhpur

2. The Five Astronomical Observatories (Jantar Mantar) of Sawai Jai Singh II

LOCATION	PRESENT STATE	ARCHITECTURAL LANDMARK & SALIENT INSTRUMENT
1. Delhi	NCT of Delhi	Built in **1724 CE** (first constructed); features Samrat Yantra, Jai Prakash Yantra, Ram Yantra
2. Jaipur	Rajasthan	Built in **1734 CE** (largest of the five); UNESCO World Heritage Site; world's largest stone sundial
3. Ujjain	Madhya Pradesh	Built on the ancient Indian prime meridian (Tropic of Cancer alignment)
4. Varanasi	Uttar Pradesh	Built on the roof of **Man Mandir Ghat** overlooking the holy Ganga river
5. Mathura	Uttar Pradesh	Built inside the historic Kans Qila; sadly destroyed prior to the 1857 uprising

3. Iconic Rajput Architecture & Citadel Builders

MONUMENT / CITADEL	LOCATION	BUILDER / PATRON	DISTINCTIVE ARCHITECTURAL MILESTONE
Vijay Stambha (Kirti Stambha)	Chittorgarh (RJ)	**Rana Kumbha (1448 CE)**	9 storeys, 122 ft; carved with pantheon of Hindu gods; architect **Jaita**
Kumbhalgarh Fort	Rajsamand (RJ)	**Rana Kumbha (15th c.)**	Birthplace of Maharana Pratap; second-longest continuous wall in the world (36 km)
Mehrangarh Fort	Jodhpur (RJ)	**Rao Jodha (1459 CE)**	Perched on 400 ft perpendicular cliff; delicate lattice stone screens
Amer Fort & Palace	Jaipur (RJ)	Raja Man Singh I (1592 CE)	Fusion of Rajput & Mughal styles; Sheesh Mahal, Maota Lake, red sandstone & marble
Dilwara Jain Temples	Mount Abu (RJ)	Vimal Shah (1031) & Vastupala-Tejapala (1230)	World-famous translucent white marble ceiling carvings and miniature pillared halls
Hawa Mahal	Jaipur (RJ)	**Sawai Pratap Singh (1799 CE)**	Five-storey pyramid with 953 honeycomb casements; designed by Lal Chand Ustad
City Palace, Udaipur	Udaipur (RJ)	Maharana Udai Singh II (1559 CE)	Built on Lake Pichola; granite and marble palaces linked through maze of courtyards

🧠 Memory Anchors & Mnemonics

1. **Sawai Jai Singh's Five Jantar Mantar Cities: D–J–U–V–M** - **D**elhi (First, 1724) - **J**aipur (Largest, UNESCO) - **U**jjain (Prime Meridian) - **V**aranasi (Man Mandir Ghat) - **M**athura (Destroyed) - *Mnemonic Hook:* "Daily Journey Unveils Vast Mysteries"
2. **The Agnikula Four Rajput Clans: P–C–P–C** - **P**ratihara (Parihar) - **C**hauhan (Chahamana) - **P**aramara (Pawar) - **C**haulukya (Solanki) - *Origin:* Vashistha's sacrificial fire-altar on **Mount Abu**.
3. **Mewar Heroic Quad: K–S–P–A** - Rana **K**umbha (Vijay Stambha 1448, defeated Malwa) - Rana **S**anga (Khanwa 1527, 80 battlefield wounds) - Maharana **P**ratap (Haldighati 1576, Chetak, Chavand) - Rana **A**mar Singh (1615 Treaty with Jahangir)
4. **The Amber Royal Lineage for Mughals: B–B–M–J–J** - Raja **B**harmal (First alliance 1562) - Raja **B**hagwant Das (Navratna noble) - Raja **M**an Singh I (Commander at Haldighati) - Mirza Raja **J**ai Singh I (Treaty of Purandar 1665) - Sawai **J**ai Singh II (Jaipur 1727, Jantar Mantar)

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill

> **Mastery Rule:** Read the consolidated facts above, attempt these high-yield questions, and score ≥80% to conquer this chapter.

Q1.

Which of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched (Ruler–State)?

A. Rana Hamir – Mewar B. Rana Chunda – Marwar C. Malik Raja Farooqi – Khandesh D. Malik Sarwar Khwaja Jahan – Malwa

▶ Details

Q3.

Arrange Alauddin Khalji's victories in chronological order: 1. Ranthambore 2. Jaisalmer 3. Warangal 4. Chittor

Options: A. 1-2-3-4 | B. 2-1-4-3 | C. 2-1-3-4 | D. 1-2-4-3

▶ Details

Q5.

Who among the following kings had given patronage to Tansen before Akbar?

A. Raja Ramchandra Singh of Bhata B. Rajbahadur of Malwa C. Uday Singh of Mewar D. Muzaffar Shah of Gujarat

▶ Details

Q7. Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Rana Sanga — Battle of Khanwa (1527)
2. Maharana Pratap — Battle of Haldighati (1576)
3. Maharana Pratap — Battle of Khanwa (1527)

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 only B. 3 only C. 1 and 2 only D. 2 and 3 only

▶ Details

Q9. Arrange the following in chronological order:

1. Akbar's capture of Chittor
2. Alauddin's sack of Chittor
3. Battle of Khanwa
4. Battle of Haldighati

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 2-1-3-4 B. 2-3-1-4 C. 3-2-1-4 D. 2-3-4-1

▶ Details

Q11. Consider Cause–Course–Result for Haldighati:

1. Cause: Pratap refused Akbar's mansab and held Aravalli bases.
2. Course: Man Singh led the imperial wing; fighting in the pass was tactically indecisive.
3. Result: Pratap escaped, continued guerrilla resistance, and died in 1597.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A. Only 1 and 2 B. Only 2 and 3 C. Only 1 and 3 D. All 1, 2 and 3

▶ Details

Q13. Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Amar Singh made peace with Jahangir in 1615.

Reason (R): The settlement kept Mewar honour without requiring personal court attendance in the usual humiliating form.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) B. (A) is false, but (R) is true C. (A) is true, but (R) is false D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

▶ Details

Q15. With reference to Chittor chronology, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Alauddin sacked Chittor in 1303.
2. Akbar took Chittor in 1567–68 after Jaimal–Patta resistance and jauhar.
3. Udaipur became Mewar capital from 1559 while Chittor remained the prestige fort.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1, 2 and 3 B. 2 and 3 C. Only 1 D. 1 and 2

▶ Show answer

Chapter 12: Sikh Gurus, Khalsa & Sikh State

📰 Current Affairs & High-Yield Updates

YEAR/REF	KEY FACT	EXAM RELEVANCE
Dec 2023	**Veer Bal Diwas (26 December):** National annual commemoration of the martyrdom of Sahibzada Zorawar Singh (9) and Sahibzada Fateh Singh (7)	Bricked alive at Sirhind by Wazir Khan in 1704 CE; sons of 10th Guru Gobind Singh
2023–2024	**Sri Kartarpur Sahib Corridor:** Pilgrimage traffic updates across the visa-free corridor connecting Dera Baba Nanak (Punjab) with Gurdwara Darbar Sahib (Pakistan)	Where Guru Nanak Dev spent the final 18 years of his life farming and formalizing Sangat-Pangat
2024	**Martyrdom Day of Guru Tegh Bahadur (24 November):** Commemorated across India as *Shaheedi Diwas*	9th Guru executed in Delhi (1675) by Aurangzeb; Gurdwara Sis Ganj Sahib & Gurdwara Rakab Ganj Sahib
2023	**350th Birth Anniversary Celebrations of Sardar Banda Singh Bahadur:** Heritage exhibition at Red Fort	Defeated Wazir Khan at Chappar Chiri (1710), abolished feudal zamindari, executed in 1716 under Farrukhsiyar
2024	**Maharaja Ranjit Singh Statue & Ram Bagh Palace:** Upgradation of heritage sites at Amritsar and Lahore	Sukerchakia Misl founder, captured Lahore (1799) & Amritsar (1802), Treaty of Amritsar (1809), *Fauj-i-Khas*

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Guru Nanak (गुरु नानक) (1469–1539)** founded Sikhism on **Ik Onkar**, the householder path, **langar** (लंगर), and **sangat** (संगत).
2. The ethical triad is **Naam Japna**, **Kirat Karni**, and **Vand Chakna**.
3. **Mardana** (मर्दाना) was Nanak's Muslim **rabab** companion and **disciple**, not a Guru.
4. There are exactly **ten human Gurus** from Nanak to Gobind Singh (**1469–1708**); after that the Granth is eternal.
5. **Guru Angad** (earlier **Bhai Lehna (लेहना)**) standardised **Gurmukhi**; **Guru Amar Das** organised **22 Manjis** and made langar firm at **Goindwal**.
6. **Akbar** (अकबर) granted about **500 bighas** (with a pond) to **Bibi Bhani**, wife of **Guru Ram Das**; **Ramdaspur** on that land became **Amritsar** (अमृतसर).
7. **Guru Arjan** (गुरु अर्जन) compiled the **Adi Granth (आदि ग्रंथ) in 1604**, built **Harmandir (हरमंदिर) Sahib** (हरमंदिर साहिब), started the **Masand** (मसंद) tenth, founded **Tarn Taran** and **Kartarpur**, and was martyred under **Jahangir (जहाँगीर) in 1606** after aiding **Khusrau**.
8. **Guru Hargobind (हरगोबिंद)** introduced **miri (मीरी)–piri (पीरी)** and built the **Akal Takht** (अकाल तख़्त); he did **not** create the Khalsa.
9. **Guru Tegh Bahadur** (गुरु तेग बहादुर) was executed in **Delhi in 1675** under **Aurangzeb** (औरंगजेब).
10. **Guru Gobind Singh** (गुरु गोबिंद सिंह) founded the **Khalsa at Anandpur (आनंदपुर) on Vaisakhi 1699** with the **Panj Pyare** (पंज प्यारे).
11. In **1708** at **Nanded (Hazur Sahib)**, Gobind Singh made **Guru Granth Sahib** (गुरु ग्रंथ साहिब) the eternal Guru; there is **no 11th human Guru**.
12. **Adi Granth** (आदि ग्रंथ) names the 1604 book; **Guru Granth Sahib** names the same canon as living Guru after 1708.
13. **Dasam Granth** (दसम ग्रंथ) is a separate corpus linked to Gobind Singh and is **not** the eternal Guru.
14. **Japji Sahib** of Nanak opens the Granth; hymns of Kabir (कबीर), Namdev (नामदेव), Ravidas, and Sheikh Farid also appear.
15. Five Ks are **Kesh, Kangha, Kara, Kachha, and Kirpan**; initiated names are **Singh** and **Kaur**.
16. Sikh **Khalsa** (खालसा) is the 1699 initiated order; Mughal (मुग़ल) **Khalsa** means **crown land**.
17. **Harmandir Sahib** is the spiritual centre; **Akal Takht** is the temporal seat beside it.
18. At **Bhangani in 1688**, Gobind Singh defeated **Pahari (पहाड़ी) hill rajas** before founding the Khalsa.
19. **Zafarnama** is Gobind Singh's **Persian** (फ़ारसी) letter to Aurangzeb.
20. **Kabir did not found Sikhism**; his hymns later entered the Granth.
21. **Har Krishan** (हर कृष्ण), the child eighth Guru, is remembered for service during a **Delhi** epidemic.
22. Arjan's martyrdom led to Hargobind's militarisation; Tegh Bahadur's martyrdom led to Gobind Singh and later the Khalsa.
23. Saint chronology bridge often used in matches: **Namdev → Kabir → Nanak → Chaitanya (चैतन्य)**.
24. **Ranjit Singh (रणजीत सिंह)'s Adalat-i-Ala** at **Lahore** belongs to the later Sikh Empire, not the Guru period.
25. **Guru Gobind Singh** was born at **Patna** (पटना); he died at **Nanded**, where **Hazur Sahib** stands.
26. **Banda Bahadur** (बंदा बहादुर)'s earlier name was **Lachman Dev** (Lachhman Dev); Gobind Singh gave him the Sikh name.
27. **Hem Kund** (Chamoli (चमोली), Uttarakhand (उत्तराखंड)) is a famous Sikh gurudwara site linked to Gobind Singh tradition.
28. Among early Adi Granth compositions is **Jayadev**; among the last human additions is **Guru Tegh Bahadur**.

29. **Guru Nanak's Four Spiritual Journeys (Udasis):** Traveled thousands of miles across India, Tibet, Sri Lanka, Mecca, and Baghdad accompanied by his faithful Muslim rabab player **Bhai Mardana**, preaching radical monotheism (*Ik Onkar*) and universal brotherhood.
30. **Gurmukhi Script Standardization:** Standardized from earlier regional Lande and Sharada characters by **Guru Angad Dev (Bhai Lehna)** in the 16th century to ensure that Sikh sacred scriptures remained accessible to common peasants rather than monopolized by Sanskrit-literate elites.
31. **Goindwal Baoli (Stepwell):** Constructed under **Guru Amar Das** at Goindwal Sahib with **84 steps**; Sikhs believe that meditating on divine name on each step liberates the soul from the 84 lakh cycles of rebirth.
32. **Akbar's Visit to Goindwal:** Emperor Akbar personally visited Guru Amar Das at Goindwal, conformed to the mandatory custom of **'Pehle Pangat, Peeche Sangat'** (first dine in the communal kitchen, then enter the Guru's presence), and granted revenue rights over several villages to Guru's daughter Bibi Bhani.
33. **The Masand System:** Instituted by **Guru Ram Das** and regularized by Guru Arjan Dev; a network of authorized community deputies (*Masands*) who supervised regional Sikh congregations and collected the voluntary tithe (**Dasvandh / 10% of income**) for the central Guru treasury.
34. **Foundation of Harmandir Sahib (1588 CE):** Guru Arjan Dev invited revered Qadiri Sufi mystic **Hazrat Mian Mir of Lahore** to lay the foundation stone of Harmandir Sahib; uniquely designed with **four entrance doors** opening toward all four cardinal directions, signifying universal welcome to all castes and creeds.
35. **Compilation of the Adi Granth (1604 CE):** Compiled by Guru Arjan Dev at Ramsar Sarovar (Amritsar) with scribe **Bhai Gurdas**; incorporated the devotional hymns of the first five Sikh Gurus along with verses of 15 Hindu and Muslim Bhakti-Sufi saints (**Kabir, Ravidas, Baba Farid, Namdev, Dhanna, Jaidev**); installed in Harmandir Sahib with **Baba Buddha** as the first Head Granthi.
36. **Martyrdom of Guru Arjan Dev (30 May 1606):** Following the rebellion of Prince Khusrau against Emperor Jahangir, Guru Arjan Dev was arrested on charges of treason; subjected to horrific torture (seated on a burning hot iron plate and showered with boiling sand) on the banks of the Ravi at Lahore, becoming the **first great martyr in Sikh history**.
37. **Akal Takht (The Throne of the Timeless One):** Established by **Guru Hargobind in 1606 CE** directly opposite Harmandir Sahib; a 12-foot raised concrete platform where temporal justice, martial affairs, and political directives (*Hukamnamas*) of the Sikh nation were deliberated.
38. **The Two Swords of Miri and Piri:** Symbolized the dual responsibility of the Sikh faith: **Miri** (representing temporal, political, and defensive sovereignty) and **Piri** (representing spiritual leadership and devotional grace).
39. **Guru Har Krishan at Bangla Sahib:** Summoned to Delhi by Aurangzeb; stayed at the haveli of Raja Jai Singh of Amber (now **Gurdwara Bangla Sahib**); tended fearlessly to the destitute during severe smallpox and cholera epidemics, succumbing to the disease on 30 March 1664 with his dying words: **'*Baba Bakale*'** (pointing to his grand-uncle Tegh Bahadur at Bakala).
40. **Martyrdom of Guru Tegh Bahadur (24 November 1675):** Beheaded at Chandni Chowk, Delhi, by order of Aurangzeb after refusing forced conversion to Islam and championing the religious freedom of Kashmiri Pandits led by Pandit Kripa Ram; site marked by **Gurdwara Sis Ganj Sahib**.
41. **Bhai Jaita's Heroic Feat (Ranghreta Guru ka Beta):** Following Guru Tegh Bahadur's execution, a low-caste devotee named **Bhai Jaita (Bhai Jiwan Singh)** daringly snatched the Guru's severed head from under the Mughal guard and carried it across 300 km to Anandpur Sahib, where Guru Gobind Singh embraced him with the famous blessing: **'*Ranghreta, Guru ka Beta*'**.
42. **Lakhi Shah Vanjara at Rakab Ganj:** Trader **Lakhi Shah Vanjara** carried Guru Tegh Bahadur's headless body in a hay cart to his house in Raisina village and set his own entire house and estate on fire to cremate the sacred body secretly; site marked by **Gurdwara Rakab Ganj Sahib**.
43. **Creation of the Khalsa (13 April 1699):** At Anandpur Sahib on Baisakhi day, Guru Gobind Singh demanded five heads for sacrifice; five devoted disciples answered (**Daya Ram, Dharam Das, Himmat Rai, Mohkam Chand, Sahib Chand**), who were baptized as the **Panj Pyare** (Five Beloved Ones) with sweet nectar (**Amrit**) stirred with a double-edged dagger (**Khanda**).
44. **The Five Mandatory Ks (Panj Kakar):** Guru Gobind Singh ordained every baptized Khalsa to perpetually wear: (1) **Kesh** (uncut hair), (2) **Kangha** (wooden comb), (3) **Kara** (iron bangle), (4) **Kachera** (cotton undergarment), and (5) **Kirpan** (curved defensive sword).
45. **Martyrdom of the Four Sahibzadas (1704 CE):** The elder two sons (**Ajit Singh, 18, and Jujhar Singh, 14**) died fighting heroically at the **Battle of Chamkaur**; the younger two sons (**Zorawar Singh, 9, and Fateh Singh, 7**) were bricked alive at Sirhind by Mughal governor Wazir Khan for refusing to apostatize.
46. ***Zafarnama* (Epistle of Victory):** A historic 111-verse letter in classical **Persian verse** written by Guru Gobind Singh in 1705 from Dina Kangar to Emperor Aurangzeb, rebuking the emperor for violating oaths taken on the Quran and declaring: **'*When all peaceful avenues have failed, it is righteous to lift the sword.*'**
47. **Banda Singh Bahadur's Agrarian Revolution:** Raised by Guru Gobind Singh at Nanded; routed Mughal armies at **Chappar Chiri (1710)** and executed governor Wazir Khan; struck coins bearing the inscriptions of Nanak and Gobind; abolished oppressive feudal absentee landlordism across eastern Punjab, transferring proprietary rights to the cultivating peasantry.
48. **Execution of Banda Singh Bahadur (1716 CE):** Captured after an 8-month heroic siege at Gurdas Nangal; paraded in iron cages to Delhi and brutally executed near the Qutb Minar along with 700 followers under Emperor **Farrukhsiyar**.
49. **The Twelve Sikh Misls (Confederacies):** Autonomous military fraternities organized under the Dal Khalsa: **Sukerchakia, Ahluwalia, Bhangi, Kanheya, Ramgarhia, Phulkian, Faizalpuria, Dallewalia, Nishanwalia, Shaheed, Karorsinghia, Nakai**; gathered semi-annually at Amritsar to pass unanimous national resolutions (**Gurmatta**).

50. **Maharaja Ranjit Singh's Secular Rule (1799–1839 CE):** Belonged to the **Sukerchakia Misl**; unified Punjab; captured Lahore (1799) and Amritsar (1802); ruled in the name of the Khalsa (*Sarkar-i-Khalsa*); appointed Dogras (Gulab Singh, Dhian Singh), Muslims (Fakir Azizuddin, Nuruddin), and Europeans (Generals Allard, Ventura, Court, Avitabile) to supreme offices; gold-plated the sanctum of Harmandir Sahib.

⏱ Timeline / Chronology

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[1469–1539 CE] GURU NANAK DEV: Founder; Nankana Sahib; Sangat & Pangat; passes away at Kartarpur
   |
[1504–1552 CE] GURU ANGAD DEV: Lehna; standardizes Gurmukhi script; Mall Akhara
   |
[1479–1574 CE] GURU AMAR DAS: 22 Manjis; Anand Karaj; opposes Sati; visited by Akbar at Goindwal
   |
[1534–1581 CE] GURU RAM DAS: Founds Amritsar (Ramdaspur); digs Amrit Sarovar; introduces Masands
   |
[1563–1606 CE] GURU ARJAN DEV: Harmandir Sahib (1588); compiles Adi Granth (1604); martyred by Jahangir
   |
[1595–1644 CE] GURU HARGOBIND: Miri & Piri swords; builds Akal Takht (1606); militarization
   |
[1630–1661 CE] GURU HAR RAI: Maintained 2,200 horsemen; sheltered Dara Shikoh
   |
[1656–1664 CE] GURU HAR KRISHAN: "Child Guru" (aged 5–8); smallpox service at Delhi (Bangla Sahib)
   |
[1621–1675 CE] GURU TEGH BAHADUR: "Hind ki Chadar"; executed at Chandni Chowk by Aurangzeb (Sis Ganj)
   |
[1666–1708 CE] GURU GOBIND SINGH: Born Patna; Khalsa founded (1699); Panj Pyare; Zafarnama; Nanded
   |
[1708–1716 CE] BANDA SINGH BAHADUR: Crushes Sirhind (1710); abolishes zamindari; executed (1716)
   |
[1799–1839 CE] MAHARAJA RANJIT SINGH: Sukerchakia Misl; captures Lahore (1799); Treaty of Amritsar (1809)
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The Ten Sikh Gurus (Comprehensive Master Reference)

ORDER & NAME	LIFE SPAN	GURUSHIP ERA	DEFINING CONTRIBUTION	CONTEMPORARY MUGHAL MONARCH(S)
1. Guru Nanak Dev	1469–1539 CE	1469–1539 CE	Founded Sikhism; *Japji Sahib*; Sangat & Pangat	Bahlul Lodi, Sikandar Lodi, Ibrahim Lodi, Babur
2. Guru Angad Dev	1504–1552 CE	1539–1552 CE	Standardized **Gurmukhi script**; physical culture	Humayun, Sher Shah Suri, Islam Shah Suri
3. Guru Amar Das	1479–1574 CE	1552–1574 CE	Instituted **22 Manjis**; *Anand Karaj*; anti-Sati	Humayun, Akbar
4. Guru Ram Das	1534–1581 CE	1574–1581 CE	Founded **Amritsar**; excavated Amrit Sarovar	Akbar
5. Guru Arjan Dev	1563–1606 CE	1581–1606 CE	Built **Harmandir Sahib**; compiled **Adi Granth (1604)**	Akbar, **Jahangir** (ordered execution)
6. Guru Hargobind	1595–1644 CE	1606–1644 CE	**Miri and Piri** swords; founded **Akal Takht (1606)**	Jahangir, Shah Jahan
7. Guru Har Rai	1630–1661 CE	1644–1661 CE	Maintained cavalry; aided Dara Shikoh	Shah Jahan, Aurangzeb
8. Guru Har Krishan	1656–1664 CE	1661–1664 CE	"Child Guru" (served Delhi smallpox victims)	Aurangzeb
9. Guru Tegh Bahadur	1621–1675 CE	1664–1675 CE	**"Hind ki Chadar"**; martyred at Chandni Chowk	**Aurangzeb** (ordered execution)
10. Guru Gobind Singh	1666–1708 CE	1675–1708 CE	Founded the **Khalsa (1699)**; Five Ks; *Zafarnama*	Aurangzeb, Bahadur Shah I

📊 Quick Reference Grid

1. The Five Historical Takhts of Sikhism

TAKHT NAME	GEOGRAPHICAL LOCATION	FOUNDING AUTHORITY & ERA	HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION & RELIGIOUS SIGNIFICANCE
1. Akal Takht Sahib	Amritsar (facing Golden Temple)	**Guru Hargobind (1606 CE)**	Highest seat of temporal authority of the Khalsa; issues sovereign *Hukamnamas*
2. Takht Sri Damdama Sahib	Talwandi Sabo, Bathinda (Punjab)	Guru Gobind Singh (1705 CE)	Where Guru Gobind Singh finalized the complete, definitive edition of Guru Granth Sahib
3. Takht Sri Keshgarh Sahib	Anandpur Sahib, Ropar (Punjab)	Guru Gobind Singh (**1699 CE**)	Birthplace of the **Khalsa**; venue of the historic Baisakhi assembly and Panj Pyare
4. Takht Sri Patna Sahib	Patna (Bihar)	Established by Maharaja Ranjit Singh	Birthplace of **Guru Gobind Singh (1666 CE)**; commemorates his childhood days
5. Takht Sri Hazur Sahib	Nanded (Maharashtra)	Built by Maharaja Ranjit Singh (1832)	Where Guru Gobind Singh breathed his last in 1708 and declared Granth Sahib eternal Guru

2. Historic Delhi Gurdwaras Associated with Sikh Gurus

GURDWARA NAME	LOCATION IN DELHI	HISTORIC GURU ASSOCIATION & EVENT
Gurdwara Sis Ganj Sahib	Chandni Chowk, Old Delhi	Site of the public beheading of **Guru Tegh Bahadur** on 24 November 1675 by Aurangzeb
Gurdwara Rakab Ganj Sahib	Near Parliament House, New Delhi	Site where Lakhi Shah Vanjara burned his own house to secretly cremate Guru Tegh Bahadur's body
Gurdwara Bangla Sahib	Connaught Place, New Delhi	Former palace bungalow of Raja Jai Singh where **Guru Har Krishan** stayed and cured epidemic victims
Gurdwara Bala Sahib	Ring Road, Sarai Kale Khan	Cremation site of 8th Guru **Har Krishan**, Mata Sundari, and Mata Sahib Kaur
Gurdwara Majnu ka Tila	Outer Ring Road, Timarpur	Historic site visited by **Guru Nanak Dev** and later by Guru Hargobind during Jahangir's reign

3. The Twelve Misls of the Dal Khalsa

MISL NAME	FOUNDER / PIVOTAL LEADER	CORE HEADQUARTERS / TERRITORY	HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE
1. Sukerchakia	Charat Singh & Mahan Singh	Gujranwala (Punjab, Pak)	Misl of **Maharaja Ranjit Singh**; unified all 12 misls into the sovereign Sikh Empire
2. Ahluwalia	**Jassa Singh Ahluwalia**	Kapurthala	Commanded the Dal Khalsa; struck coins in Lahore; took title *Sultan-ul-Qaum*
3. Bhangi	Chhajja Singh / Hari Singh Bhangi	Amritsar & Lahore	Named after addiction to *bhang*; held the celebrated Zamzama Cannon (*Bhangianwali Tope*)
4. Kanheya	Jai Singh Kanheya	Batala / Gurdaspur	Ranjit Singh married Mehtab Kaur (granddaughter of Jai Singh and daughter of Sada Kaur)
5. Ramgarhia	**Jassa Singh Ramgarhia**	Sri Hargobindpur	Renowned warrior and carpenter artisan; captured the Red Fort's coronation slab in 1783
6. Phulkian	Phul Singh / Baba Ala Singh	Patiala, Nabha, Jind	Maintained friendly relations with Ahmad Shah Abdali and the British East India Company
7. Faizalpuria (Singhpuria)	**Nawab Kapur Singh**	Jalandhar	Formed the Dal Khalsa in 1748; conferred titles and divided forces into Taruna & Budha Dal
8. Dallewalia	Gulab Singh Dallewalia	Rahon / Doaba	Valiant horsemen controlling upper Doaba region
9. Nishanwalia	Dasaundha Singh	Ambala	Standard-bearers of the Dal Khalsa in battles
10. Shaheed	**Baba Deep Singh**	Talwandi Sabo	Deep Singh fought at Amritsar with his severed head supported in his left hand (1757)
11. Karorsinghia	Karora Singh / Baghel Singh	Hoshiarpur / Delhi	**Baghel Singh** captured Delhi in 1783 and built all historic Delhi Gurdwaras
12. Nakai	Hira Singh Nakai	Chunian / South of Lahore	Ranjit Singh's second wife Datar Kaur (Raj Kaur) was from this misl

🧠 Memory Anchors & Mnemonics

1. **Chronological Order of Ten Sikh Gurus: N–A–A–R–A–H–H–H–T–G** - **N**anak (1469–1539) - **A**ngad (1504–1552) - **A**mar Das (1479–1574) - **R**am Das (1534–1581) - **A**rjan Dev (1563–1606) - **H**argobind (1595–1644) - **H**ar Rai (1630–1661) - **H**ar Krishan (1656–1664) - **T**egh Bahadur (1621–1675) - **G**obind Singh (1666–1708) - *Mnemonic Hook:* "No Army Attacks Royal Armies, Heavy Horsemen Have Tremendous Guns"
2. **The Two Martyr Gurus & Executing Mughal Emperors:** - **5th Guru Arjan Dev** = Executed by **Jahangir (1606)** at Lahore. - **9th Guru Tegh Bahadur** = Executed by **Aurangzeb (1675)** at Delhi. - *Memory Hook:* 5th by 4th Mughal (Jahangir); 9th by 6th Mughal (Aurangzeb).
3. **The Five Mandatory Ks (Panj Kakar):** - **K**esh (Uncut hair - spirituality) - **K**angha (Wooden comb - cleanliness) - **K**ara (Iron bangle - moral restraint) - **K**achera (Cotton shorts - chastity & agility) - **K**irpan (Curved sword - defense of the oppressed)
4. **Amritsar City Foundation Anchor:** - Land granted by **Akbar**. - Pool excavated by **Guru Ram Das** (4th Guru). - Temple built by **Guru Arjan Dev** (5th Guru); foundation by Sufi saint **Mian Mir**.

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill

> **Mastery Rule:** Read the consolidated facts above, attempt these high-yield questions, and score ≥80% to conquer this chapter.

Q1. With reference to Guru Nanak, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Born at Talwandi (Nankana Sahib) in 1469.
2. Started langar and sangat institutions.
3. Chose Lehna (Angad) over his own sons as successor.

A. 1 and 2 B. 2 and 3 C. 1 and 3 D. 1, 2 and 3

▶ Details

Q3. Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Guru Angad — Gurmukhi standardisation
2. Guru Arjan — Adi Granth (1604)
3. Guru Gobind Singh — Dasam Granth as the eternal Guru replacing Adi Granth

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 only B. 3 only C. 1 and 2 only D. 2 and 3 only

▶ Details

Q5. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below:

LIST-I (GURU)	LIST-II (KEY INSTITUTION / CONTRIBUTION)
A. Guru Angad	1. 22 Manjis; Goindwal langar
B. Guru Amar Das	2. Gurmukhi standardisation
C. Guru Ram Das	3. Amritsar / Ramdaspur (Akbar grant to Bibi Bhani)
D. Guru Hargobind	4. Miri–Piri; Akal Takht

Row order is not the answer code.

A. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4 B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3 C. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4 D. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4

▶ Details

Q7. Consider Cause–Course–Result linking martyrdom to militarisation:

1. Cause: Arjan's martyrdom (1606) under Jahangir.
2. Course: Hargobind developed miri–piri and the Akal Takht.
3. Result: Tegh Bahadur's martyrdom (1675) later fed Gobind Singh's path toward the Khalsa.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A. Only 2 and 3 B. Only 1 C. 1 and 2 D. Only 1, 2 and 3

▶ Details

Q9. With reference to Harmandir Sahib and Akal Takht, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Harmandir Sahib is the spiritual centre.
2. Akal Takht is the temporal seat associated with Hargobind.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 1 B. Only 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Neither 1 nor 2

▶ Details

Q11. Arrange the following events in chronological order:

1. Compilation of Adi Granth
2. Martyrdom of Guru Tegh Bahadur
3. Founding of the Khalsa
4. Battle of Bhangani

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1-2-3-4 B. 1-4-2-3 C. 1-2-4-3 D. 4-1-2-3

▶ Details

Q13. With reference to Zafarnama, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It is Gobind Singh's Persian letter to Aurangzeb.
2. It is the opening hymn of the Adi Granth composed by Kabir.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 1 B. Only 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Neither 1 nor 2

▶ Details

Q15. Consider the following statements about Manji and Masand:

1. Manjis were Amar Das's 22 preaching circles.
2. Masand related to Arjan's tenth collection.
3. Manji and Masand are identical offices created by Nanak alone.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A. Only 1 B. Only 1 and 2 C. Only 3 D. 1 and 3

▶ Show answer

Chapter 13: Maratha State & Maratha Confederacy

📰 Current Affairs & High-Yield Updates

YEAR/REF	KEY FACT	EXAM RELEVANCE
2023–2024	**350th Anniversary of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj's Coronation:** National and state-level celebrations at Raigad Fort (*Shiv Rajyabhisheka Sohala*)	Shivaji's coronation took place on **6 June 1674** at Raigad Fort, officiated by **Gaga Bhatt** of Varanasi
2023	**Indian Navy's New Ensign & Admiral Epaulettes:** Octagonal seal design inspired directly by **Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj's Rajmudra**	Commemorates Shivaji as the 'Father of the Indian Navy' (built fortified naval docks at Sindhudurg, Vijaydurg, Kolaba)
2024	**UNESCO World Heritage Nomination: Maratha Military Landscapes:** Nomination of 12 forts including **Raigad, Shivneri, Torna, Pratapgad, Sinhagad, Sindhudurg, Jinji**	UPPCS tests fort architectures, battles (Pratapgad against Afzal Khan 1659; Purandar 1665; Jinji siege 1690–98)
2023	**Repatriation of the Historic 'Wagh Nakh' (Tiger Claws):** Brought from Victoria & Albert Museum (London) to Maharashtra museums for public display	Used by Shivaji to vanquish Bijapuri general **Afzal Khan** at Pratapgad on 10 November 1659
2024	**National Panipat War Memorial Projects:** Upgradation of the Panipat Third Battle memorial at Kala Amb (Haryana)	Third Battle of Panipat fought on **14 January 1761** between Sadashivrao Bhau and Ahmad Shah Abdali

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Shivaji (1630–1680)** built swaraj (स्वराज), was crowned **Chhatrapati at Raigad (रायगढ़) in 1674** (**Gaga Bhatt / Vishweshwar** of Banaras declared him Kshatriya), and died at Raigad in **1680**.
2. He was born at **Shivneri** to **Shahji Bhonsle** and **Jijabai**; tradition remembers **Samarth Ramdas** as his guru (गुरु).
3. At **Pratapgad in 1659**, Shivaji killed Bijapur (बीजापुर)'s **Afzal Khan** and expanded western Deccan (दक्कन) power.
4. By the **Treaty of Purandar (पुरंदर) (1665)** with **Raja (राजा) Jai Singh I**, Shivaji surrendered **23 forts**; the **Agra** (आगरा) detention followed in **1666**. He defeated the Mughals at **Salher in 1672**.
5. Big **Deshmukhs** opposed an independent Maratha state because they preferred remaining **Bijapur feudal lords**.
6. The **Ashtapradhan** (अष्टप्रधान) was Shivaji's eight-minister council; under him the **Peshwa** (पेशवा) was one minister, not the sovereign.
7. Ashtapradhan portfolios: **Peshwa** (पेशवा / मुख्य प्रधान - admin), **Amatya** (अमात्य / मजूमदार - finance/revenue), **Mantri** (मंत्री / वाक़ियानवीस - records/home), **Senapati** (सेनापति / सर-ए-नौबत - army (सेना) chief), **Sumant** (सुमंत / डबीर - foreign affairs), **Nyayadish** (न्यायाधीश - justice), **Pandit Rao** (पंडितराव / दानाध्यक्ष - religious endowments), **Sachiv** (सचिव / सुरनवीस - royal correspondence).
8. **Chauth** (चौथ) is a **25%** (1/4) protection levy; **sardeshmukhi** (सरदेशमुखी) is an extra **10%** (1/10) hereditary chief claim (together up to **35%**). **Saranzami** (सरंजामी) land supported Maratha jagirdars' livelihood.
9. From **1713**, **Balaji Vishwanath** (बालाजी विश्वनाथ) made the Peshwa office **hereditary** and de facto ruling under Shahu (शाहू).
10. Core Peshwa order: **Balaji Vishwanath** → **Bajirao (बाजीराव) I (बाजीराव I)** → **Balaji Bajirao (बालाजी बाजीराव)** → **Madhav Rao I (माधवराव)** → **Narayan Rao (नारायणराव)** → **Raghunath Rao**.
11. **Bajirao I (1720–40)** drove north expansion; **Balaji Bajirao (1740–61)** belongs to the Panipat III generation. By the **Sangola (सांगोला) agreement (1750)**, the Chhatrapati became a do-nothing king and the **Peshwa** the real head.
12. **Madhav Rao I (1761–72)** comes **before Narayan Rao (1772–73)**; do not reverse them.
13. At **Panipat III on 14 January 1761**, **Ahmad Shah Abdali (अब्दाली)** defeated the Marathas under **Sadashiv Rao Bhau (भाऊ)**; heir **Vishwas Rao** was killed. Eyewitness **Kashiraj Pandit** called it catastrophic; immediate spark was Maratha expulsion of Abdali's viceroy (वायसराय) **Timur Shah** from **Lahore**.
14. Panipat III is not Panipat I (**1526**) or II (**1556**); **Shivaji** (शिवाजी) was already dead and did not fight it.
15. **Nadir Shah (नादिर शाह)'s Delhi sack (1739)** is a separate Afghan shock from Abdali's Panipat victory.
16. After Shivaji, **Sambhaji** (सम्भाजी) was executed in **1689**; **Rajaram** then **Tarabai** (for **Shivaji II**) led resistance; at **Aurangzeb (औरंगजेब)'s death** Maratha leadership was with **Tarabai**. **Shahu** was released after **1707** and the Peshwa line rose.
17. Later confederacy seats: **Peshwa–Pune (पुणे)**, **Scindia–Gwalior**, **Holkar–Indore**, **Gaekwad–Baroda**, **Bhonsle–Nagpur**.
18. The **Treaty of Lanavada (लानावड़ा) (1718)** won Mughal (मुग़ल) recognition (मान्यता) of Maratha chauth rights.
19. **Palkhed (1728)** is Bajirao I's famous campaign against the **Nizam** (निजाम).
20. Shivaji's navy used Konkan forts such as **Sindhudurg** and **Vijaydurg**.
21. Maratha **chauth** reached the **Doab** (दोआब), **Bundelkhand**, and **Rohilkhand**.
22. Peshwa power ended with the British in **1818**; the last Peshwa was **Baji Rao II**.
23. **Shaista Khan** was raided in Pune in **1663** before the Purandar settlement.

24. **Abwab** (अबवाब) and **Jamadani** are distractors; the protection revenue name asked is **Chauth**.
25. Cause–course–result for Purandar: Aurangzeb sent Jai Singh, Shivaji surrendered forts under treaty, then recovered strength toward the 1674 coronation.
26. Cause–course–result for Panipat III: Maratha northern surge met Abdali and Najib-ud-Daula; Bhau's army was crushed; the all-India northern surge broke though the confederacy survived.
27. **Modi script** (मोड़ी लिपि) was used in Maratha revenue and administrative papers.
28. **Ahilyabai Holkar** (अहल्याबाई होल्कर) ruled from the **Holkar** house of **Indore**.
29. Ashtapradhan ministers headed departments but did **not** hold independent cabinet power; Shivaji could accept or reject advice.
30. **Shivaji's Birth and Family Lineage:** Born at **Shivneri Fort** (near Junnar, Pune) on **19 February 1630**; son of Shahaji Bhonsle (feudatory noble of Ahmadnagar and Bijapur) and Jijabai (daughter of Lakhuji Jadhav of Sindkhed).
31. **First Fort Conquest (Torna 1646):** Captured the fortress of **Torna** at the tender age of 16 from the Sultan of Bijapur, utilizing the discovered royal treasure to fortify the adjoining hill into **Rajgad Fort**, his first administrative capital.
32. **Encounter with Afzal Khan (10 November 1659):** Met the giant Bijapuri commander Afzal Khan at the foot of **Pratapgad Fort**; when Afzal Khan attempted assassination in a treacherous embrace, Shivaji slew him using concealed **Bagh Nakh** (steel tiger claws) and a **Bichhwa** (curved dagger).
33. **Shaista Khan Night Attack (April 1663):** Daringly infiltrated the heavily guarded **Lal Mahal** in Pune with 400 chosen Mavali commandos; wounded the Mughal viceroy Shaista Khan (maternal uncle of Aurangzeb), cutting off his three fingers and killing his son Abul Fath.
34. **First Sack of Surat (January 1664):** Plundered the paramount Mughal western trade emporium of **Surat** for six days, extracting over 1 crore rupees in bullion and merchandise without molesting European Christian missionaries or innocent civilians.
35. **Treaty of Purandar (11 June 1665):** Besieged at Purandar Fort by **Mirza Raja Jai Singh I** of Amber; Shivaji agreed to surrender **23 out of 35 forts** yielding 4 lakh huns annual revenue, retaining 12 forts for himself, and sending Sambhaji with 5,000 horse to imperial service.
36. **Escape from Agra (17 August 1666):** Insulted by Aurangzeb at court by being placed behind 5,000-rank nobles; placed under house arrest in Ram Singh's haveli; staged a dramatic escape concealed in large sweetmeat and fruit baskets dispatched as alms to Brahmins and fakirs.
37. **Battle of Salher (February 1672):** Historic open-field cavalry battle in which Maratha commanders **Moro Pant Pingle** and **Prataprao Gujar** decisively routed a 40,000-strong Mughal army, shattering the myth of Mughal tactical superiority.
38. **Formal Coronation at Raigad (6 June 1674):** Anointed *Chhatrapati* according to full Vedic rites by celebrated scholar **Gaga Bhatt (Visheshwar)** of Varanasi; took the titles ***Haidava Dharmoddharak*** (Protector of Hindu Faith) and ***Kshatriya Kulavantas***; struck gold **Hon** and copper **Shivrai** coins and founded the **Rajyabhisheka Shaka** calendar.
39. **Second Tantric Coronation (September 1674):** Following the demise of his beloved mother Jijabai eleven days after the first coronation, Shivaji underwent a second, tantric consecration ceremony officiated by ascetic priest **Nishchal Puri Goswami**.
40. **Composition of the Ashtapradhan Council:** 1. **Peshwa** (Prime Minister), 2. **Amatya** (Finance), 3. **Waqia-Navis** (Interior/Intelligence), 4. **Shuru-Navis / Sachiv** (Royal Correspondence), 5. **Senapati / Sari-Naubat** (Armed Forces), 6. **Sumant / Dabir** (Foreign Affairs), 7. **Nyayadhish** (Chief Justice), 8. **Panditrao** (Ecclesiastical & Charity).
41. **Military Obligation of Ashtapradhan:** A perennial UPPCS trap: with the sole exception of the **Nyayadhish** (Judge) and **Panditrao** (Priest), all the remaining six ministers of the Ashtapradhan were legally bound to lead armed military campaigns and command battalions in the field.
42. **Kathi Land Measurement:** Replaced arbitrary estimations with exact field measurement utilizing the **Kathi** (measuring bamboo rod of 5 cubits and 5 closed fists); state revenue was fixed at 33%, later revised to 40% after abolishing 40 irregular feudal taxes (*abwabs*).
43. **Chauth vs Sardeshmukhi Formula: Chauth** was 1/4th (25%) of gross revenue collected from non-Maratha territories as insurance against Maratha plundering; **Sardeshmukhi** was an additional 1/10th (10%) tribute claimed by Shivaji by virtue of his hereditary royal right as paramount chief (*Sardeshmukh*) of Maharashtra.
44. **Bargir vs Silahdar Cavalry: Bargirs** were regular cavalry troopers mounted on state-owned horses and equipped directly from the imperial armory (*paga*); **Silahdars** were aristocratic freelance horsemen who maintained their own war-horses, weapons, and provisions.
45. **Founding of the Maratha Navy:** Shivaji recognized that *'He who commands the sea commands the realm'*; built fortified naval arsenals at **Sindhudurg, Vijaydurg, and Kolaba**, commanding over 400 fighting vessels under admirals **Maynak Bhandari** and **Daryasarang**.
46. **Torture and Martyrdom of Sambhaji (1689 CE):** Betrayed by local chieftains and captured by Muqarrab Khan at Sangameshwar; brought before Aurangzeb at Bahadurgarh; steadfastly refused conversion to Islam; endured horrific torture (eyes gouged out, tongue severed) and executed at **Tulapur** on 11 March 1689.
47. **Siege of Jinji and Santaji-Dhanaji Heroics:** Following Sambhaji's death, younger brother **Rajaram** shifted the Maratha royal court to **Jinji (Tamil Nadu)**, holding off Mughal commander Zulfiqar Khan for eight years (1690–1698) while generals **Santaji Ghorpade** and **Dhanaji Jadhav** paralyzed Mughal supply lines across the Deccan.
48. **Rani Tarabai's Heroic Leadership (1700–1707 CE):** Following Rajaram's death, his courageous widow **Tarabai** served as regent for her infant son Shivaji II, organizing the counter-offensive that drove imperial Mughal armies out of Maharashtra and into defensive retreat.
49. **Baji Rao I's Hindu Pad-Padshahi:** Son of Balaji Vishwanath; legendary military genius who never lost a battle in his 20-year career (1720–1740); championed **Hindu Pad-Padshahi**; defeated Nizam-ul-Mulk at **Palkhed (1728)** using lightning cavalry speed; captured Bassein from the Portuguese (1739).

50. **Third Battle of Panipat (14 January 1761):** Fought on Makar Sankranti between the Maratha Empire under **Sadashivrao Bhau** and Afghan invader **Ahmad Shah Abdali** allied with Najib-ud-Daulah and Shuja-ud-Daulah; over 100,000 Maratha soldiers and camp-followers massacred; ended Maratha aspirations to replace the Mughals on the Delhi throne.

⏱️ Timeline / Chronology

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[19 Feb 1630] Birth of Shivaji Maharaj at Shivneri Fort
   |
[1646 CE] First military conquest: Torna Fort captured; Rajgad built
   |
[10 Nov 1659] Slaying of Afzal Khan at Pratapgad Fort using *Bagh Nakh*
   |
[Apr 1663] Daring midnight raid on Shaista Khan at Lal Mahal, Pune
   |
[Jan 1664] First Sack of Surat (1 crore rupees captured for Swaraj)
   |
[11 June 1665] Treaty of Purandar signed with Mirza Raja Jai Singh I (23 forts surrendered)
   |
[May–Aug 1666] Visit to Agra imperial court; house arrest and dramatic escape in sweet baskets
   |
[6 June 1674] Formal Coronation at Raigad Fort by Gaga Bhatt (assumed title *Chhatrapati*)
   |
[3 Apr 1680] Demise of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj at Raigad Fort (aged 50)
   |
[1680–1689] Reign of Chhatrapati Sambhaji; martyred at Tulapur by Aurangzeb (1689)
   |
[1689–1700] Chhatrapati Rajaram shifts capital to Jinji (Tamil Nadu) during 8-year siege
   |
[1700–1707] Regency of Rani Tarabai; guerrilla warfare exhausts Aurangzeb in the Deccan
   |
[1713–1720] Balaji Vishwanath: First Peshwa; Treaty of 1719 ("Magna Carta of Maratha Dominion")
   |
[1720–1740] Baji Rao I: Preached *Hindu Pad-Padshahi*; Battle of Palkhed (1728); raid on Delhi (1737)
   |
[1740–1761] Balaji Baji Rao (Nana Saheb): Sangola Pact (1750); Maratha Empire reaches Attock (1758)
   |
[14 Jan 1761] Third Battle of Panipat: Marathas under Sadashivrao Bhau routed by Ahmad Shah Abdali
```

Dynastic Evolution: Chhatrapatis to the Peshwa Confederacy

ERA / PHASE	REIGNING HEAD / LEADERSHIP	IMPERIAL SEAT	KEY LANDMARK & EVENTS
Shivaji's Swaraj (1674–1680)	**Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj**	**Raigad Fort**	Ashtapradhan, Chauth & Sardeshmukhi, Kathi system, creation of navy
Sambhaji's Rule (1680–1689)	**Chhatrapati Sambhaji**	Raigad Fort	Fought Mughals, Portuguese, Siddies; executed at Tulapur (1689)
War of Independence (1689–1707)	**Rajaram** & **Rani Tarabai**	**Jinji** (TN) → Satara	8-year siege of Jinji; Santaji Ghorpade & Dhanaji Jadhav guerrilla raids
First Peshwa (1713–1720)	**Balaji Vishwanath**	Satara / Pune	Made Peshwaship hereditary; treaty with Sayyid brothers (1719)
Peshwa Baji Rao I (1720–1740)	**Baji Rao I** (*Fighting Peshwa*)	**Pune** (Shaniwar Wada)	Won Palkhed (1728); conquered Malwa, Gujarat; Bassein from Portuguese
Nana Saheb (1740–1761)	**Balaji Baji Rao**	Pune	Sangola Agreement (1750); peak expansion; Third Battle of Panipat (1761)
Peshwa Restoration (1761–1772)	**Madhavrao I**	Pune	Defeated Hyder Ali, Nizam, Rohillas; brought Emperor Shah Alam II to Delhi
Regency of Nana Phadnavis	Sawai Madhavrao	Pune	"Maratha Machiavelli"; Treaty of Salbai (1782) concluding First Anglo-Maratha War
Fall of the Peshwaship (1796–1818)	**Baji Rao II**	Pune	Treaty of Bassein (1802); Third Anglo-Maratha War (1818); Peshwaship abolished

📊 Quick Reference Grid

1. Shivaji's Ashtapradhan Council (8 Central Ministers)

OFFICIAL TITLE	SANSKRIT / PERSIAN EQUIVALENT	PORTFOLIO & CORE IMPERIAL FUNCTIONS	MILITARY COMMAND OBLIGATION
1. Peshwa	**Mukhya Pradhan** (मुख्य प्रधान)	Prime Minister; general administration, royal welfare, signing state papers	**Yes (led armed forces)**
2. Amatya	**Mazumdar** (मजमुआदार)	Finance and Revenue Minister; audited all state income, expenditure, accounts	**Yes (led armed forces)**
3. Waqia-Navis	**Mantri** (मंत्री)	Home Minister and Court Chronicler; state intelligence, royal diary records	**Yes (led armed forces)**
4. Shuru-Navis	**Sachiv / Surnis** (सचिव)	Royal Correspondence; drafted royal firmans, verified accounts of parganas	**Yes (led armed forces)**
5. Senapati	**Sari-Naubat** (सर-ए-नौबत)	Commander-in-Chief; military recruitment, field command, discipline of army	**Yes (Supreme Commander)**
6. Sumant	**Dabir** (दबीर)	Foreign Minister; handled foreign diplomacy, envoys, international treaties	**Yes (led armed forces)**
7. Nyayadhish	**Chief Justice** (न्यायाधीश)	Supreme judicial arbiter for civil, criminal, and agrarian disputes	**NO (Strictly Exempt)**
8. Panditrao	**Dhanadhyaksha** (दानाध्यक्ष)	Chief Religious Officer; charity, religious rites, penances, temple grants	**NO (Strictly Exempt)**

2. Maratha Military & Revenue Glossary

TERM	CATEGORY	SPECIFIC DEFINITION & EXAMINER TRAP
Chauth (चौथ)	Revenue Tax	**1/4th (25%)** of the standard land revenue demanded from non-Maratha territories in exchange for protection from plunder
Sardeshmukhi (सरदेशमुखी)	Sovereign Tribute	Additional **1/10th (10%)** tax claimed by Shivaji as hereditary paramount chief (*Sardeshmukh*) of Maharashtra
Bargir (बारगीर)	Cavalry	Regular cavalrymen mounted on **state-owned horses** and armed from the royal treasury
Silahdar (सिलहदार)	Cavalry	Freelance noble cavalrymen who provided and maintained **their own horses and weapons**
Mavali (मावली)	Infantry	Fierce hill foot-soldiers from the Western Ghats (Maval region); formed the backbone of Shivaji's infantry
Kathi (काठी)	Measurement	Standard land measurement rod comprising **5 cubits and 5 closed fists**; based on Malik Ambar's system
Mirasdars (मिरासदार)	Agrarian Class	Hereditary peasant proprietors in Maharashtra who owned permanent land tenure rights
Gorkhi / Upari (उपरी)	Agrarian Class	Tenant farmers with temporary, leasehold cultivation rights
Deshmukh & Deshpande	Local Officers	Hereditary district revenue officials (Deshmukh = chief executive; Deshpande = accountant)

3. The Five Branches of the Maratha Confederacy

RULING FAMILY / DYNASTY	PRINCIPAL SEAT / CAPITAL	REGION / TERRITORY	FOUNDER / PIVOTAL LEADER
1. Peshwas	**Pune (Poona)**	Western Maharashtra	Balaji Vishwanath / Baji Rao I
2. Scindias (Shindes)	**Gwalior** (originally Ujjain)	Malwa & Gwalior (MP)	Ranoji Scindia / **Mahadji Scindia**
3. Holkars	**Indore** (originally Maheshwar)	Malwa (MP)	Malhar Rao Holkar / **Rani Ahilyabai Holkar**
4. Gaekwads	**Baroda (Vadodara)**	Gujarat	Damaji Gaekwad / Pilaji Gaekwad
5. Bhonsles	**Nagpur**	Berar & Central Provinces	Raghuji Bhonsle I (raided Bengal)

🧠 Memory Anchors & Mnemonics

1. **Shivaji's 4 Key Encounters in Exact Sequence (1659–1666):** - 1659: **Afzal Khan** (Slain at Pratapgad with *Bagh Nakh*) - 1663: **Shaista Khan** (Lal Mahal night raid; severed 3 fingers) - 1664: **First Sack of Surat** (1 crore rupees booty) - 1665: **Treaty of Purandar** (Signed with Mirza Raja Jai Singh I; 23 forts surrendered) - 1666: **Agra House Arrest & Sweet-Basket Escape**

2. **The Ashtapradhan Military Exemption Trap:** - **Exempt from War:** ONLY **Nyayadhish** (Judge) and **Panditrao** (Priest). - **Compelled to Fight:** All other 6 (Peshwa, Amatya, Mantri, Sachiv, Senapati, Sumant).
3. **Chauth vs Sardeshmukhi Fractions:** - **Chauth** = **1/4th (25%)** (Protection fee / चौथाई). - **Sardeshmukhi** = **1/10th (10%)** (Hereditary Sardeshmukh right). - Total burden on raided territory = **35% (25% + 10%)**.
4. **Maratha Confederacy Cities Matching:** - **P**eshwa = **P**une (**P–P**) - **S**cindia = **G**walior (**S–G**) - **H**olkar = **I**ndore (**H–I**) - **G**aekwad = **B**aroda (**G–B**) - **B**honsle = **N**agpur (**B–N**)

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill

> **Mastery Rule:** Read the consolidated facts above, attempt these high-yield questions, and score ≥80% to conquer this chapter.

Q1. With reference to Shivaji, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. He personally commanded the Maratha army at Panipat III in 1761.
2. He was crowned Chhatrapati at Raigad in 1674; Gaga Bhatt of Banaras declared him Kshatriya.
3. He was born at Shivneri to Shahji Bhonsle and Jijabai.

A. 1 and 2 B. Only 3 C. 2 and 3 D. Only 1

▶ Details

Q3. Which of the following pairs is/are NOT correctly matched?

1. Chauth — 25% protection levy
2. Sardeshmukhi — extra 10% hereditary chief claim
3. Chauth — Mughal crown land under Akbar

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 only B. 3 only C. 1 and 2 only D. 2 and 3 only

▶ Details

Q5. Arrange the core Peshwa order:

1. Balaji Vishwanath
2. Bajirao I
3. Balaji Bajirao
4. Madhav Rao I

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1, 2, 3, 4 B. 2, 1, 4, 3 C. 1, 3, 2, 4 D. 3, 1, 2, 4

▶ Details

Q7. With reference to Panipat III (14 January 1761), which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Ahmad Shah Abdali allied with Najib-ud-Daulah (Rohillas) and Shuja-ud-Daulah (Awadh).
2. Sadashivrao Bhau and Vishwasrao commanded the Maratha army.
3. Ibrahim Khan Gardi commanded the Maratha artillery.

A. 1 and 2 B. 1, 2 and 3 C. Only 2 and 3 D. Only 1

▶ Details

Q9. Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): From 1713 Balaji Vishwanath made the Peshwa office hereditary and de facto ruling under Shahu.

Reason (R): By the Sangola agreement (1750) the Chhatrapati became a do-nothing king and the Peshwa the real head.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) B. (A) is false, but (R) is true C. (A) is true, but (R) is false D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

▶ Details

Q11. Arrange the following in chronological order:

1. Battle of Pratapgad (Afzal Khan episode)
2. Treaty of Purandar
3. Battle of Salher

4. Coronation of Shivaji at Raigad

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1, 2, 3, 4 B. 2, 1, 4, 3 C. 1, 3, 2, 4 D. 3, 1, 2, 4

▶ Details

Q13. With reference to Bajirao I and Balaji Bajirao, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Bajirao I championed expansion into North India under the ideal of Hindu Pad Padshahi.
2. Balaji Bajirao oversaw the Sangola Agreement of 1750 which transferred supreme power to the Peshwa.

A. Only 1 B. Only 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Neither 1 nor 2

▶ Details

Q15. Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Narayan Rao ruled the long recovery decade immediately after Panipat III before Madhav Rao I.

Reason (R): Madhav Rao I (1761–72) comes before Narayan Rao (1772–73).

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) B. (A) is false, but (R) is true C. (A) is true, but (R) is false D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

▶ Show answer

Chapter 14: Later Medieval India (Later Mughals & Regional States)

Current Affairs & High-Yield Updates

YEAR/REF	KEY FACT	EXAM RELEVANCE
2023–2024	**Bara Imambara & Rumi Darwaza Structural Conservation (Lucknow):** Major facade and structural restoration by ASI and UP Tourism	Built by **Asaf-ud-Daulah in 1784 CE** as a famine-relief project; unsupported central vault; Rumi Darwaza styled on Constantinople gate
2024	**Heritage Circuit Awadh (Faizabad–Lucknow):** Restoration of Gulab Bari, Bahu Begum Tomb, and Chhota Imambara	Saadat Khan established capital at **Faizabad (1722)**; Asaf-ud-Daulah shifted to **Lucknow (1775)**; core UP Special history
2023	**Murshidabad Heritage Tourism Mission (West Bengal):** Conservation of Hazarduari Palace and Katra Mosque	Founded by **Murshid Quli Khan (1717)**; Alivardi Khan's European doctrine; Siraj-ud-Daulah & Battle of Plassey (1757)
2024	**Bahadur Shah Zafar Memorial & Ghalib Centenary Seminars:** Commemorating the poetic and symbolic legacy of 1857	Last Mughal emperor tried by British military commission, exiled to **Rangoon (Burma)**; died in 1862
2023	**Safdarjung Tomb (New Delhi) Night Illumination:** Conservation of the last grand Mughal garden tomb	Built in 1754 CE for **Safdarjung (Nawab of Awadh & Mughal Wazir)** by his son Nawab Shuja-ud-Daulah

Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. Sea-power arrival order: **Portuguese 1498 → Dutch ~1605 → English Surat factory (फैक्टरी) 1613 (सूरत) → Danish Tranquebar (ट्रैंकेबार) 1620 → French Pondicherry (पांडिचेरी) 1674**.
2. Charter fact: **EIC 1600** (ईआईसी), **VOC 1602** (वीओसी), **Danish 1616**, **French 1664** — the English charter comes **before** the Dutch.
3. **Vasco da Gama (गामा)** reached **Calicut in 1498**; **Afonso de Albuquerque (अल्बुकर्क)** captured **Goa (गोवा) in 1510** and made it Portuguese India's capital.
4. Portuguese **cartaze** (कार्टाज़) was an ocean pass-fee; **Shah Jahan** (शाहजहाँ) expelled the Portuguese from **Hooghly (हुगली) in 1632**.
5. The Dutch **VOC** used **Pulicat** as its South Indian headquarters and **Chinsurah** (चिन्सुरा) as its Bengal factory.
6. **William Hawkins (हॉकिन्स)** reached India in **1608** on the *Hector*, spoke **Turkish**, and met Jahangir (जहाँगीर); the trap year **1611** is false for arrival.
7. **Sir Thomas Roe (रो)** was ambassador at Jahangir's court from **1615 to 1619**.
8. English factory spine: temporary **Masulipatnam 1611** (मसूलिपत्तनम), permanent **Surat 1613** (सूरत), **Madras/Fort St George 1640**, Bombay leased **1668** (Portuguese dowry to Charles II, **1662**), **Calcutta** via **Job Charnock** at **Sutanuti**. **Levant (लेवेंट) Company (1592)** got a land-route charter before the sea EIC (**1600**, under **Akbar** (अकबर)).
9. **Colbert** founded the French company (**1664**) under **Louis XIV**; earliest French factory **Surat 1668** (**François Caron**); HQ **Pondicherry (1674)**; Bengal factory **Chandernagore** (चंद्रनगर). **Dupleix** (डुप्ले) first used European troops in Indian succession (उत्तराधिकार क्रम) quarrels.
10. **First Carnatic (कर्नाटक) War (1746–48)**: immediate spark = English capture of French ships (नावाध्यक्ष) (**Captain Bernett**); French won **St. Thome** (सेंट थॉम) on the Adyar vs Anwaruddin's force; **Aix-la-Chapelle (1748)** (एक्स-ला-शापेल) returned **Madras**. **Second Carnatic** opens with **Ambur (1749)**; **Wandiwash (वांडिवाश) (1760)** = British (**Eyre Coote**) defeat French (**Count de Lally**); **Paris 1763** ends the Third.
11. Danish facts are **Tranquebar (1620)** and **Serampore** (श्रीरामपुर) in Bengal; Denmark sold its Indian settlements in **1845**.
12. Traveller chronology: **Ralph Fitch (फिच) 1585 → Hawkins 1608 (हॉकिन्स) → Nicholas Downton 1614 → Roe 1615**.
13. **Bernier** (बर्नियर) was a **French** traveller at Aurangzeb (औरंगजेब)'s court, not an English EIC envoy.
14. **Saadat Khan (सादात खान) Burhan-ul-Mulk** founded the **Awadh** (अवध) Nawabi in **1722**; he is not Bengal's Murshid (पीर) Quli (मुर्शिद कुली) Khan (मुर्शिद कुली खान).
15. **Shuja-ud-Daula** (शुजाउद्दौला) stood with Abdali (अब्दाली) at **Panipat (पानीपत) III (1761)**; after Buxar (बक्सर) came the **Treaty of Allahabad (इलाहाबाद की संधि) (1765)**.
16. **Asaf-ud-Daula** (आसफउद्दौला) made **Lucknow** (लखनऊ) the capital and built the **Bara Imambara**.
17. The British annexed **Awadh in 1856**; **Wajid Ali Shah** (वाजिद अली शाह) was the last Nawab.
18. Later chronology bridge: **Awadh annexation 1856 → Indigo (नील) Revolt 1859 → Second Afghan War 1878 → Ilbert Bill 1883 (इल्बर्ट)**.
19. An early European **factory** was a trading post with godowns and guards, not yet a full colony (उपनिवेश); trade (पण्याध्यक्ष) needed Mughal **farmans**.
20. Under **Dupleix**, the French took **Madras in 1746** during the First Carnatic War before Aix-la-Chapelle restored it.
21. Do not confuse **Aix-la-Chapelle 1748** with the later **Treaty of Paris 1763** ending the Seven Years' War.
22. **Ralph Fitch** saw **Agra** (आगरा) and **Banaras** in Akbar's time, before any lasting EIC factory.
23. **Begum Hazrat Mahal** (बेगम हज़रत महल) led Lucknow resistance after 1856 annexation fed the **1857** rising.

24. **Safdar Jung** also served as Mughal **Wazir** (वज़ीर); **Serampore** is Danish, not French.
25. Cause–course–result for Portuguese arrival: they sought a sea spice route, Gama reached Calicut, and Albuquerque's Goa made them a coastal maritime power.
26. Cause–course–result for Awadh's end: Nawabi autonomy from 1722 weakened after Buxar, Dalhousie (डलहौज़ी) annexed the state in 1856, and Lucknow became a major **1857** centre.
27. After **Aurangzeb (1707)**, **Bahadur Shah I (बहादुर शाह I) (Muazzam / Shah Alam)** ruled **1707–1712**; Khafi Khan called him **Shahe Bekhabar**.
28. **Jahandar Shah** rose with **Zulfiqar Khan** (ज़ुल्फ़िक़ार) and was defeated and killed by nephew **Farrukh Siyar** (फ़र्रुख़) in **1713**.
29. **Farrukh Siyar's 1717 farman (फ़रमान)** gave the English **duty-free trade in Bengal** for an annual lump sum of about **Rs 3,000**.
30. **Sayyid (सैयद) brothers** (सैय्यद) (**Abdullah** and **Hussain Ali**) were the later-Mughal **king-makers** (**1713–1720**).
31. **Muhammad Shah Rangeela (रंगीला) (1719–1748)** was the last emperor to sit on the **Peacock Throne**; **Nadir Shah** (नादिर शाह) defeated him at **Karnal (1739)** and took the throne and **Kohinoor**.
32. **Chin Qilich Khan (Nizam-ul-Mulk (निजाम-उल-मुल्क) Asaf Jah)** founded independent **Hyderabad** after defeating **Mubariz Khan** at **Shakar Kheda (खेड़ा) (1724)**.
33. **Sawai Jai Singh II** built **Jantar Mantar** observatories at **Delhi, Jaipur, Ujjain (उज्जैन), Mathura (मथुरा), and Varanasi (वाराणसी)** (not Allahabad) and prepared **Zij Muhammad Shahi**.
34. Last Mughal **Bahadur Shah Zafar** (बहादुर शाह ज़फ़र) (son of **Akbar II**) was an emperor without an empire; teachers include **Zauq** and **Ghalib**; spiritual guide **Hasan Askari**.
35. Arrival order of European traders: **Portuguese → Dutch → English → Danes → French**. Portuguese were **first to arrive (1498)** and **last to leave (1961)**.
36. First Portuguese fort in India: **Cochin 1503** (Albuquerque, before he was Viceroy (वायसराय)). First Portuguese factory: **Calicut 1500**. **Nuno da Cunha** shifted HQ **Cochin → Goa**.
37. Portuguese used **Hooghly** as a Bay of Bengal piracy base; **Shah Jahan** crushed them there in **1632**. Dutch Bengal hub **Chinsurah** had **Fort Gustavus (गुस्तावस) (1653)**; Dutch took Kochi and built **Fort Williams (1663)**.
38. **Thomas Best** broke Portuguese naval monopoly at **Swally** near Surat. **Sir John Child** was expelled by **Aurangzeb** (औरंगजेब) after attacking Mughal ports (**1688**).
39. First modern **Municipal Corporation** in India: **Madras, 1688**. Europeans prized **Bihar** for high-grade **opium** and **saltpetre**.
40. **Bahadur Shah I's Accession (Battle of Jajau 1707):** Prince Muazzam defeated his brother Prince Azam Shah at the **Battle of Jajau** (near Samugarh/Agra) in June 1707, ascending the throne at age 63 as **Bahadur Shah I**; pursued a conciliatory policy toward Rajputs, Marathas (released Shahu), and Sikhs.
41. **Jahandar Shah and the Izara System:** First puppet emperor in Mughal history; dominated by prime minister Zulfiqar Khan; institutionalized **Izara (revenue farming)**, auctioning the right to collect land revenue to the highest bidder, ruining the peasantry and bankrupting the imperial exchequer.
42. **Sayyid Brothers (King Makers): Abdullah Khan** (Wazir / *Qutb-ul-Mulk*) and **Husain Ali Khan** (Mir Bakhshi / *Amir-ul-Umara*), Barha Sayyids of Muzaffarnagar (UP), enthroned and deposed four successive emperors: Farrukhsiyar, Rafi-ud-Darajat, Rafi-ud-Daula, and Muhammad Shah.
43. **Farrukhsiyar's Golden Farman (1717 CE):** Issued to the British East India Company delegation led by **John Surman** (cured of illness by surgeon William Hamilton), granting duty-free trade in Bengal, Bihar, and Orissa for a nominal annual payment of ₹3,000, termed by historian Orme the '***Magna Carta of the Company's Trade***'.
44. **Nadir Shah's Invasion & Battle of Karnal (24 February 1739):** Nadir Shah routed the disorganized imperial army of Muhammad Shah in barely three hours; treacherously invited by Saadat Khan Burhan-ul-Mulk of Awadh; plundered Delhi for 57 days, massacring 30,000 citizens and seizing the **Peacock Throne (Takht-i-Taus)** and **Koh-i-Noor diamond**.
45. **Foundation of Independent Hyderabad (1724 CE):** Disgusted by court debauchery, Wazir **Nizam-ul-Mulk (Chin Qilich Khan)** marched south, slew imperial viceroy Mubariz Khan at the **Battle of Shakar Kheda (October 1724)**, and established the sovereign Asaf Jahi dynasty.
46. **Murshid Quli Khan's Reforms in Bengal:** Elevated to hereditary Nawab-Nazim of Bengal in 1717; transferred capital from Dacca to **Murshidabad**; introduced the ***Mal-zamini*** system of rigorous revenue collection; maintained absolute peace and regularly remitted imperial tribute to Delhi.
47. **Alivardi Khan's European Doctrine:** Usurped Bengal in 1740; astutely compared European merchants to **bees**: '*If left in peace, they produce sweet honey, but if provoked, they sting you to death*'; strictly prevented British and French traders from fortifying their factories at Calcutta and Chandernagore.
48. **Saadat Khan Burhan-ul-Mulk (Founder of Awadh):** Appointed Subahdar of Awadh in **1722 CE**; suppressed recalcitrant local zamindars; established capital at **Faizabad**; committed suicide by poison during Nadir Shah's occupation of Delhi when unable to produce the promised ₹2 crore ransom.
49. **Nawab Asaf-ud-Daulah's Lucknow Architecture:** Shifted the capital of Awadh from Faizabad to **Lucknow in 1775 CE**; constructed the world-renowned **Bara Imambara (1784 CE)** as a massive famine-relief project without a single wooden or iron beam, along with the monumental **Rumi Darwaza** styled on Constantinople's Sublime Porte.

50. **Annexation of Awadh (February 1856):** Lord Dalhousie annexed the Kingdom of Awadh on the pretext of chronic 'misgovernance' (*Ku-prashasan*), utilizing a biassed inquiry report by British Resident **Major-General James Outram**; deposed the cultural monarch **Nawab Wajid Ali Shah** (*Akhtarpiya*) and exiled him to Metiabruz (Kolkata), directly provoking the outbreak of the **1857 Uprising**.

⏱️ Timeline / Chronology

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[1707 CE] Death of Aurangzeb; Battle of Jajau; Bahadur Shah I (*Shahe Bekhabar*) ascends
   │
[1712–1713 CE] Jahandar Shah (*Lumpat Sadak*); introduces Izara (revenue farming)
   │
[1713–1719 CE] Farrukhsiyar (*Ghrinit Kayar*); Golden Farman to British EIC (1717); Banda Bahadur martyred (1716)
   │               └── Dominated by Sayyid Brothers (King Makers)
   │
[1719–1748 CE] Muhammad Shah 'Rangeela': Breakup of Empire into Regional Autonomous States
   │       ├── [1717/1727] Bengal: Murshid Quli Khan
   │       ├── [1722] Awadh: Saadat Khan Burhan-ul-Mulk (Faizabad)
   │       ├── [1724] Hyderabad: Nizam-ul-Mulk (Battle of Shakar Kheda)
   │       └── [1739] Nadir Shah of Persia sacks Delhi (Battle of Karnal; loots Peacock Throne)
   │
[1757 CE] Battle of Plassey: Robert Clive defeats Siraj-ud-Daulah; British control Bengal
   │
[1759–1806 CE] Shah Alam II: 3rd Panipat (1761) ⚔ Battle of Buxar (1764) ⚔ Treaty of Allahabad (1765)
   │               └── Diwani of Bengal granted to EIC; becomes British pensioner (1803)
   │
[1806–1837 CE] Akbar II: Confers title 'Raja' on Ram Mohan Roy; pensioner of the British
   │
[1837–1857 CE] Bahadur Shah II 'Zafar': Symbolic leader of 1857 Revolt; exiled to Rangoon (1858)
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Dynastic Succession of Later Mughals (1707–1857 CE)

MONARCH	REGNAL YEARS	IMPERIAL SOBRIQUET / NICKNAME	PIVOTAL LANDMARK / EVENT
Bahadur Shah I (Muazzam)	1707–1712 CE	***Shahe Bekhabar*** (Khafi Khan)	Battle of Jajau; released Shahu; conciliatory policy
Jahandar Shah	1712–1713 CE	***Lumpat Sadak*** (Foolish Debauchee)	Dominated by Zulfiqar Khan; introduced Izara system
Farrukhsiyar	1713–1719 CE	***Ghrinit Kayar*** (Despicable Coward)	King Makers (Sayyids); Golden Farman (1717); executed Banda Bahadur
Rafi-ud-Darajat	1719 CE (98 days)	—	Shortest reigning Mughal emperor; died of consumption
Rafi-ud-Daula (Shah Jahan II)	1719 CE (105 days)	—	Puppet of Sayyid brothers; died of dysentery
Muhammad Shah 'Rangeela'	1719–1748 CE	***Rangeela*** (Pleasure-Seeker)	Liquidated Sayyid brothers; Khayal zenith; Nadir Shah sack (1739)
Ahmad Shah	1748–1754 CE	—	First invasions of Ahmad Shah Abdali; dominated by Udham Bai
Alamgir II	1754–1759 CE	Aziz-ud-Din	Reign witnessed **Battle of Plassey (1757)**; murdered by Wazir Imad
Shah Alam II (Ali Gauhar)	1759–1806 CE	—	**Battle of Buxar (1764)**; **Treaty of Allahabad (1765)**; first EIC pensioner
Akbar II	1806–1837 CE	—	Granted royal title **"Raja"** to Ram Mohan Roy (1830)
Bahadur Shah II 'Zafar'	1837–1857 CE	*Zafar* (Pen-name)	Leader of **1857 Revolt**; tried and exiled to Rangoon; died 1862

📊 Quick Reference Grid

1. The Autonomous Regional Successor States of the 18th Century

AUTONOMOUS STATE	YEAR FOUNDED	FOUNDER / SOVEREIGN	HISTORICAL CAPITAL	DECISIVE HISTORIC LANDMARK
Awadh (Oudh)	**1722 CE**	**Saadat Khan Burhan-ul-Mulk**	**Faizabad → Lucknow (1775)**	Treaty of Allahabad (1765); Bara Imambara (1784); Annexed **Feb 1856** (Outram Report)
Bengal	**1717 CE**	**Murshid Quli Khan**	**Murshidabad** (from Dacca)	*Mal-zamini* revenue; Battle of Plassey (1757) & Buxar (1764); Dual Govt (1765–72)
Hyderabad	**1724 CE**	**Nizam-ul-Mulk (Chin Qilich Khan)**	**Hyderabad**	Battle of Shakar Kheda (1724); First state to accept Subsidiary Alliance (1798)
Carnatic (Arcot)	c. 1720 CE	**Saadatullah Khan**	**Arcot**	Disputed succession led directly to Anglo-French Carnatic Wars
Mysore	1761 CE	**Haidar Ali** & **Tipu Sultan**	**Srirangapatna**	Four Anglo-Mysore Wars; French alliance; rocket artillery; Treaty of Srirangapatna (1792)
Rohilkhand	c. 1721 CE	**Ali Muhammad Khan / Hafiz Rahmat Khan**	**Aonla / Bareilly (UP)**	Defeated in First Rohilla War (1774) by Shuja-ud-Daulah and British (Warren Hastings)

2. Chronology of Nawabs of Awadh (UP Special Core Match List)

ORDER	NAWAB / RULER	REIGNING SPAN	CAPITAL	DEFINING HISTORICAL LANDMARK
1.	**Saadat Khan Burhan-ul-Mulk**	1722–1739 CE	**Faizabad**	Founder; established autonomous dynasty; committed suicide during Nadir Shah's raid
2.	**Safdarjung** (Abul Mansur Khan)	1739–1754 CE	Faizabad / Delhi	Appointed imperial Wazir (**Nawab-Wazir**); built Safdarjung Tomb in Delhi
3.	**Shuja-ud-Daulah**	1754–1775 CE	Faizabad	Fought at Panipat III (1761) & Buxar (1764); signed **Treaty of Allahabad (1765)** with Clive
4.	**Asaf-ud-Daulah**	1775–1797 CE	**Lucknow** (shifted 1775)	Built **Bara Imambara (1784)**, Rumi Darwaza, Bibiapur Kothi; famine relief works
5.	**Wazir Ali Khan**	1797–1798 CE (4 mos)	Lucknow	Deposed by British; led the **Massacre of Benares (1799)** against George Cherry
6.	**Saadat Ali Khan II**	1798–1814 CE	Lucknow	Signed **Subsidiary Alliance (1801)** ceding half of Awadh territory (Rohilkhand, Gorakhpur)
7.	**Ghazi-ud-din Haidar**	1814–1827 CE	Lucknow	Took royal title **'King of Oudh' (Badshah)** in 1819 with Lord Hastings' encouragement
8.	**Nasir-ud-din Haidar**	1827–1837 CE	Lucknow	Established astronomical observatory at Lucknow; built Tarawali Kothi
9.	**Muhammad Ali Shah**	1837–1842 CE	Lucknow	Constructed **Chhota Imambara (Husainabad Imambara)** and unfinished Satkhanda
10.	**Amjad Ali Shah**	1842–1847 CE	Lucknow	Built Hazratganj market and Iron Bridge (*Loha Pul*) over Gomti
11.	**Wajid Ali Shah**	1847–1856 CE	Lucknow	Last Nawab; poet (*Akhtarpiya*), patron of Kathak & Thumri; annexed **Feb 1856**

3. Decisive 18th-Century Battles Shaping Modern India

BATTLE	DATE / YEAR	OPPOSING FORCES	VICTORIOUS POWER	REVOLUTIONARY GEOPOLITICAL IMPACT
Battle of Karnal	**24 Feb 1739**	Nadir Shah (Persia) vs Muhammad Shah	**Nadir Shah won**	Humiliated Mughals; looted Peacock Throne and Koh-i-Noor; exposed imperial decay
Battle of Plassey	**23 June 1757**	Robert Clive (EIC) vs **Siraj-ud-Daulah** (Bengal)	**British EIC won**	Treachery of Mir Jafar; British established sovereign political mastership over Bengal
Third Battle of Panipat	**14 Jan 1761**	**Ahmad Shah Abdali** vs Marathas (Sadashivrao Bhau)	**Ahmad Shah Abdali won**	Decimated Maratha leadership; prevented pan-Indian Maratha empire; aided British rise
Battle of Buxar	**22 Oct 1764**	**Hector Munro (EIC)** vs Triple Alliance (Mir Qasim + Shuja-ud-Daulah + Shah Alam II)	**British EIC won**	Truly decisive military battle; established British supremacy over North India
Battle of Shakar Kheda	**11 Oct 1724**	**Nizam-ul-Mulk** vs Mubariz Khan (Mughal governor)	**Nizam-ul-Mulk won**	Decisive victory founding the independent Asaf Jahi State of Hyderabad

🧠 Memory Anchors & Mnemonics

1. **Later Mughal Nicknames Formula (High-Yield UPPCS Match):** - **Bahadur Shah I** = ***Shahe Bekhabar*** (The Heedless King — Khafi Khan) - **Jahandar Shah** = ***Lumpat Sadak*** (The Senseless Fool) - **Farrukhsiyar** = ***Ghrinit Kayar*** (The Despicable Coward) - **Muhammad Shah** = ***Rangeela*** (The Pleasure-Loving)
2. **The King Makers (Sayyid Brothers):** - **Abdullah Khan:** The **Wazir** (Administration & Finance). - **Husain Ali Khan:** The **Mir Bakhshi** (Military & Army). - *Barha Sayyids of Muzaffarnagar (Doab, UP).*
3. **Awadh Nawabs Capital Shift Hook:** - First 3 Nawabs ruled from **Faizabad** (Saadat Khan, Safdarjung, Shuja-ud-Daulah). - **Asaf-ud-Daulah** shifted the capital to **Lucknow in 1775 CE** and built the **Bara Imambara in 1784 CE**.
4. **1764 Buxar Triple Alliance:** - **M**ir Qasim (Deposed Nawab of Bengal) - **S**huja-ud-Daulah (Nawab of Awadh) - **S**hah Alam II (Fugitive Mughal Emperor) - Defeated by Major **Hector Munro** at Buxar.

🎯 High-Yield PYQ Drill

> **Mastery Rule:** Read the consolidated facts above, attempt these high-yield questions, and score ≥80% to conquer this chapter.

Q1.

Arrange foreign travellers by arrival: I. William Hawkins II. Ralph Fitch III. Sir Thomas Roe IV. Nicholas Downton

A. II, I, IV and III B. IV, II, I and III C. I, III, II and IV D. III, II, IV and I

▶ Details

Q3.

With reference to the Treaty of Aix-la-Chapelle (1748), which of the following statements is/are correct? 1. The First Carnatic War ended. 2. Madras was returned to the English.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 only B. 2 only C. Both 1 and 2 D. Neither 1 nor 2

▶ Details

Q5.

Arrange the following wars in correct chronological order: 1. First Anglo-Mysore War 2. Second Anglo-French War (Second Carnatic War) 3. First Anglo-Sikh War 4. First Anglo-Afghan War

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 2, 1, 4, 3 B. 1, 2, 3, 4 C. 1, 2, 4, 3 D. 2, 1, 3, 4

▶ Details

Q7.

In which year did Vasco da Gama reach Calicut, and who received him?

A. 1492; Albuquerque B. 1498; Zamorin C. 1502; Almeida D. 1510; Krishna Deva Raya

▶ Details

Q9.

Match **List I** with **List II**:

List I (Navigator) A. Vasco da Gama B. Christopher Columbus C. Captain Cook D. Abel Tasman

List II (Country) 1. Holland 2. Portugal 3. Spain 4. Great Britain

A. A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1 B. A-3, B-2, C-4, D-1 C. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4 D. A-4, B-1, C-2, D-3

▶ Details

Q11.

Which European power used **Hooghly** primarily as a base for piracy in the Bay of Bengal?

A. Dutch B. French C. Portuguese D. English

▶ Details

Q13.

Who is associated with founding the English settlement that grew into **Calcutta**?

A. Sir Eyre Coote B. Gerald Aungier C. Job Charnock D. Sir Thomas Roe

▶ Details

Q15.

When the **English East India Company** is **not** an option, which was the first **joint stock company** to trade with India?

A. French East India Company B. Dutch East India Company (VOC) C. Danish East India Company D. Portuguese Estado da India

▶ Show answer